



arnica
butler

promoting
april

PROMOTING APRIL

By Arnica Butler

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CHAPTER 1

The second time my wife and I saw Jonny, it was like a date.

It was weird, actually, how easily it all fell into place. Jonny sent the text messages to *me*.

*Hey. You and April up for some play tonight, this wknd?
I can't get her tight ass out of my mind*

I have to admit, I stared at this one for a long time. My dick was rock-hard in a second, and my heart started beating so fast I thought I was going to need a paramedic. Jonny sent me this message at 7:30pm on a Friday, so I was still at work, and April and I had plans to eat chicken from a churrasqueria.

April's tight ass. My wife's tight ass, and he couldn't get it out of his mind because he'd blown it full of cum.

It was two weeks since our first real dip into the hotwife lifestyle. While April and I had made occasional reference to that wild evening at her friend Lilith's party, when she had let Jonny walk her over the line into hotwifing - *well* over the line - we didn't talk about it constantly.

That wasn't out of lack of interest on my part. I have to be honest: I was new to this thing, and I didn't really know how to bring it up with April, let alone how to arrange another encounter with Jonny.

I didn't want to seem, to April, quite as obsessed with her sleeping with other guys as I was. I didn't want her to know that almost every single second of my day was filled with thoughts about that night. Visceral images floated through my mind, across my vision. I spent whatever imagination I had (I'm a logistics guy, so this isn't a deep bucket) coming up with potential, future scenarios that were sometimes too wild for even me.

There were dark thoughts, too. Concern about how far April had gone with Jonny, how naturally she'd deep-throated a total stranger, how easily she took his fat cock in her ass - something she had never done before, if you believed her, certainly never with me... these thoughts burned like hot coals in the center of my chest. Slowly and incessantly.

In the end, though, I sent April a text after re-reading Jonny's invitation over and over. My hand was shaking a little with excitement, my

cock rock-hard.

*Jonny wants to know if you want to get together.
Sometime this weekend.*

It might seem mildly hilarious, or strange, that I wanted to protect my wife from the coarseness of Jonny's text message, but that was something on my mind as well. *I* wanted to hear Jonny talk about April's ass like that. I hung on every syllable of that sentence, "*I can't get her tight ass out of my mind.*" I savored the thought that the *way* April's tight ass was on his mind was as the memory of a feeling: the feeling of her actual ass, tight around his cock, pulsing with an orgasm. April's sweet sweat on his lips, the back of her head in front of his eyes, and her ass clenching around his dick while he sawed at her velvety, hot interior, knowing it was the first time anybody's dick had ever touched her there.

April didn't get back to me for a long time, and that was a form of torture in and of itself. Maybe April would, like so many women seem to do, regret what she had done and vow to never do it again. This I could never understand, but it was an experience I'd had with more than one woman in my life. Jenny Brooks, the girl I lost my virginity to, who said, "That was nice, but I don't want to do it again." That kind of thing.

April *said* she'd had a good time. April had been, in fact, complicit in the plan to make something happen that night with Jonny. She *seemed* to have had a good time, and had gone way further than I ever could have hoped she did.

But April was the kind of prim, pristine, rule-following woman who might reflect on a night of swallowing cock and taking it in the ass while her husband watched as way too risqué, something to never be repeated.

As a one-off, she might be able to excuse herself. But as a continued practice? I could see her deciding not to go through with it.

And sure enough, after a while, April texted me back, and I felt my hopes crushed beneath her high heels.

Can we talk about this when you get home?

I drove home dreading the conversation to come. I thought about it for so long, and played it out in all of its disappointing possibilities, and

then rehearsed my nonchalance about her indifference to this sexual adventure, that when she said what she said, it took me a moment to actually *hear* it in my mind.

She was still in her work clothes, pulling something from the fridge. I expected a whole big build-up to the conversation, like her asking me about work and what I wanted for dinner, before she pursed her lips and asked, in the tone that I hate, "So, about this thing with Jonny, we need to talk."

But April did none of that. She poured herself a glass of water, asked me if I wanted one, took a sip as I sat down, and then set the glass down.

"So he texted you?" she said.

"Who?" I asked, honestly, because she hadn't said it in the tone I'd expected, and she'd got to it right away.

"Jonny, silly. He texted you?"

"Uh... yeah," I said cautiously.

She held out her hand. It took me another moment to figure out she wanted the phone.

"I set that to auto-erase," I lied, proud of myself for thinking on my feet. I handed her the phone. "It's a sensitive conversation... you know."

She took the phone, and then waved a little, and set it down.

"Gotcha," she said. "That's... probably for the best. Although... who else can get into your phone?"

I shrugged and made a face and waved my hands around. *I know. I'm so silly*, my gestures said.

All I wanted, in fact, was to have a smooth landing here, and not have April get offended by the trashy way Jonny was talking about her ass.

Which, admittedly, was silly of me.

"Well," April said, playing with the cover of the phone with her fingertips, dancing them over it, stroking the seams, absent-mindedly being ridiculously arousing. "What do you think?"

"I...?" I said. My mouth moved and made a flapping sound, like fish slapping together in a barrel or something equally stupid. "I think... um... it's, I guess, up to you."

She looked up at me, still tracing. "Is it, uh... something you want to do again?"

God. Women. How many fucking times do you have to say this sort of thing to them?

Do you want to do that thing we did that involved sex again?

Always yes.

"I... look April, I told you, it was really, really hot."

"You don't think it was too much?" she asked. She brought her hand to her mouth, thumbnail to her lips, taking a little nibble of it, and grimacing slightly.

I swallowed. "Did you?" I said. My voice was brittle, faint. I hoped she couldn't hear the uncontrollable need in it. I hoped she had no way of sensing the boiling desperation inside of me: the cold chest, the hot balls, the sweat that was surfacing all over my chilled and boiling back.

She covered her eyes with both hands. "I don't know," she said. "I'm just... uh... I can't believe I did all that stuff."

"Did you like it?"

April set her hands down in front of her and looked at them. Her lips trembled and fluttered until they melted into that mysterious smile of hers, the one that barely turned up the corners of her mouth. She pressed her lips together and exhaled through her nose, lifting her eyes to look at me.

I picked up my phone. "Do you want to see what he has in mind?"

"This is so weird," April said, her lips fluttering into a shy smile.

I started typing to Jonny.

April's up for it. She wants to know what you have in mind.

I read my words aloud as I typed, and then looked at April for approval, with my finger hovering over the "send" button. She stared, and then nodded quickly, minutely.

I sent the text and set the phone down. I slid my hands across the counter to her and took them in mine. "Babe," I said, even though we never called each other "babe" except, ironically, in the most serious of circumstances. "I want you to do whatever makes you happy. It's more than okay that you had a good time with Jonny. Doing all that. If you liked it, I liked it, I want to see more of it."

"It's so..." she said, and then lowered her voice to a charming, astounded whisper, "*dirty*."

I hunched over a little, because at this point, my cock was painfully hard already, and it pulsed excruciatingly into the seam of my work pants.

I wondered what to say.

The phone buzzed. I picked it up.

*Ask her if she has anything in mind
Have her wear something that looks nice from behind
you'll thank me later*

I translated this for April. I could see that it gave her a little thrill, or that some sentiment traveled through her body.

"So listen," she said, and here came the tone.

I cringed inwardly.

"This is, uh... fun and everything. But I don't want... like, it's fun with Jonny, because he's..." she waved a hand at the ceiling, indicating that Jonny was some kind of nothing above her head. "I feel like I can do this stuff with him because he's not someone I have to see every day. But I don't want it to be, like, the thing *we* do, or to be doing it, I guess, all the time. Does that make sense?"

April did not want me throatfucking her and fucking her ass. She wanted some other guy to do that.

Check.

I had somehow hit the jackpot, and I was just sitting there staring at it while all the cash spilled out on the floor.

"I... yeah, April, that's, you know... what I always, I guess, envisioned."

April looked at me with such a confused expression on her face that I thought for a moment I had spoken in tongues.

"Really?" she asked, at last.

My mouth was dry. "Really."

It really, actually, literally, was.

"If that's what you want," I added quickly.

She tipped her head a little. "And you're not... like, going to get mad, or jealous, or whatever? That's the part I don't understand."

I shook my head slowly. "This is hard to explain," I said. "It's, uh... like, jealousy, is part of it. But no... I'm not, I'm definitely not going to get mad."

...If you commit the filthiest acts I have ever seen.

"Hmm," April said.

"Hmm?"

"I just, you know... is that, you won't get mad no matter what?"

That was a real question.

"April, honey, I keep trying to tell you..." I sighed.

April was blushing.

"Can you just tell me," I said cautiously, "what you're thinking?"

Ha. Wouldn't all of life be that much easier if this was something we were all good at doing?

April shrugged, and hesitated. "It's just... I kind of like it." Her blush deepened. "I like, you know... oh, my God, I can't believe I'm saying this..."

Please say it. My cock was about to explode.

"Just tell me," I said. "Look, it can't be any more... I don't know... risqué than what I like. Right? I'm telling you the truth, and it was hard for me to tell you what I wanted. But since I did, it's been a good thing. So you can tell me. I *want* you to tell me."

"It's just that..." she said, and looked at the ceiling, sighing, holding a hand up to her chest, like she was trying to grab something out of her soul.

"Are you embarrassed to say it?" I ventured.

"Kind of."

"I was, too," I said. "But I didn't have to be. I want that same thing for you."

"Okay," April said. She lowered her voice to almost a whisper. She looked me in the eye, but then looked off to the side. "I kind of like... you know, being... *used* like that."

My eyes closed and I inhaled slowly. "April," I said. I opened my eyes. "That is... the hottest thing you've ever said."

"I didn't know that about myself," she continued, as if she hadn't heard me. "Until... you know."

I turned the phone, which I had placed face-down, back over. "So you want to say yes?" I ventured.

She inhaled, her eyes drifting off to the side. A smile quivered on her lips, like something surfacing from a very deep lake. "If... you're really okay with it," she said. "Then... okay."

"Okay."

I typed a response.

When?

Jonny, predictably, suggested "now."

April raised her eyebrows, and then, though I wanted to go "now," I exerted some control over the situation.

We have plans. Tomorrow?

Re-reading my text, I realized it probably came across to Jonny as exactly what it was: a lie meant to make it seem like I had more control over the situation than I did, a sort of hotwifing blow-off meant to increase April's appeal. Jonny probably knew that April and I were not exactly free-swinging swingers who were painting the town red every single Friday night.

But still. I didn't want to appear as desperate as I felt.

A long pause ensued, but Jonny wrote back.

*Sure
Start at my place?*

*

I had no idea what a "date" with Jonny was going to look like. The first time we had stepped out of our marriage had been with him, and it had happened sort of organically, at a party, after a long string of encounters and situations in which April had teased me. We had circled around the idea for a long time, but the night it actually happened, neither one of us had any idea it was going to.

Lilith, April's somewhat predatorially sexy friend, had a big hand in what had transpired between April and Jonny; she had introduced him to me, and then to April, and also engineered some of the situations that led to our "big step" into hotwifing.

As odd as it seemed, I felt a little strange flying solo without Lilith as my wing-woman.

It's not like I was friends with Lilith. She was a hot woman with a manipulative and dangerous side, and I didn't trust her any further than I could throw an elephant. But Lilith, who seemed so at home in the realm of sexual taboos, was a sort of guide - a nightmarish, scary guide, but a guide nonetheless.

April slept in the next day, then went to the gym, and basically acted like nothing was going on Saturday night. I couldn't tell if this was an act, and if it was, what motivated her to put it on. Didn't she want to know what Jonny was up to? Where we would go, if we would go anywhere, what he had planned?

I wanted to know these things. They burned inside of me every second of the day.

Watching April putter around the house, nonchalant, another sentiment burned inside of me: why didn't she feel as nervous, as curious, as excited, as I did?

Was it just that she wasn't showing it?

"Well," she said, around 4pm. "I guess... like, should we get ready?"

She was in the kitchen, and she poured herself a glass of white wine. When she saw me watching her, she shrugged. "To take the edge off," she explained. "I'm sort of nervous."

I don't know how to describe the feeling I had at that moment, except to say that the world seemed to shift, and I felt a lot like I had back when I first started dating April. There's a scene in some old show where this guy gets to sleep with a supermodel, and in his mind he's wearing an astronaut suit as he walks into the bedroom to have sex with her for the first time.

April brushed a loose lock of hair from her forehead, as innocently as someone might do if they were studying in a library somewhere, and looked at me expectantly.

"You're nervous?" I asked, and I could feel the back of my neck heating up with embarrassment, because I sounded like an absolute idiot. "Nervous" left my mouth rattling from a high-pitched cackle. *No-big-deal, nervous, ha-ha, about-ha, what?*

April looked shocked, though, and not like she was as embarrassed of me as she should be. "You aren't?"

I gave my head a little shake, and it was about the fakest bluff I think I'd ever tried. So I quickly started blabbing to cover it up. "I... you know, you just seemed really... uh, cool about it today, so I just assumed that you were... you know... not nervous..."

April looked at her wine. "I wonder if this is such a good idea."

I waited, because I didn't know if she was talking about the wine or the date, or Jonny in general. "I... what's, um, what are you thinking?" I finally said, when she didn't elaborate.

April set her wine down. Then she shrugged and pushed her hair from her face again. "I think... I guess I'm a little nervous," she said. She fluttered her eyes to look at me. It was endearing and incredibly hot at the same time. "Is that really stupid?"

"No," I responded immediately, because I was certain that was the right answer.

April inhaled and twisted the stem of her wine glass. "Okay," she said, exhaling. "So... what do I wear?"

"Something sexy?" I suggested. "Anything. Anything looks good on you."

I remembered Jonny's text, of course. *Tell her to wear something that looks good from behind. You'll thank me later.*

It excited me thinking about April choosing an outfit that met these specifications, specifically thinking of what she wanted to look like for me, and for Jonny. But it also implied something devious and calculating about Jonny that I wasn't sure I liked: *we* might not know what he had planned for tonight, but it seemed that Jonny *did*.

The last time, things seemed to have happened organically (which is a word, I'll just drop here, that I hate, along with "homeopathy" and "parenting"). So, even though my wife had gone way outside of our marriage vows, and our private sexual recipe card, it hadn't felt quite as out-of-bounds. More like a chance encounter, a flirtation with something - a deep flirtation, sure - but it had a "one-off" feeling to it that planning a date with Jonny didn't have.

April picked up her wine and moved her head in the direction of the bedroom. "Come and help me pick something out. I don't feel like I can do it."

I followed her, watching her move in front of me: same April, same walk, definitely my wife. But the things she was saying? *Come and help me pick something out?* Where did she get this stuff? It disturbed me that she seemed to have mainlined the *very* things that made my dick rock-hard, that she seemed to have some insight into what I fantasized about hearing... and yet why would that bother me? Great, April knew my fantasies inside and out and wanted to enact them. It should have been my dream. I should have been 100% elated.

But instead, I felt off-kilter.

I sat down on the bed and she handed me her wine, so I sipped it as she walked into the closet and bent down to the lower rack, tucking her hair behind her ear. Something about her gesture made me think of a librarian choosing a child's book from a bookshelf, which was incongruent and a fairly wild thought. I tried to stuff it somewhere where I wouldn't think about it, but it kept surfacing.

In the meantime, I want to clarify: I was still all-in on this going ahead.

"What about..." April murmured, pulling out a black pair of pants that she wore to cocktail parties. They were really sexy, for sure, but April was generally a conservative dresser, and while they were fashionable and cute, it didn't have "looks good from behind" written all over it.

She held them up, but continued to pick through her clothes. I didn't want to have to say anything, so I took another sip of wine.

"Hmm," she said, stuffing them back into the rack. "Probably not... you know."

She looked at me. "A dress?"

"A dress," I repeated, like a concussed parrot.

April pushed through her clothes. "These are all kind of... I don't know..."

"The blue one," I interjected, pointing. "How about that one?"

April frowned at me. "I already wore that one once," she said.

"At the strip club?" she added, when I looked confused.

It might seem strange, but this burned inside of me. April remembering that she had worn a certain dress the first night she met Jonny, before she could have known what was going to happen with him. And April not wanting to wear that same dress again... but why? It was a hot dress.

"You can't wear it again?" I asked, disbelief in my voice even though I was working hard to sound casual.

April looked at me like I had asked if she could bite the head off a chicken. Then she rolled her eyes and went back to looking through her clothes. "Uh, no," she said, with a laugh.

A derisive laugh. I have no idea why, but it turned me on. Kind of like bossy, know-it-all high school girls turned me on in high school when they rolled their eyes and told me the actual due date for something.

"What about this?" April asked, fishing a black dress out of her closet. I was certain I'd never seen it before. I squinted.

"Uh... is that new?"

April shrugged. "Lilith was tossing a whole bunch of stuff after she moved, so I took some of it." April held the dress up and examined the bodice by putting her hand through it. She looked at me and smiled. "Just making sure it's not see-through," she explained. "Okay. I'll try it on... Most of Lilith's stuff is sort of stretched out," she said, shaking herself out of her leggings. "Here," she added, moving her hand over her chest.

She pulled her shirt off. She was wearing a pair of sporty neon orange panties and a sports bra, which she left on to try on the dress. My mouth opened and I was about to say something about her underwear, but I was grateful that I had the sense to stop myself. April would think of changing it later, I reasoned.

"Huh," she said, pulling the dress down over her body. The neon sports bra fell outside the shoulders of the dress, and it clung loosely around her body, still requiring a zip-up on the back. April looked down at it and assessed the situation quickly. "That should work," she said.

"You gonna wear it with that bra, though, right?" I joked.

"Of course," April quipped. Then she set the dress on a shelf in the closet. "Unless... you have a better idea?" Her voice had changed to a sultry, beckoning voice, which was incredibly sexy but also made me feel a little like a sailor headed for an island of sirens. It wasn't *like* April to talk like that at the drop of a hat, and so it had the unsettling effect of being sexy as hell and disorienting.

It reminded me, I guess, of Mexican chile candy - a combination of chile, sugar, and tamarind. Spicy and sweet are two things I love and I can't even say I hate in combination. But when I eat that candy, I feel like something has gone terribly wrong in the world. I also always finish the whole thing.

"I... have some... suggestions," I said. My voice sounded quizzical, even to me. April either ignored it or didn't notice. Or didn't care.

"Hmm," she said. She was walking toward me, neon sporty underwear bright against her white skin, the colors clashing with her cool limpid tones. Everything clashed: April's seductive tone and her "normal" personality, the clothing, her carefree attitude about going out on a date

with another man that was almost certain to end in sex (if not just begin with it). "What do you recommend?"

...something that looks good from behind. You'll thank me later.

I didn't really want to be given advice by Jonny, even if it was, technically good advice. Even if I was just as interested in my wife doing something to him that would "look good from behind" as he was.

April was close to me now and nudged my knee with hers. She had her hand on her hip and was wearing that smile I was starting to feel uncomfortable with on her lips.

"Uh..." I said, my head spinning. "Some... you have a pair of black, um, lace, underwear that are sort of like, a um, thong..."

Listening to myself, I was aware that I sounded like sort of an ass. I was also aware that I was, in fact, doing exactly what Jonny had told me to do, and something about that bugged me. But any part of me that was resisting Jonny, or felt disoriented by April, was being dragged along anyway by the part of me that really, really wanted April to wear the underwear I was thinking of while she let Jonny talk her into something filthy.

The grin that so disturbed me flickered at the corners of April's mouth, and the raw pain in my chest was again scraped. She went to her dresser and opened it, found the item I wanted with ease, and held it up between two fingers. She was waiting for me to approve of them, and I was sitting on the edge of the bed with no idea what to do. So I nodded, with my mouth a little open, like an imbecile.

She tossed them on the bed and strode toward the bathroom. "Okay," she said. "I guess I better take a shower."

I watched her go into the bathroom and begin her shower like it was the sort of shower she would take any day of the week, a shower before work, a shower after working out. Did she know she was teasing me, or was it all in my imagination? Maybe she didn't know, maybe she didn't mean to, maybe she was an evil bitch.

My hands were folded in my lap like I was at a church service or something. April took her clothes off carelessly and tossed them toward the hamper. Then she popped into the shower, her limbs moving with a cheerful jauntiness. Something in her bouncing walk, her blasé way of taking her underwear off, her casually-moving limbs, screamed to me that she was delighting in torturing me.

She washed her hair and soaped herself up - all this I could see from where I was, in a slice of mirror hanging over the vanity that reflected a sliver of her body through the curtain of our claw-foot tub.

April always left the curtain open a little, and water splashed out all over the place. But rarely did she leave it as open as it was right now, with the gap directly in the center of the long side of the tub, so that I could see the length of her thigh, the round swell of her bottom, a quick peek of her nipples as she turned. Soap bubbles rolled down her skin. She propped her leg up on the edge of the tub, and all I could see was her foot, as she shaved something above her knee.

This took a long time, and I was left to imagine what she was up to: trimming up her bikini wax, running the face of a razor over all of her most intimate places, painstakingly, carefully - but for another man.

My cock was throbbing painfully, but I just sat there. I didn't want to interrupt the spell that April had me under; I wanted to sit there and watch it unfold without disturbing it. She knew I was here, but I almost wished she didn't, that I could see into her life as she got herself ready for someone else. This wasn't the kind of thought and care that April put into sex with me anymore, not that I cared, but it still burned like a strong drink to swallow the thought.

When she was done, she stayed in the bathroom for a long time. I couldn't see her because she had, predictably, steamed the mirrors, along with the windows in the master bedroom. The combination of scents that were uniquely April drifted throughout the room: her shampoo, her conditioner, her lotion, her deodorant, even the crisp mint of her toothpaste. Layers and layers of April, underneath them, if you got close enough, the sometimes sweetened vinegar of her pussy, the overripe honey scent that gathered at the nape of her neck whenever she sweat a little there. And then a smell that I only know how to describe as *April*. The superheated air of the hair dryer burnt it all slightly around the edges.

And all of this was going to be inhaled by Jonny, his hands were going to feel the sweet proportions of her ass when he cupped it, the tautness of her lean muscles when she had an orgasm, the tightness of her ass around his dick as he filled her with cum.

I wiped some sweat from my brow, but other than that I was motionless as I watched her when she came out of the bathroom. She smiled as she breezed through the room naked, looked at the underwear

with uncertainty, and then stepped into them and fastened a strapless bra. She adjusted her breasts in the lacy cups.

Suddenly she seemed to revert to the April I knew, and she shivered, holding her arms together against her chest. "I don't know..." she mused, and that sentence could have ended with anything. "It's supposed to be chilly tonight."

"Just take a jacket," I said, almost robotically. I wasn't myself, I realized, as I heard my voice. I sounded like I was possessed.

I felt like I was.

April retrieved the dress, and then turned around and got on the floor of the closet, searching for something. "I need shoes..." she said.

When she came out, she was holding a pair of shoes I hadn't seen in years, and which I supposed I had thought had been thrown out. They were a ridiculously high pair of heels, the kind that made April several inches taller than me. She had worn them to a Halloween party what seemed like a lifetime ago.

She let them dangle from her fingers, like a model in an advertisement for something totally unrelated to shoes.

My voice was hoarse, unrecognizable to me. "Wear those," I told her. "And leave them on no matter what you do." Surprise flitted about on April's face, but it quickly turned back to the alluring, sensual smile she had been beguiling me with all night. "Okay," she said, and her voice was as innocent as if I had asked her to pass me the butter.

The shoes themselves seemed to grind their heels into my chest, plant their pointed heels into the collage of fantasies I was playing out while I watched her get dressed.

The dress clung to her as she pulled it on. It was tight-fitting, low-cut at the bosom, and had a wide neck that could only cover one shoulder at a time. The material shifted as she moved, baring first her left shoulder and then her right.

"I need you to zip me up," She said, straining to reach the zipper behind her.

I rose, my legs feeling detached from my body and my hands feeling like something I was operating from a million miles away, like a drone pilot. I zipped her dress up while she held her hair above the zipper. It was still warm from being blow-dried, glossy and gorgeous, and when she dropped it from her hands it filtered down like onyx sand and grazed the

back of my hand. The touch of her hair at that moment was overpoweringly erotic - blood surged to my dick and there was a brief second that I thought I might ejaculate right then and there, without so much as a touch. The memory of a crusty patch of dried cum caught in the tips of her hair seized me and I felt dizzy. I sat down.

"You okay?" April asked me, putting a foot into one of her shoes.

I didn't answer, just slid down to the floor to grasp the straps of her shoe and fasten them. A thin strip of black leather encircled her ankle. I helped her into the other shoe and did the same thing, then paused with my hands on her feet. An idea - to lick her shoe or something that was ephemerally like that - ricocheted through my head, but rather than act on it, I held her left ankle like it was a vase I was afraid of dropping, until she shifted her weight and laughed uncomfortably. "Thomas? You okay?"

I looked up at her and held onto her foot. This was another intensely erotic moment that threatened to overwhelm me, one I would jerk off to later after everything that happened that evening had happened. It was strange: April was going to do so much more than wear sexy heels and tower over me with the promise of letting another man do all the things to her that I *couldn't* do myself - but that was the moment I would later keep in my mind when I was alone in the shower and this evening came crashing into my head. That was the moment that would put me over the edge.

CHAPTER 2

We didn't say much in the Uber to Jonny's place. April hesitated when she got out of the car. "Is it weird that he wants to meet here?" she asked me.

"Uh..." I said. I didn't know: was it? "I don't think so," I assured her, because I knew April was the kind of girl who wanted to hear that everything was fine and totally normal, even when it wasn't. Also, I was pretty sure this wasn't super strange, if you went by the guys on hotwife forums.

After all, when you are doing something with the express intent of getting your wife fucked by another guy, everything that might have seemed off the table under other circumstances seemed silly to object to. Were we going to get too familiar with Jonny by seeing his home? More familiar than his dick in my wife's throat?

It was a nice building, the kind with a concierge. It occurred to me that I had no idea what Jonny did for a living, and no way of even imagining it. He looked like he *worked*, doing some kind of blue-collar job. But this was not a blue-collar condo building.

Inside, his place was all bachelor pad, but classy. I noted the pricey furniture, the freshly-cleaned appearance that indicated he had a housekeeper.

"Nice place," I said, eying the floor-to-ceiling windows and their view of the water. It was one of those new buildings that had been inserted in front of people who used to have views of the water.

Jonny was wearing a pair of jeans and a black t-shirt, but these, too, were items that looked expensive and like they would blend at a club or a decent restaurant.

"You gotta tell me what you do," I told him, and Jonny, who was headed toward a mini-bar built into the cabinetry, sniffed dismissively and grinned, like I was making a joke. Which I wasn't, but I wasn't about to tell him that.

"April, you look *hot*. What do you want to drink?"

April was standing in the middle of the living room, uncertain as to what to do with herself. She had shifted her purse from hand to hand, to

under her arm, back to her hand, because she wasn't sure how to stand. She set it on a chair now, and looked flustered. "Um... I just... what...?"

"Or are you two the kind who don't drink while they're doing this?" Jonny said, popping a cap off a beer. I couldn't see the label, but it had a green bottle and the kind of hipster-y colors that decidedly *non*-blue-collar beers had.

"No," I said, on behalf of April and myself.

Jonny grinned and tipped the beer into his mouth.

"Do you have wine or something?" I asked him. "April likes white wine."

Jonny's eyes moved to April, and delighted in this piece of information: of course, April Snow drank white wine, and something about that titillated him. And me, too, if you want to be honest: I could almost feel him imagining what it was like to taste some white wine on April's cold tongue, or maybe savor it as an undertone in her tangy pussy juices later.

"I got that," he told us, turning around.

He made a drink for me without asking what I wanted, but it was whiskey, and that wasn't really a hill I wanted to die on. He handed it to me with his palm grasping the whole top of it, and heat started to gather under my collar. I'm a white-collar job guy from the kind of neighborhood where guys do shit like this all the time to you: a hundred tiny little nicks of alpha gestures, which you're best off keeping even on a scorecard somewhere, balancing out with your own sinister stares or spreading out on the couch or kicking their shoes or whatever.

But I was here to watch Jonny fuck my wife, so I just took my drink and sat down.

April sipped her wine and there was a really long silence, which I suspected Jonny enjoyed. I wanted to ask what the plan was, and I was hoping April would do it, but I didn't want to sound lame.

"I thought we could go to this place down the street," Jonny said, out of nowhere, after spinning around to pour himself something into a glass. He crouched to look into his mini-bar, bouncing lightly with the just-fresh from adolescent strength that ran through him. "After we have a little fun, of course. It gets pretty hot there, maybe we'll run into a friend of mine."

He stood up, poured the drink and turned around.

April sipped her drink. She was nervous, I could see. "Okay," she said, with the same tone she had used to agree to my underwear choice. My

cock throbbed.

"I have some real tense energy built up from today," Jonny told April, taking the glass from her hand. "I think I need you to take care of that, before we go." He smiled. "Then I'll be able to relax."

He set the glass down on a table, and looked back at April, whose hand was still in midair like she was holding the drink.

Before April could move, he unbuttoned his jeans. Slowly, to give everyone enough time to think about what was happening. He let them drop to the floor. His hand went to his cock, which was already hard, and began to stroke it lazily as he stepped backward toward a big leather armchair. He fell into it and spread his legs open, letting his cock rise between his thighs like a totem pole.

April was still standing, speechless, and looked back at me briefly. I don't know what I did in that moment. My mouth was dry, I wet my lips by pressing them together... I had come here for this, April had come here for this. I just hadn't expected him to dive in so *soon*.

Jonny was grinning confidently, and there was a sinister tension in the air as he did so. His demeanor toward April had changed: no longer coaxing her, he was instructing her, expecting her to comply, almost demeaning her.

But I had done nothing to stop it, and I could feel in my weighted limbs that I wasn't going to.

April took my remaining seated, and my inaction in every other way, as a tacit "go ahead." Turning back to Jonny, she began to walk toward him.

He lifted a finger and tsked. "Take that dress off, baby. Nice and slow."

Jonny stroked his cock while April reached behind herself, attempting to get the zipper of the dress. She laughed nervously when it became clear she couldn't unzip it herself, and Jonny developed a wicked smile before his eyes snapped over to me. "Get her dress, will you Tommy?"

I rose, which was a battle against over-zealousness and dread. Perhaps they combined to make it seem like I was a cool customer, because I moved without stumbling. I pulled on the zipper of April's dress, and the metal mouth opened, spreading open to reveal her white skin, the lacy strap of her bra, her spine, the round hills of her ass with the black lace of the thong bisecting them near her hips, then disappearing between her thighs.

April looked at Jonny while I did this. He was stroking his cock, his hungry eyes all over my wife's body as I slid the dress from her shoulders

and pushed it down to her hips, tugging on it so that it fell to her feet.

"Get rid of that bra," Jonny said, and since I didn't know who he was talking to, I unsnapped her bra and pulled it away. I let my fingers brush over April's nipples as I did: they were peaked and stiff. The bra fell with a soft thump to the floor.

Jonny raised a hand and beckoned April with his fingers, two short pulls with his index and middle finger. It was the gesture of an impatient, important man, a businessman asking for files from his secretary.

April stepped out of her dress, and toward him, and her hot skin vanished from the surface of my palms.

"Sit down right there, on your knees," Jonny told her. He looked at me. "Just get back there and enjoy the view, man," he said.

April got on her knees, and Jonny tapped her shoulder down, so that she was sitting on her heels. From where I was, I could see only her long, shimmering black hair, her bare waist, and then the plump heart of her ass, the black thong snuggled between her butt-cheeks, lace spreading out of the crack to hold her ass like petals on a flower.

Jonny put his hand in her hair, his fingers sliding through it as a caress. He did this twice, then put a second hand around her head, palming her with both hands, almost like a basketball he intended to shoot.

But instead, he pulled her forward, toward his cock, and as he did, he grinned over her head at me.

I couldn't see anything but April's ass, perched over her sexy heels, and the mass of black hair suspended in Jonny's wiry grip, as she bobbed up and down on his cock.

But I could hear what she was doing: the splutter, the cackling, the strain of her nostrils as she struggled to breathe with her mouth full of cock.

Jonny grinned at me for a while and then looked down at April's head in his lap. His mouth fell open, and his eyes rolled a little in pleasure. He sucked on his lower lip. "Mmm, fuck, yeah, baby, suck it," he told her. Then he looked up at me, his eyes narrowing in pleasure.

He pulled April's hair with one hand and used his free hand to hold his cock up to her mouth. April gasped for breath, and I heard the slap of his dick against her wet lips. Jonny swept her hair off to the side, and grinned at me. "She's real good," he said. "I like her lips." He looked down at April. "Go on, honey. Get to work on it. Suck that cum right out of my cock."

When she began again, he looked back at me. "Nice view, huh?"

I was frozen in place. Speech was not something I could do, but Jonny obviously didn't expect much from me anyway.

This moment seemed to go on forever, though I know it didn't. April's head moving rhythmically over Jonny's lap, me staring at her heels beneath her ass, her ribs straining against her skin as she sucked and sucked. Splutters and gags popping into the air, Jonny staring at my wife's mouth around his cock with his sinister grin.

"Oh fuck, there we go," he said. "Swallow it, baby, don't mess that pretty makeup up just yet," he said, before he tipped his head back and groaned, pushing April into his groin. He lifted his hips a little, in time to the bursts of cum that I knew were spraying into the back of April's throat.

Jonny relaxed, April lifted her head, and I heard her pant wetly for a moment. He slipped his fingers into her silky hair and played with it. "Clean that all off, baby, I don't want to have to change my clothes."

And so April went to work on him again, licking his cock clean, while he watched her, guiding her head to get every last drop of cum from his dick and balls.

"Good girl," Jonny said, pulling on her hair slightly to tip her head back and look at her. He flicked his eyes up at me. "Just needs a little lipstick and she's good as new," he said. "Unless you want to take the edge off before we go?"

I shook my head. Jonny was turning April's face toward me so I could see for myself; her lips were bare, the lipstick worn off on Jonny, or licked from his cock by her own tongue. Other than a smudge of mascara, she looked none the worse for wear.

Jonny played with her lip. "He likes that. Okay, get dressed, go get cleaned up, and then we'll go out."

April looked back at me, as if for approval of the plan. I nodded, even though I didn't know what Jonny had in mind by "going out."

She crawled to her dress, and then stood up, while Jonny watched her ass and took a sip of his drink. I helped April into her dress, and then she stumbled to the bathroom.

"She's horny as fuck from doing that," Jonny told me, when she closed the door. "But that's how we should leave it." He took another sip of his drink. Then he raised his eyebrows. "Although..."

I have to admit, I had no idea what to say. What do you say to a guy who is deviously planning ways to use your wife like a whore? Especially if

you're into it? I mean, it was absolutely fucking filthy and April was getting bossed around like an actual hooker, but I wanted to see what he was going to do next.

And I also didn't.

How can I explain it?

Jonny laughed when I didn't say anything. "You gotta quit worrying, man," he told me. "She's into it." He slid open a drawer and took something out of it that I didn't quite see. Then he jumped up, grinning, and stood in front of me. "I told you, girls like that, they're just looking for someone to tell them what to do, so they can do it. Relax and enjoy it." He held up his hand, whatever he had taken from the drawer enclosed in it. "I'm gonna go make sure April's cleaning up all right."

He strolled to the bathroom door and knocked on it, before entering without waiting. It closed behind him.

I heard Jonny's voice, low and sultry, and April's higher pitch, expressing surprise. And then a thump, followed by silence that dragged on forever.

The door opened, and Jonny strolled out. He snatched his phone from the bar, and began sliding his fingers over it. "Uber can be here in like five," he said, to no one in particular.

April came out of the bathroom, a flushed look about her. She was tugging at her dress, to pull it into place. She smiled sheepishly at me. Her red lipstick had been replenished, and her mascara cleaned up. She looked the same as when we had left our apartment.

Except not. Something was off about her, and I scanned her with a sort of desperation, trying to find what it was, even as I smiled at her.

She raised her eyebrows. I mouthed, "that was hot."

"Let's hit it," Jonny said, looking up. "This place is fucking great."

So we left.

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Jonny whispered something in April's ear about two minutes into the car ride. April looked over at me and smiled again, then slid over and eased herself onto my lap. Well, partially: her butt was on my thigh, and she was kind of leaning to the side.

She pulled up the dress until it was over her hip, exposing the length of her right leg. I could see the thong nestled between her legs. She reached for my hand and brought it to her ass, placing it on her thong, guiding me along the wet fabric to where her pink eyelet would be.

My fingers rubbed over something metal, and hard: not the feeling I expected. For a moment my senses flickered out completely on me, like if you expect to chug some water and find vodka in the glass instead. I sucked in my breath, and felt around, my brow furrowed.

Jonny rolled his eyes and grinned, and April held my hand in place. Slowly, the sensations on my fingertips formed into a coherent message: what I felt beneath the pads of my fingers was hard, and there was a metal ring in the center of it, pressed taut to the object by April's thong.

I slipped a finger beneath the fabric of her thong, just to feel it out for real, to confirm what I had already realized: my fingertip ran in a circle around the rubber, feeling the stretched, rubbery eyelet of April's ass, the hard flange, the metal ring.

Jonny had put something in my wife's ass in the bathroom, and now we were going to dinner.

April slid from my lap and settled into the middle seat, smiling.

I wanted to ask her about it, I wanted to know how big it was. Maybe it was beads, maybe it was huge, maybe it was only tiny. I didn't know. I *wouldn't* know, Jonny's smile was saying, until he decided to pull it out from inside of her. Or tell me about it, after he did.

In the meantime, April would be, literally, sitting on it, squirming with something inside of her, getting stretched and ready, I guessed, for Jonny's cock again.

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We settled into a booth at a fashionable place called Tres, and because there was no way of knowing from the decor or anything else what language that was supposed to be, I had no idea what sort of place we were in. It appeared to be restaurant and bar and club, and Jonny seemed to be some kind of mild celebrity, because we received a large booth and excellent, immediate service.

He threw his arms over the back of the booth when he sat in it, April between us. I barely noticed anything, though, because as April scooted to

the center of the horseshoe-shaped booth, all I could think about was the butt plug that pressed against her ass, whether it was dragging against the booth when she moved, and moving around inside of her.

She squirmed into place and pushed her hair behind her shoulders.

Jonny grinned at me.

We ordered drinks, and Jonny told us to order a lot of protein because we were going to work out hard later.

"I have a buddy coming," Jonny said, leaning on the table. "Just... casually. April, Toms, you see what you think, if you like him," Jonny looked at April, "then, you know, we can see what happens from there. But no pressure..." He cut at the air with one of his hands.

"Uh," I said. April looked over at me, eyes wide. "We didn't really talk about that. You know. Other guys."

Jonny leaned back and literally chuckled, and that isn't a word I use for anything but an actual chuckle. "Jesus," he said. "You two."

The waitress appeared at that moment and set down drinks for all of us. April had not ordered hers; Jonny had picked it, and it was a red, fruity-looking martini with a cherry in it.

Jonny grinned at me. "I want to see her eat that," he explained.

"So look," I began, wanting to get back to the topic of this "other guy." "I'm not, uh... we should probably talk about..."

Jonny waved at me dismissively. "Look," he said. "It's just a friend. Let's see what April thinks." He shrugged.

April looked at me.

"I think maybe you should wait and see the guy, okay?" Jonny smiled. "If he meets with April's high standards, we can have some fun." Jonny grinned at April but was speaking to me. "She's wild, but she won't do it with just anyone, I get it." He smiled at April. "I got your number, April."

I stared at April, unable to process her reaction. She didn't blush, or look upset, or look happy, or negate anything he said, or confirm it, either. She lifted her drink and took a sip of it, like Jonny had just found she liked tabby cats and told her he had one, too.

I was glad the place was pretty crowded and loud, and that people seemed to spot Jonny and want to talk to him. I wasn't sure exactly what I was up for in this new relationship, but sitting around talking to the guy who was fucking my wife about sports was not exactly what I had in mind.

"Be right back, you two," Jonny said, and popped out of the booth.

April looked over at me and raised her eyebrows. She scooted toward me and put her hand on my thigh. I saw her lips move, and heard the low rumbling of her voice, but I couldn't make out what she said.

She leaned close to me, her lips grazing my earlobe. "I didn't know he was planning something like this," she said. Over the music, and the clapping of all the voices, I couldn't read the emotion in her voice. It seemed breathy, excited, like she was telling me a secret and it would change my life.

A little bit of alcohol, April's hand, hot through my pants on my thigh, and the thought of her sitting there with some unknown thing in her ass, combined with this breathy whisper, and my cock was so hard I felt like someone was squeezing my balls and my kidneys at the same time.

"So what do you -" I began. I was going to end with "think we should do?" but April cut me off.

"Let's just see who it is," she said, smiling her new, mischievous smile, that I have to be honest, got me hard as a rock, but also kept me up at night with a distinct pain in my gut.

I slipped a hand onto her neck, under her mane of hair, and pulled her toward me. With my lips on her ear, I spoke to her, hoping she was feeling the same debilitating arousal that I was because of it. "What did he put in your ass?"

Her neck was damp with a very light sheen of sweat. Her body squirmed next to me, and her lips quivered into a smile. Her eyelashes fell, she looked at the table, smiling. The moment seemed to go on forever.

She moved her mouth back to my ear. I felt the indent of her teeth, gently, on the ridge of cartilage above my lobe. It was like she had poured an electrical current down my back. "It's a secret," she whispered.

Jonny dropped into the booth again. "Hey guys. This is my buddy, Rog."

We looked up to see a guy very much like Jonny: tattoos, bulging biceps, a flat abdomen beneath an expensive shirt - a chest and stomach that you just knew would be a washboard of carefully sculpted muscles beneath two bulging pecs when he took the shirt off. He had dark hair and dark eyes, homed in on a frequency between friendly and dominating just like Jonny's.

A major, soul-stirring difference between Jonny and 'Rog,' though, was that Rog was a very, very dark-skinned man.

"Hey," he said, in the sort of indifferent, polite tone that men like him can use because they are ripped, black, and have the upper hand in almost every way that matters to men when meeting each other.

April's arm was against mine, and I had every part of my mind attuned to her like she was an experiment in a lab that I needed to observe lest she explode. I could see her jaw and her mouth, and her long eyelashes in the corner of my eye. Her lips trembled a little, and a quiver of excitement ran through her - I was sure of it - before she moved her hands under the table, clasping them on her knees, I think, and said, "Hi."

I sat there, going cold from the core out. Was April's "hi" inviting? Blasé? Stuck-up? Neutral? What would I find between her legs if I had my fingers there?

"Hey, Rog," I said. And then I heard myself asking him, as I scooted out of the booth, "Whatcha drinkin,' man?"

I headed to the bar, and I wouldn't realize until I was there that I hadn't heard what he asked for before dropping onto the side of the booth opposite Jonny, with April smiling at him as he said something to her I couldn't hear over the loud patrons and the music.

From the bar, where I was soundly ignored by the bartender for a good long while, I couldn't see the booth very well. Too many people milled around, blocking my view. I could see glimpses of April's shiny black hair, a flash of Rog's dark skin, Jonny's mouth, open, telling a story. But there was no way to know what was happening under the table, and that was what I really wanted to know: where Rog's hands were, what they were doing. What was happening between April's legs, in her mind, in her gut. In the places where I had gone cold-hot.

I didn't really have *a thing* for black guys in my fantasies about my wife. But there was definitely *a thing* about black guys in general, and that's just out there, okay? Rog was a real alpha-male type, too. And I'd never had a conversation with April about this *specific* thing because, well, I felt lucky enough that April hadn't slapped me with divorce papers when the very tiniest hint of my fantasy had come to light.

"What can I get you?" the bartender screamed at me impatiently.

I ordered two whiskeys, and planned to blame the drink on the bartender if I had the wrong drink. Because whatever he had said to me as I stood up had never even reached my consciousness.

This took another eternity, because while I was waiting, a gaggle of hot blond girls sidled up to the bar and claimed their rightful place at the head of the line in front of any and all men. Our waitress, in the meantime, had gone over to our table, but I figured I would look like a man who just wanted to (confidently) leave his very hot wife in the company of two hot guys who were into fucking her, on purpose, because that's the kind of guy I was.

I looked at myself in the mirror behind the bar. My face was unreadable, which I supposed was a good thing.

When I got back to the table, April was laughing, pushing a strand of her hair behind her ear. She looked up at me and smiled; all of them, in fact, looked at me and smiled, and the conversation went a little dead, the way it does when people are talking about you.

"Forgot what you wanted, man," I told Rog confidently, handing him a whiskey and sitting down next to him, with April now between the two of them, closer to Rog than to Jonny.

Rog took the drink and sipped it. "That's cool, man," he said.

And then Rog looked at Jonny, and they shared a sinister-ish knowing look, before Rog sucked on his lower lip and turned to April, putting his arm behind her on the booth. His fingers landed in her hair, and he played with it absent-mindedly while he took a sip of his drink.

I gave April a very serious look, meant to convey that if she wasn't okay with any of this, then she should just say something. She picked up her drink, looking at me, and smiled, then drank, while looking up at the ceiling. It was the same kind of teasing, *je-ne-sais-quoi* expression she had worn in Mexico - maybe this was a game, maybe it was real.

Only this time, April had, in fact, let another guy fuck her already.

I reminded myself that I had gone along with it, that I had wanted her to do just that. I had wanted April to have some dirty girl inside of her, just waiting to get out - I really had. And I had wanted her to take it even further than she had, I just hadn't expected her to be so willing, so enthusiastic. To do, right away, so many porn-star level things with a stranger.

And yet, it wasn't as if I put the brakes on any of it.

The question that simmered inside of me was: how much of this was April, *all* April? April's repressed sexual desires, the wrapping torn off them, and how much was April doing this for me? What did I want the ratio to be? I didn't even know.

But every time that control slipped, as it was at this moment, I felt it as if it were a rope inside my chest, tied to my dick somehow, and it *slipped*, and burned, just like a rope that slips in real life.

"April," Rog said. "That's a hot name, April."

"Her name is April fucking *Snow*," Jonny said, and I looked over at him, wondering why he knew that. My money was on Lilith, April's stratospherically shady, oversexed, libertine friend.

"April Snow?" Rog said, and brought a hand to his lips in a fist. "You're fucking with me, right? That is a *porn star* name. That's your real name?"

April, who had been slowly transforming into a different person over the course of the evening and had now emerged, fully-formed, dented her lower lip with one clean, white tooth and shrugged.

Rog raised his eyebrows and looked at Jonny. "Shiiii..." he said. He took a sip of his whiskey. "I thought you were the little friend of Lilith's, the one from school."

He said this to no one in particular, shaking his head, looking into his drink. I wondered quietly how many men Lilith talked about her "little friend from school" to.

Jonny tilted his chin. "That's her, man," he said.

For whatever reason, this made Rog turn slightly toward me and raise his eyebrows again. "Tell me you didn't make her change her legal name when you got married." To Jonny, as his left hand moved under the table, out of sight beneath the white tablecloth but obviously to the only place it could have gone - April's knee, he said, "Just the name got me hotted up."

I watched the muscles of his upper arm as they flexed, telltale ripples that spoke of his hands moving over April's thigh. April was looking at her own drink, her lips parted, the faintest smile on her lips, and then she lifted her gaze and met my eyes for one long, scorching moment.

Jonny looked over at me, and his face seemed like that of a salesman: eyebrows up, hands open. "You want to buy this or not?" his face was saying.

"You guys got plans after this?" Rog asked, lifting his hand from under the table to pick up his drink. His fingers, I noticed, were still rubbing strands of April's hair between them, combing through it, giving her, as I knew, electric shivers down her spine. April liked it when people played with her hair.

"We got dinner coming," Jonny said. "Then we were gonna see where the night took us, right, April?"

Rog looked at me and laughed lightly. "I'm game," he said.

Jonny's eyebrows arched again. "How about April?" he asked, the question directed at the table in general.

April stirred her drink with that queer little smile on her face, almost as if she was really looking for something to materialize in it, like flipping a coin or reading tea leaves, that would tell her what she wanted to do.

A red-hot spike of fury went through me; like lightning, it struck hard and fast, and then was gone. It was furious enough to make sweat gather on my neck, the veins in my arm go rigid and rise from beneath my skin like blue wires, but then it passed.

I wondered then, like I would wonder a lot, in quiet dark moments, what the fuck April was thinking about, with that smile on her lips, as she sat there with three guys staring at her, their dicks all rock-hard and oozing precum, waiting for her to say if she was interested in fucking just one, or two, or maybe all three of them.

She lifted the metal sword that Tres used for drinks, because this place was way too classy for plastic, and brought the cherry to her mouth. It burst between her teeth and then disappeared behind her lips, a bright red stain of its juice staining her upper lip for the briefest of pornographic moments, until her tongue darted from between her lips to capture it.

At that moment, she met my eyes, and April looked like the sluttiest woman I had ever seen. Sure, she was all creamy-white skin and shiny-black hair, she was my wife, with her perfect lips and her cornflower blue eyes, but she was also the kind of girl who might, just might, let these two guys fuck her at the same time tonight.

And *then* - and you can never tell what cards April thinks or knows she's holding, whether she's playing them intentionally or not - she fluttered her lashes and said, coyly, "I don't know. I've never done anything like that."

There are a lot of ways a woman can say a sentence like that, and there's a subset of those that I might have expected from April. A woman can say, "I've never done anything like that," and blush, or be outraged, or laugh like it's all a joke. She can sound awkward, uncertain, like she's trying to change the subject. Any of these I would have expected from April.

In the case of a woman like Lilith, she could sound surprised that there was something sexual on the face of this planet she hadn't done yet. She could sound confident, or bored.

But April - *my April* - managed to sound even more viscerally juicy than the cherry she had just pinched between her teeth, by saying, "I've never done anything like that," with a tone that matched her mysterious smile: an indecipherable invitation.

I guarantee, every dick at that table almost spewed cum just hearing that sentence. April wasn't gangbusters to get gangbanged, her tone said: she was April *Snow* for fuck's sake, and of course a girl like her had never done anything like that.

But missing from the tone was a hint of protest, and likewise, there was a hint of eagerness.

April Snow, simply put, "had never done anything like that," but... she *was* sitting at a table with three guys who wanted to fuck her brains out, and some sex toy in her ass, and that was all she could tell you about that.

I heard Rog make an audible, hissing sound as he sucked on his lip again. Jonny grinned at me. It was a lingering grin, the kind of look he might dare someone with. He gave me time to say something, but I was about as useless for speaking at this point as a brick wall.

So Jonny leaned over toward April, and, while still looking at me, began to speak to her in a low voice.

Rog shook his head, smiled, and picked up his drink. "Fuck, man," he said to me, and said no more. I guess I could finish the sentence for myself: *Fuck man, your wife is a hot fucking slut and I'm creaming my fucking jeans right now thinking about my dick in her pussy.*

But my eyes were on April, Jonny's lips next to her ear. Jonny the wife-charmer, putting ideas in her head. April looked at me as he spoke, her eyes burning right through me. The rope of control slipped again, scorching my entire inner torso as it was jerked through my body.

You're looking right at her, Thomas, I told myself. She's looking right at you.

But I couldn't tell anymore if April's eyes were large and dilated and fixed on mine because she was waiting for approval, or if there was something else behind them.

So who knows what she saw in mine, or if it even mattered?

When Jonny put his mouth on April's neck, it was all I could see, even though I didn't move my eyes from hers. His hand traveled up to her throat, and he spoke into her ear, lips gathering up her lobe, tongue running along the ridge of cartilage before his teeth sank gently into her skin.

April dropped her eyes to the table, a faint and hesitant smile on her lips, evidently having given up on getting any message from me. Jonny said a little more into her ear, she lifted her eyes and looked at me, and held my gaze again for a long, simmering moment.

When she shifted in her seat, it felt like I was going to explode right there.

Rog moved his hand over his mouth and watched them. I wondered if he could hear what Jonny was saying.

I wondered what the *fuck* Jonny was saying.

And then Jonny leaned back on the booth and put his arms over the top of it. "Hey Rog, buddy," he said. "You get that bike up and running yet?"

But Jonny was looking at me. Smiling.

As this exchange took place, April seemed to melt in slow motion. By the time I knew what was happening, it was too late, she was disappearing, sliding off the booth, underneath the table.

And everyone knows that can only mean one thing.

I felt her down there, her body brushing against my legs. It was a big booth, and a big table, but there wasn't a ton of room among all those legs down there.

Rog emitted a sound, sort of a laugh, sort of a "huh," and leaned back. "It's, uh... yeah, still in the shop, man."

My ears were ringing: the sound of the bar felt like it was a million miles away. The woman beneath the table was somewhere, but I couldn't tell where. The water in the glasses shook slightly, and Jonny just kept talking to Rog like this was three guys hanging out at dinner.

I sat there, paralyzed, feeling her moving under the table, my eyes flicking back and forth to Jonny and Rog's faces. Jonny grinned, and Rog had a neutral expression on his face. I don't know what my face looked like. I had no idea what to do. Around us, the club continued as if nothing was happening there in our corner.

I don't know how long this went on: for me, time had stopped. The waitress appeared, plates in hand, and looked at the table confused. "Uh, the

oysters?" she asked, finally.

"That's for his wife," Jonny said, grinning, pointing at me. "She's, uh, she'll be right back, you can just put it there."

Jonny grinned some more as the dishes were set down.

And then, to my left, Rog made a low sound, and his head tipped back a little. Almost as if he was falling asleep. He closed his eyes, and his mouth fell open.

And it was then that the movements I felt beneath the table made sense to me: I could see what was happening in my mind almost as clearly as if the table had been clear glass with no cloth over it. April was on her knees, her arm against my right shin, her head between Rog's legs. Her mouth, almost certainly, on his cock.

My stomach felt, suddenly, like I had swallowed a block of ice.

Jonny unrolled his silverware and took a stab at whatever he had ordered. Then he looked at Rog, whose eyes were open, distracted, his mouth hanging open a little. He dropped his hand to his lap, bit his lower lip.

"She's good, huh?" Jonny said to him. He looked at me. "Your wife is a grade-A cocksucking whore."

Rog's body tensed, and he groaned, tipping his head back again. Beneath his taut shirt, I saw his muscles flex, and then he let out a stream of expletives in a hoarse whisper, clutching beneath the table, looking down at the tablecloth as if he could see the woman swallowing his load of cum.

Jonny grinned and popped a piece of meat into his mouth, then grinned at me.

I'm not sure what I thought would happen next. I was floating in space, free-falling in time, untethered to reality. All of this had happened right in front of me, and I still couldn't believe it.

Not *my* wife. Not April. April didn't do things like give blowjobs under tables in public places. Full stop, no need to continue on with the part about giving them to men she had just met, while her husband was seated right there at the table.

Was it hot?

It was fucking off-the-charts-hot. I could feel a damp circle of precum spreading all over the front of my fucking jeans, hot.

And then she slipped back up, into her seat, without looking at anyone. Her red lips were pink now, a tiny smear of red above the left

corner of her upper lip all that remained of her lipstick. A single motion smoothed her unflappable, Asian-straight hair.

I stared at her mouth as she brought her drink to her lips and swallowed, imagining the interior of her throat coated in Rog's pearly white cum.

"So?" Jonny asked her.

Now April looked at me. Her fingers went to work, with remarkable skill, on the oysters before her on a plate. She tipped one into her mouth, and this, like the cherry, seemed to be a deliberately calculated move designed to drive everyone to a touchless orgasm. "Not bad," she said. Then her eyes were on mine. "I could try it. I guess."

Rog growled something under his breath and finished his drink in one gulp, which I assumed was an expression of his agreement with the plan, and a suggestion to get going sooner rather than later. Jonny slapped his hand on the table and looked around for the waitress. "Let's get going, then," he said happily.

CHAPTER 3

We took an Uber to Jonny's place. It was an SUV, and Jonny called shotgun, smiling at me. The three of us piled into the ample backseat, April in the middle, and said nothing as the drive began. Jonny looked back at us, grinning. "It's about fifteen minutes," he told us. "Just sayin'."

Rog leaned over to catch my eye. At the same time, he put his hand on April's thigh. I wasn't sure what the look he was giving me was about: this all seemed like some secret club I'd lied to get into, and now people were giving me secret handshakes and flashing me gestures, and I had no idea what to flash back.

Much like I had for the first part of the evening, I settled on keeping my face as neutral as possible.

Rog's eyes dropped to watch his own hand, and the silky smoothness of April's lean, muscled thigh, as he began to work his dark hand up, pushing her dress along with it. He swept his fingers down, along the inside of her thigh, caressing the skin between her legs.

"So you friends with Lilith?" Rog asked April. My eyes darted from his hand, inching ever-upward toward her panties, and her face, as she watched the same thing. Rog's eyes were on her lips now, eating her alive with his lust. I figured he was thinking about the view he hadn't had the chance to have, savoring the knowledge that April's lips had been enclosing his cock under a restaurant table not half an hour ago.

"She's not one of *those* friends," Jonny said, glancing back.

"Uh-huh." Rog said. His eyes flicked back to me, and he caught my eye. "I got it," he said, like he really did "get it," which I considered mildly insulting, since I wasn't sure if I got it, myself.

I sucked in a deep breath as Rog curled his fingers toward April's panties, and they must have touched her in the center of her pussy, because she squirmed and inhaled sharply. I couldn't see, because his fingers were hidden by the hem of her dress.

"But your name is really April?" Rog said, now to April.

"April Snow," Jonny commented, and then pointed at something outside the car and gave the driver instructions. The driver, a really young guy, was trying to keep his eyes on the road, but he had become interested

in what was going on in his car, for obvious reasons. His eyes kept moving to the rear-view mirror, hoping to catch a glimpse of what Rog was doing.

"That's a good porn name," Rog said, laughing. He had turned toward April now, sitting on the edge of the seat, his eyes on her lips. "That your real name?"

He was now turned almost all the way around. He slid his hand from beneath April's dress and moved it from her lap to the hollow of her throat, bisecting her torso with a smooth caress that made April's entire body shudder.

"It's her real name," I said.

Rog looked briefly at me, smiling, and then back at April. "That's some name. That's the kind of name makes you want to just get all that snow really... dirty." He had a thumb on her lower lip now, and then he leaned in to bite it gently. "April ever been with a black guy before?"

He asked this question while looking down, his fingers moving down to April's thighs again, then beneath her dress, then moving under the fabric, obviously pushing aside her panties. April didn't answer, just fluttered her eyes in pleasure. She seemed almost hypnotized by Rog.

He grinned, and looked over at me, just as I heard a sticky crackle - the sound of his fingers dipping into April's pussy. "Better be careful," he said, good-naturedly, but with just a touch of menace. "You know what they say."

His hand was moving between April's legs, pumping his fingers in and out of her pussy. He braced himself on the headrest above his seat, leaning against the driver's seat. I watched the driver's eyes flicker back and forth between the road and the black man behind him. I wondered if we were all going to die. I didn't think this skinny driver was going to say anything to Rog.

April rolled her head toward me, almost surprised. Her lips were parted in pleasure, but she had an expression on her face, almost like she couldn't believe what he was doing, like she wanted me to confirm that he was.

It occurred to me at that moment that my wife had already sucked two cocks that night, and swallowed their cum, and that she was about to let Rog fuck her brains out. I leaned over to kiss her: I wasn't sure exactly what it was, a kiss of appreciation, a need to stake my own personal claim on her,

a desire to taste her lips and perhaps whatever remained on them of her very naughty deeds... maybe all three.

Her mouth tasted like a sugary drink, though, and her lips moved slightly beneath mine as the motion of Rog's fingers jiggled her whole body. She kissed me back, hungrily, and I heard a mewl in the back of her throat, a vibration of pleasure as Rog's thick black fingers fucked her wet pussy.

"Almost there," Jonny said, laughing. "Hey man, don't worry, we're gonna give you a big tip," he told the driver.

I sat back in my seat, my eyes locked on April's. A wave of disturbing, sickening, hot pleasure rolled through me as I looked at her. Rog grinned and withdrew his hand, making April's eyes close and a quiet whimper leave her mouth.

Rog brought his fingers to his lips and sucked on the tip of them. "Mmm," he said. "April tastes good. I like the taste of that," he said, looking at me. He put his fingers on April's lips. "Don't worry, honey. We got all night."

The car rolled to a stop. We were at Jonny's place.

*

Jonny entered his house like he was having an after-party after going to the bar with some regular friends. He made his way to the small bar he had created in the corner of his living room and got out a beer for himself. "Help yourself," he said, to anyone who was there, before sitting in a rolling chair that he seemed to use for all purposes.

Rog crouched to look into the fridge, and then popped up, holding a drink in a bottle which he took with him to the couch.

"Um," April said, standing in the middle of the foyer. She laughed, a little nervously, and pushed her hair back from her face. "I don't... really know what to do."

Rog laughed. "That's right. You never done this before." He rubbed his lips together and his eyes took another, hungry walk all over April. My stomach flip-flopped again: the air was heavy with the possibility of things getting very, very out of control.

"Why don't we show Rog what April's hiding," Jonny suggested in a teasing lilt, coaxing April toward him with his fingers, like he was beckoning a waitress.

April walked toward him. He encircled her waist, and slipped his hand beneath her dress, pulling it up as he did, moving his hand into her panties. I could hear how wet April was from where I was - I was standing, a little stunned, near the door, still with one hand on the knob, as if I hadn't quite committed to this yet.

But it was committed to, I realized. There wasn't any turning back on it at this point.

Jonny pulled his fingers from April's panties and brought them to her lips, his fingertips gliding in the slick wet of her pussy juices across her lower lip. "April's nice and hot," he said, in that narrating way of his, to no one in particular. He flicked his eyes over her shoulder at me. "You wanna get comfortable? Come in? Go get yourself a drink, man."

I stumbled into the bar area and looked blankly through the fridge, while Jonny wheeled himself and April closer to Rog.

When I turned around, Jonny was peeling April's clothes off, and Rog had wasted no time taking off his own. He had his thick black cock in his hand and was stroking it lazily, watching Jonny unwrap my wife like a Christmas present in front of him.

I went unsteadily to a chair across from the couch, Rog walking backward as Jonny moved April in his direction. Then Rog sat down on the couch, his big cock hovering over his lap like a goddamn monument of some kind.

"So you tasted it, huh, April," Jonny said. "You liked it, right?"

Jonny wasn't the kind of guy to ask this question rhetorically, but April hesitated, her back to me, Jonny's hands on her shoulders.

"You liked it, didn't you, baby?" Rog asked, confident of the answer. His voice was low and growly now.

April nodded, and Rog smiled, his hand gripping his dick with a kind of satisfaction.

"That's right," Jonny said. "Now climb up there and get some more of it, while I show Tommy here your surprise."

Jonny's right hand moved between her legs, fingers sliding into her engorged pussy lips, left hand steering her toward Rog on the couch. She was naked except for her heels, a tall wisp in his hands.

She turned her head to Jonny, and in my direction, and smiled uncertainly as she said, "I don't know if I can, you know, do that," she said. "It's so... big..."

Her eyes fluttered up at me at that moment, her lips still crested into that maddening, unknowable smile. Did she know what she was doing? Was she playing this delicate balance of innocence and sluttiness like a master? Or was it just dumb luck?

Or, as Jonny had put it, was she simply a natural?

Did it matter?

Jonny smiled, his lips on the back of April's neck, his eyes hungrily boring into her skull. "Huh." he said, still moving her forward.

"Come here, baby," Rog said. "Climb up here. I'll get it in there." His eyes shifted to mine. "She got a tight pussy?" He looked back up at April. "It's not so big, baby. Just like Jonny."

April took a hesitant step toward Rog.

"I put something in her ass," Jonny said, lifting her hair and pushing it over one shoulder, before drawing his finger down her spine. April shuddered.

"Fuck," Rog said, his cock pulsing wildly. "Fuck, you little *slut*. Thought I felt something. Y'all kiddin me right? This ain't the first time you done this."

April looked back at me. Then she turned to Rog. "It's my first time with two guys," she said.

Again with that fucking tone, the one that almost made me cum right then and there.

"I got ya," Rog said, reaching for her waist. He pulled her onto him, her legs spreading to accommodate his thick, parted legs between hers. "Your first time with a black guy, too?"

Rog's cock was inches from April's pussy now, purple and pink, dark and twisted with veins and girth that seemed to strain at his skin. It was a gnarly, limb-like appendage, and looked like it was going to stretch April's pussy permanently.

But Rog held April's hips so that she couldn't sit down on it and took her breasts into his mouth one at a time. I could see glistening juices rolling down her thighs, droplets of her lust slipping from her pussy lips to her thigh, balling up, rolling down her leg. She put her hands on the back of the couch uncertainly after moving them around, not sure where to rest them.

"Oh she's good and juiced up," Rog said, as his dark, fat fingers dropped between her legs, pointed upward, and plunged into her pussy. He

stretched his ring finger to her ass, to the black rubber that strained at her eyelet, and then he rolled the object around in a circle.

April emitted a sound like none I have ever heard her make, or even probably heard in porn. This made Rog emit a gruff laugh. "That's good, yeah, you're right about her, she's all ready to get some. Aren't you, April?" He spoke tenderly to her at the end, lifting a hand to touch her lips.

But his hands returned to her hips and started to push her down. I stared as the fat bulb of his head disappeared into the folds of April's pussy, heard a sticky cracking sound, and a mewl from my wife.

"Oh yeah, keep going, that's it. Shit, you got something... what is it? In your ass. You had that in all night?"

April was sinking down to Rog's lap, his cock disappearing, the plug in her butt pressing out, straining her asshole.

"Oh my, oh... wait... oh, it's too big..." April was mewling.

"You got it baby, there you go," Rog told her encouragingly. "There you go," he repeated, when April sat on his lap and her weight sank into him. He had one hand on her upper back, supporting her, and the other on her ass. He slid his hand to her asscrack and played with the tip of the object inside her again.

Jonny had taken this moment to undress himself. His jeans were piled at his ankles, and he had his cock in his hand, watching Rog's cock disappear into April's pussy.

"Now ride it, baby. You never come with something in your ass and your pussy? You're gonna like how that feels," Rog was telling her. "Fuck, I like these dirty little virgins," he added, to the room in general.

Jonny looked over at me, a devious expression on his face. I couldn't tell with him, this time, if he was working with me, or against me. He got down on his knees behind April and palmed her ass with his hands. He spread her cheeks so that he, and I, had a good view of the black implement he had implanted.

With Rog guiding her, lifting her hips and moving them down, April had begun to fuck him. Glimpses of his gnarly cock peeked between her thighs as she rose, her stretched asshole gaping above her pussy, both orifices looking like they might shred if the tiniest bit more pressure stretched them out.

Rog started to jerk April up and down on his shaft more quickly, and Jonny grinned, his hands still working on her buttocks, pulling them apart

as April slammed her sticky wet pussy onto Rog's balls and lap faster and harder.

When April started to moan and shriek, and it was plain to anyone that she was going to come, Jonny grinned, pushed against her lower back to brace himself, and tugged on the ring and ribbon connected to whatever was in April's ass.

He timed it well, April's shrieking reached a crescendo just as the lip of the object stretched her open and emerged from her ass, stretching the pencil-thin line of her anus to an extreme, before a round ball, maybe half the size of a fist, shot out rapidly.

April screamed, coming hard.

I stared as April bounced juicily on Rog's lap: his balls flattened into a dense, hairy mass each time she did. Jonny was still pulling on the string, and the big ball, and it was slowly dawning on me that he had inserted a string of anal beads into April's ass.

April's scream of pleasure changed in tone, rising an octave, as another ball emerged from inside her ass, stretching her anus wide, a shiny sphere only slightly smaller than the first opening her wider and wider until being pushed out.

Rog gripped her hips and lifted his own, slamming his cock deep into her pussy, still thrusting over and over. April's cum sloshed and spurted with every thrust; it was pouring down Rog's balls. Jonny kept pulling, and another ball made April howl as it was birthed.

Jonny pushed that bead back in and April gasped. He stood up, gathering her hair into a ponytail that he tugged on to tip her head back against his torso. His cock was against the back of her head, her long, pretty hair cascading over his cock and his hairy balls. Her mouth was open. Jonny looked down at her. Rog was still bouncing her on top of his cock, slower, but fast enough that her tits bounced.

"You ready to do two guys at the same time, April?" he asked her. "Think you can do it?"

April looked at him and moaned. "I don't know if I can," she said hoarsely.

Jonny stroked her face possessively with his free hand and pulled her mouth open with his thumb. "You can do it, honey. Rog here is gonna lie down, and you're gonna just lie down on top of him, and then I'm gonna

pull those beads out, and I'm gonna fuck your ass full of cum, just like you like it."

He pushed April's head forward. Rog gripped her hips and rolled to the side, stretching out on the couch, pulling April's leg with him, pinning her between his body and the couch.

Jonny wedged himself in between Rog's spread legs and pushed April's torso down to Rog's chest. Rog pulled her close to him, in what would have been a romantic embrace under any other circumstances, April resting her right cheek on his chest.

She was looking right at me, but her eyes were distracted - not vacant, just not really looking at me. Rog lifted his head to look at what Jonny was doing, and his hand stroked April's hair. "Good girl April, you're gonna be just fine."

Jonny played with the final bead in April's ass for a few more minutes, pulling it in and out, drawing the sticky cum from her thighs up to the bead and coating it with them. Then he withdrew it completely and tossed the chain of beads to the floor as he guided his cock to April's gaping hole. "This is gonna go in nice and easy, April," he said.

I stared at April's face as Jonny sank into her ass. Her mouth opened, she squeezed her eyes closed, and then she mewled. "You got it, girl," Rog told her. He dropped his head onto the couch and groaned. "Fuck, you little slut, I can feel you like it. I'm gonna blow your pussy full of cum, baby."

Then Jonny started fucking April. He went slowly for only a few thrusts, and then seemed to lose control, gripping her hips and ramming her hard. April let out a long, steady howl, her eyes closed, her hand balled in a fist next to Rog's ribs.

"Oh my... oh my God..." April squealed. Her eyes flew open, and she looked at me, almost surprised, as Jonny rammed her and Rog thrust upward into her pussy.

"Oh fuck, baby," Rog said, and he lifted his head, watching Jonny's cock as it hammered April's ass. It was only then that I realized that Rog was going to pour his load of cum right into April's unprotected pussy.

My gut wrenched, and my cock spasmed with what almost passed for an orgasm, except it wasn't: I was still left with the pain of the wrenching, ever-building ache from the entire night. I felt like I had been punched in the gut.

Rog came first, holding April's head in both hands and thrusting into her hard. He turned her face to look at him while he groaned and rammed himself deep inside, before releasing her head as his cum filled her cunt. April stayed on her elbows on Rog's chest, her back arched, her body quivering. Her mouth fell open and she howled, each cry punctuated by a squeak of air that squeezed from her lungs when Jonny rammed into her.

And then she fell utterly silent, mouth open, as she came.

Jonny, incredibly, looked over at me. "Oh fuck, that's what I like, she's squeezing my cock with her ass, yeah, baby," he continued, turning his attention back to April. "Milk that fucking cum from my cock."

And then he groaned, and dove deep, filling April's ass with a load of cum.

April was lying against Rog's chest, their bodies shiny with sweat. Her eyes were a little vacant, her mouth still open. Jonny's body jerked, the last spurts of cum shaking from his body. Then he rose up, pulling his cock out of April, and slapped her ass playfully. His cock was still half-rigid, bouncing a little with his every motion.

He dropped his hand to April's ass and played with it. "That's a nice big gape. You want to take a look?"

It took me a moment to realize this question was intended for me. Rog moved a hand down April's back and dipped two fingers into her ass. He finger-fucked her a little. April mewled.

Rog made a sound, something like, "Mmmuhn."

Jonny collapsed on the far end of the couch, watching Rog finger-fuck my wife's ass. "You better get in there while she's all stretched out, man."

"Need a little time," Rog said. "Fuck, girl, that's hot, she's still squeezing my cock." To April, moving his mouth close to her forehead. "You like that, huh?"

"You never hit this?" Jonny asked me, his eyebrows raised.

"Nah," Rog said. "April's a good girl at home, aren't you April? I can tell." He pushed her up by the shoulder with his other hand to make her look at him. "Bet a good girl like you never tasted her own ass." He bit into her lower lip. "You want to taste your ass? Hmm?"

"I don't... do that," April said quietly, shaking her head. This made Rog grin.

"She doesn't do that," I told him defensively, more because I felt like April needed some backup than because I particularly wanted to *stop* her from doing that.

Rog fucked her slowly with his two fingers. "Sure, baby. You don't do *that*. But I bet you'll lick your pussy juices off my cock if I ask you real nice. I bet you'll get my cock ready for your ass, won't you?" He pushed April up to a seated position on his lap. "Yeah, you'll do that, won't you, April? Because you want a big, black cock in your ass, don't you?"

April said nothing, just lifted herself from Rog's cock. It swayed and slapped against his thigh, then began to pulse back to life again as April crawled backward toward his legs, her ass pointed up in the air. Jonny stood up so she would have room on the couch.

April reached for Rog's cock and wrapped her hand around the base.

He put both his hands behind his head and lifted himself up a little so he could watch her. Cum spurted wetly from April's ass, and Jonny watched it, grinning. I was jealous of his view, but I couldn't move my limbs to go over there.

I stared at April as she started to work on Rog's cock. Starting at where her fist ended, she licked the burgeoning length of his dick, lapping up the creamy smears that covered his shaft. She tipped her head to the right and looked at me as she did the same thing on the left side of his dick. The sight of April's eyes, just above the long, dark shaft of another man, cut through me like a saber. Her lips closed around it, like she was eating a cob of corn.

Rog dropped his hand to April's and pried her fingers away. "Just use your mouth, baby. Jonny says you can swallow his cock, let's see if you can handle Rog."

By now Rog's cock had become a solid column of meat, sturdy and pointed straight up from his groin. April dropped her hand to his thigh and lowered her head. She opened her mouth and began to slide down Rog's shaft. Rog watched her and then looked up at Jonny. "Hey man, pull her hair back for me, I wanna see, that shit's tickling my balls."

Jonny gathered April's hair, which was off to one side, into a loose ponytail in his fist. April was still struggling to get all of Rog's cock into her mouth. She released him and licked her lips, breathing heavily. But she opened wide and tried again.

"Just like that, baby, that's good," Rog said. "Do me a favor, look up here at me, yeah, that's it, I like to see those baby blues while you suck my cock." April was breathing heavily through her nostrils, and I saw her stomach ripple as she gagged slightly. She was only halfway down Rog's cock. She released him again and panted slightly.

"That's good, honey, don't give up. That's a big cock, keep working on it. Jonny, give her a little help."

April didn't object: she was staring at Rog's cock with a peculiar look of determination. She took him into her mouth again, and when she reached a stopping point, Jonny pushed against her head with his fist, pressing her down further.

"You can do it, baby. Just open up and let it go right in, you like it down there in your throat, I can tell." He watched her for a moment, and Jonny kept pressing. April pulled back to breathe, and then went at it again, taking another inch into her throat.

"You teach her how to do that thing?" Rog said, and it took me a minute to realize he was talking to Jonny, who was pushing April's head a little further.

He shook his head. "Nah, man, I haven't got that far yet," he said, distracted.

"Oh yeah, almost there," Rog said, as April's lips neared the base of his dick. I stared at April's contorted face, her jaw stretched wide, her cheeks full, her lips drawn to thin lines of pink to accommodate so much flesh. She pulled back to breathe again, and Jonny held her ponytail tightly.

"Just one more time, April. You can do it," Rog told her. "Get all the way down there and then get those eyes up here."

April took a deep breath, and Jonny pushed her forward. Slowly, she went all the way to the base of Rog's cock and looked up at him. The submission she showed him burned through my chest.

She released him, and panted, but Jonny pushed her onto him again, and forced her head to bob up and down on Rog's cock several times.

"Easy, man," Rog said. "Gotta save some for April's little ass."

Jonny let April release Rog from her mouth. The gnarled black snake left her mouth with a sticky cackle, and a long thread of shining saliva linked her mouth to the crown of his dick until she was almost upright, panting.

"Now turn around for me, girl," Rog said. "Turn around and get that ass ready."

April looked over at me briefly, before obediently turning around, while Rog got onto his knees behind her. Jonny stood on the other side of the armrest, dick in hand, watching.

"That's it," Rog said, dipping his fingers into my wife's ass again. "Your ass is all tight again, but you've got a nice load of cum in there, that's gonna make it slide in *real* easy if you just relax."

Even though this was hardly the first time I'd heard a guy talk to my wife like this, I was jarred by the way Rog was talking to her for a moment. Was this really *my April*? Letting a guy talk to her about loads of cum in her ass, bent over to take it again?

Rog finger-fucked her a little longer, then aimed his cock at her eyelet. From where I was, I couldn't really see as his dick sank into her. I could tell by the slight wobble in his dick that he was meeting resistance, and April collapsed onto her chest, head turned toward me, eyes again withdrawn inward... but it wasn't as if this was vacant. It seemed more like April was trying to concentrate, to tell herself to relax so Rog could shove himself deeper into her.

With a wet, cracking sound, Rog's dick broke through whatever had restrained it, and he slid in fast, all the way to the base of his cock. April's mouth fell open a little, and then she mewled as Rog began to slowly fuck her.

"Ah, fuck," he said after a while. "I just want to slam this shit."

"Gotta break her in, man," Jonny said. "Tommy here doesn't fuck her ass."

"Jesus," Rog said. "You don't hit this? Man, come on. This is a tight ass," Rog said, but he didn't look over at me. He just kept pummeling my wife, slowly, his dick crackling wetly with each thrust.

"She likes it," Jonny said. "You can tell she likes it."

"That's good, baby," he said to April. "You know how to take it. Mmm. Just like that. You're bein' real good, April, baby. I'm gonna give you a nice big load."

He started to pump faster, and April mewled again. Her hands were tucked under her chest, and she started to push up.

"Nah, baby, you stay just like that," Rog said, his breath heavy. "Stay just like that and take it."

He fucked her until his body went rigid and he grabbed her ass fiercely with both hands, his fingers sinking deep into her flesh. For his final thrusts, as he came, he lifted her and rammed her onto his cock, her knees flopping uselessly above the cushions as he held her hips and rammed her onto his dick.

He held onto her long after he came, out of breath, staring down at her ass. A tremor gripped him - probably a last spurt of cum - and then he fell onto his calves, his dick flopping out of April's ass. He played with her eyelet with his fingers, lazily, like they were the only people in the room.

April mewled and rocked her hips up and down, trying to get her pussy up to Rog's fingers.

"Hmmm," he murmured. "She's still all fired up."

He said this to no one in particular. I watched April move her ass toward him, her mouth opening when she rubbed her clit over his fingers. Rog smiled and played with her a little bit. April rose up on her hands and fucked herself on Rog's fingers.

"You gonna come over here and fuck your wife, man? She wants some more dick. You want some more, April?"

April looked at me, even though this was Jonny speaking, looking at me in a sinister way. I could see him in the corner of my eye, but his stare was so intense that I felt like I was looking right at him.

I wanted to fuck April, but something inside of me was bucking against being *told* to do it.

"Man, you want to fuck her ass? She's all lubed up."

April's hair, damp at the roots, was tossed over her far shoulder, hanging down her right side. Her head was turned to me, and she posed with her back arched down, her small firm ass thrust into the air. Her breasts swung below her chest, her nipples hard and pointed. Her heels completed her look: she was like a model from Playboy in that moment, except, insanely, I knew that her ass and pussy were oozing loads of cum. All I had to do was walk over there and I could get it, I could put my cock into her sloshing pussy.

"Tell Tommy here you need somebody to make you come," Jonny murmured. His eyes were on April, I could feel the sinister, lascivious burn of them across the room.

"I want you to make me come," April said, promptly, and in a voice that almost made me jump. It was not April's voice: this was the voice of a

nympho porn star.

"Ah, shit," Rog said, shaking his head. "You gotta do something about *that*."

I was standing up now, only just registering that my limbs were moving. I walked toward the couch, unzipping my pants, as Rog moved out of the way, shaking his head and grinning. I climbed onto the couch on my knees behind April.

She looked behind her, her mouth open, her eyes hungry with a dangerous, unseeing lust. A streak of cum had dried in the crack of her ass, her eyelet was still gaping, quivering closed. Cum poured from her pussy as she thrust her hips up and down. "I want it," she moaned.

Between my legs, my cock jerked so violently that I thought I was going to come before I even touched her. I grasped it and looked down, almost as much to make sure I hadn't done just that. My head was spinning.

The woman on her hands and knees in front of me was not my wife. She was a quivering, pulsing, cum-soaked version of her, her eyes literally consumed by her need to get more dick.

I guided my cock to her pussy, looking at her gaping asshole, thinking that I wanted to know what it felt like to fuck her like Rog and Jonny did, but knowing that I couldn't.

I pushed into her pussy and rammed straight to the base of my cock. Her pussy was loose and soaked with so much cum, hers and theirs, that there was no resistance as I sank in. She tipped her head back and moaned, and began to rub against my pelvis. I held onto her hips, gripping them, wanting her not to move, because I wasn't going to last much longer.

"April..." I breathed.

But my wife just continued to buck against me.

"Better grab a hold of that," Jonny advised me, and I could hear the smile in his voice.

I didn't want to grab anything else, so I just held on to April's hips as tight as I could. "Fuck, April," I heard myself saying.

But she was already coming. She ground against me, and there was no stopping her until I felt the electric pop that traveled through her, and her pussy squeezed me tightly and then spasmed around my dick. She stopped bucking, and I thrust into her - no more than three times, until my orgasm seemed to actually explode and leave my cock all at the same time, with so much force that I felt it in my kidneys. Stars swam in front of my eyes and,

for a second, I was bent over April, mouth open, thinking I was having a heart attack.

The next sequence of events is unclear to me: it happened like I was separate from it, looking in on a world through a telescope, and a fish bowl, and from a partial coma, all at once.

I sank back onto my calves, breathing heavily, and April collapsed, turning around onto her back. She flung her arms above her head lazily, and folded her legs together, putting her fingers to her mouth. She was smiling, her eyes distant, almost like she was in another world.

Maybe it was just me.

My cock bounced against my thighs, and I couldn't feel anything but the echoes of my orgasm, still jerking my limbs around. April looked at me, smiling, but it was as if she didn't see me.

And then, somehow, Jonny was pushing me out of the way, and then he was between me and April. I was on the armrest of the couch, sitting, staring, as Jonny pushed April's legs open and up above her head. All I could see was her heels, flopping like the feet of a rag doll, and then a brief glimpse of her gash, and her ass, as cum oozed out of them, just before Jonny's fat cock went right into her ass again.

I scrambled off the armrest because Jonny's body touched me as he fucked my wife again. I stood there, watching, as Rog got on his knees next to April's face. Jonny tossed April's left leg to the side, over her stomach, his dick still in her ass. April flopped for him, her limbs loose and her face blank.

She was folded over to the side, left thigh on top of the right, ankles crossed almost primly, heels bouncing as Jonny fucked her.

Rog's dick had returned to its engorged, ready state, and he held it in his hand, guiding it to April's lips. She stared at it vacantly.

"Just take a little taste," he said to her.

April's tongue flicked out and licked the tip of Rog's dick. He started to stroke himself, and April continued to reach with her tongue, stretching it to lick off the pearly drops of precum that beaded at its tip.

"You wanna put it all in?" Rog asked her.

April licked him and smiled, but then she shook her head. "No," she complained, in a voice that seemed to come from a twenty-year-old blond bimbo and not my wife.

"You don't wanna taste your ass?" Rog asked her. "I'm gonna eat your ass next time I see you, baby. Give it a taste."

April shook her head. I fell into a chair. Jonny reached down and squeezed April's cheeks, until she had no choice but to open her mouth. "You're gonna do it for him, aren't you April?" He pulled gently on her jaw until her mouth opened wide.

"Yeah, see," Jonny said, slowing his fucking, "April likes that. I can feel her getting all hot just thinking about it. She's a dirty little slut, she just needs somebody to tell her what to do. Yeah," he said to April. "I can feel it, I can feel your ass squeezing, you're getting all hot thinking about being a dirty girl."

I was sick, shaking my head. I think I mouthed the words, "April, no," but I didn't say them out loud, or stand up to do anything. I just stared, as my wife opened her mouth, and Rog slapped the length of his shaft on it.

"Just take a little taste, there you go. Oh yeah, she's gettin' all hotted up again. You gonna come for me, April? I want you to suck on that dirty cock and come with my dick in your ass, because I like that."

April closed her lips around Rog's shaft - what she could of it, and he rubbed it through her lips like it was a cob corn getting buttered.

This scene, in all of its filthy stickiness, went on for what seemed like an eternity. Jonny fucked April slowly and egged her on, Rog just rubbed his dick over her lips, and then April, somewhere in the middle, started mewling, and then panting, and then saying, "oh, oh, oh!" with her voice muffled by Rog's cock between her lips.

When she came she screamed, and Rog grasped his dick and jerked off until his cum sprayed all over her face as she tried to catch it in her mouth. Jonny started fucking her hard, and was still at it long after she had stopped screaming, and Rog was spent, using his finger to scoop his cum from her cheeks and feed it into her mouth.

Jonny pushed her legs back over her face, holding them in one hand, and fucked her with her ass turned up to the ceiling. My eyes were stinging by the time he thrust deep and yelled, tipping his head back. A third load of cum emptied into my wife's stretched and overflowing ass.

Jonny let her legs fall to either side, and stared down at her for a moment, panting, before sliding from her ass and sitting down on the couch, facing me. He looked up at the ceiling, though, panting. "Damn," he said.

April rolled her legs to the side, touching her lips almost thoughtfully. Cum glistened in her hair, and was drying on her cheeks. A pearly droplet clung to her upper lip. Her eyes were vacant, her cheeks flushed. The room smelled intensely of briny cum, of April's tangy pussy, and of sweat. Rog sat back on the floor, swiping something off his dick with his hand and looking at it.

"I think we have to get home," I said, when no one spoke for a while.

Jonny tipped his head down to look at me. His eyes were squinting and he was still a little out of breath. He said nothing, just gave me a vague kind of nod.

"Shit," Rog said. "I could go all night with this little slut. I think she's up for it, too."

I scooped April's dress off the floor and walked toward her. When I reached for her, she held out her hand, and I pulled her to standing. I helped her put her dress on. Rog reached absent-mindedly for her ankle, playing with her shoe. "Where'd you get them shoes?" he asked her, his dialect suddenly very Black. "Those're nice. Get my girl some of these."

He grinned up at her.

"Aldo," April said, her voice lost somewhere in her mind. She looked at me as I got dressed.

Rog ran his hand up her leg, stroking her thigh with his thumb about two inches above her knee. It was a possessive, too-intimate gesture, and I felt like I was being knifed. "Any time you feel like playing," he said, "she's into some freaky shit."

Jonny laughed.

I took April's hand and led her to the door. My legs felt like rubber.

"See you later, April," Jonny said, from the couch. "That was fun. Tommy."

I held up my hand as a goodbye. April turned and smiled strangely at him.

The door was closing on us when I heard Jonny's voice. "See, I told you that chick is -"

The door clicked shut.

"You okay?" I asked April.

Her eyes still had a faraway, vacant look to them, and a feeling of regret was sinking through me: I hoped it hadn't been too much for April,

maybe too far. I was scanning my visual memories of the evening, starting to see them as perhaps too rapey. My heart went cold.

But April's faraway look was something different. She was walking with me, slowly, a little uncomfortably, I could tell. "That was so..." she said, and then touched her lips again. "Was it too much?" she asked me, but she stared down the hall.

"Let's go home," I said. "Let's talk about it there."

*

We barely made it into the house. Or maybe I should say, I barely made it into the house. The cab ride had been strangely quiet, with April sitting right next to me but looking straight ahead, her eyes revealing that her mind was busy thinking about something.

I knew what the something was, but I didn't know what her thoughts were.

Halfway there, I moved my pinkie finger along her inner thigh. We were sitting close, hands clasped together, looking in front of us. The pad of my finger caught, satisfyingly, on a tacky patch of dried cum, on the slightly-sticky trail of juices that had run down her leg.

I felt April move next to me: a minute change in her body temperature, in the tension in her muscles. Enough, though, to ignite me: I glanced quickly at her face and then looked back in front of me. It was a brief glimpse, but I saw her parted lips, the upturned corners of her mouth, the gleam in her eye.

I moved my hand further up her thigh, and April's body quivered in her core: it barely lapped upon the shore of her limbs, but I felt it all the same. Between her legs, the sensitive flesh was hot and damp. I could smell the scent of her pussy, mixed with other mens' cum, as I worked my way up to her panties and rubbed the material with my middle finger.

A jolt traveled through April. We were almost home: I stroked her clit through the soaked silk of her panties until our building came into view. Her torso tensed and she sucked in her breath. I pulled my hand away and paid for the cab, opening the door for her, and we hurried to our townhome with our hands together, like teenagers on a first date sneaking into a gym to make out.

Once inside I didn't wait, pushing her toward a wall and trying to unzip my pants at the same time, finding her mouth with mine. I dropped the keys and knocked a painting off the wall: it landed with an audible crunch that indicated severe damage. I was too busy trying to tease apart the flavors in her mouth: her dirty mouth, the mouth that had swallowed cock and cum and licked Rog clean after he'd fucked her ass. She tasted salty, vaguely sweet and vaguely metallic.

My hands lifted her skirt and ripped away her panties. "That was so fucking hot, April," I said. "You're such a fucking slut."

I found her pussy: it was so wet and stretched that sliding three fingers inside of her barely met any resistance. I felt around inside of her, enjoying the way she mewled and closed her eyes, tipping her head back, as I pushed her against the wall and up slightly, feeling inside of her, remembering everything she had just done all at once. It was intoxicating.

She had her arms on my shoulders now, and as I pushed her further into and up the wall, lifting one of her legs from the floor, she opened her eyes and tipped her forehead to knock against mine. Her fingers played with my hair, grabbed it, and she panted into my mouth as I fucked her with my hand. "You don't... you're not... mad...?"

For a brief moment I had a thought: was this an invitation from April? Some kind of game she wanted to play? Did she want me to "be mad?"

I pocketed the thought for another time, because I wasn't able to control myself that long and I couldn't think straight enough to bring the idea to any logical conclusion or action.

I pulled her shoulder and steered her to a long end table behind our couch. It was piled with a bunch of decorative, fragile things that I probably wouldn't have been able to identify if you showed them to me. They all went clattering to the floor, but April didn't bat an eye. She sat down on the cleared table and spread her legs for me, her eyes locked on mine.

There were few encounters in our relationship like this, where the air smelted between us and we were both consumed by animal lust. The taxi ride in Mexico, maybe the first time we had sex (but probably, that had been more one-sided), our honeymoon.

A light from outside cast a square of sodium-yellow across April's face, a steely shadow around it. Her open mouth, her puffy, used lips glistening with spit, her eyes surrounded by smudged mascara, and the feral heat that burned in them, traveled through this square of light as I plunged

my cock into her pussy and fucked her until she began to make senseless noises.

And then, I couldn't hold it back anymore: I pumped another load of cum into her pussy, and her heels dug painfully into my back as she ground herself against me until she came, her mouth a silent scream in the center of that patch of light: the mouth of a woman who, in that moment, looked nothing, and everything, like my wife.

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April fell asleep on the couch, after sliding down onto it and panting there, saying she just needed a minute. I covered her with a blanket and sat down on the floor, leaning against the couch, with a beer I fetched from the kitchen as soon as I realized she was asleep. I spent a lot of time staring at her, touching her hair, sometimes trying to rouse her, but she was exhausted. I fell asleep at some point.

In the morning I woke up and left her there to go take a shower, and she turned her head to look at me when I came out of the hallway.

"Hi," she said, rubbing her right eye. She seemed sheepish.

I walked over to her and leaned down to kiss her, but she pulled away and covered her mouth. "Oh, babe," she said. "I need to brush my teeth."

I kissed her forehead and stroked her cheek. "How about a hot bath? And then a big breakfast?"

April sat up, pulling the blanket with her. She was still wearing her dress, but it was bunched up and stretched out in strange places after the night we'd had. Her hair, rarely out of place, was tousled on one side, and her makeup delightfully smeared. She looked very, very slutty, and my cock throbbed a little thinking about it.

She put her hands to her face. "I can't believe..." she said.

I was halfway through a deep inhale, because while April was very charming, I was starting to get a little annoyed by her lack of faith - I guess that's the word - in my dedication to what we were doing. I didn't want to piss her off, but I also didn't feel like explaining it all again.

But April dropped her hands almost immediately and was smiling when she did. She bit into almost the entirety of her lower lip. "I can't believe last night," she said.

There was an excitement humming in the lower registers of her voice. A kind of breathless, young enthusiasm, the sort of thing that made me feel like she was beckoning me closer, to tell me a secret.

But there was no secret: we had both seen everything there was to see about last night.

Just the thought of it was turning me on again, and I leaned in to kiss her, but April put her hand on my chest. Her eyes were glowing with flecks of lust, so it wasn't an outright rejection.

"I really need that bath," she said. "I'm... pretty sore..."

While her words worked their magic on my cock, and I smiled and told her I'd run it for her, and then moved to do the same, and while I thought about how deliciously hot it was that April seemed to magically know what I wanted to hear... a warning light, some well-buried circuit deep inside my brain, began to flicker again.

Why did April know exactly what to say?

But like I had so many times before, I put it aside, like a task I didn't want to do and "would get to later."

You hope those things don't turn into a dumpster fire.

CHAPTER 4

There was a part of me that wanted to talk to April about what had happened that night, and a part of me that didn't. But April didn't seem to want to bring it up: she got up the next morning and made coffee, went on a run, and then went about her business as if nothing had happened the night before.

And so who was I to argue about that? There was a vaguely unsettling feeling inside of me, for sure, about what was going on. The sense that I'd gotten what I'd wished for, but it was like an episode of *The Twilight Zone* or *Black Mirror*, and somewhere around the next corner, there would be something lying in wait for me.

I was left to wonder things about April - like why she had such a talent for blowjobs and anal sex, why all of this came so naturally to her, why she had only just brought out this side of her personality now (if in fact that was what was happening, another latent fear of mine).

But in the same way that I had sat quietly with my fantasy for so many years because I was afraid of fucking something up with April, I sat quietly on these questions because I now had a really, really good thing, and I didn't want to fuck it up.

I have a penchant for assuming the worst, always believing that some kind of wool has been pulled over my eyes, and if it hasn't, it soon will be. This isn't always a good quality to have as a person. I sometimes choose a self-destructive option when another one is available, just to be right.

It was mainly a trap of that sort that I didn't want to fall into with April now. It wasn't as if April was doing something she didn't tell me about. I was right there in the room when she did it. It wasn't like she was hiding anything. It wasn't like any of this had even been *her* idea.

What I really wanted when I thought about talking to April about the adventures she'd had was some deeper window into her mind, and I knew myself well enough to know that I was secretly hoping for something dark to emerge. Had April untapped a sexual desire she hadn't known that she had, and would she now be forever unsatisfied with her husband? Would she fall for Jonny in some way that surpassed the physical? Or perhaps Rog - and I felt a pang of guilt for even thinking this - with his dark allure, would become her man of choice?

But I didn't say any of this to April. I didn't ask, because it was a door that I didn't really want to look behind. I didn't actually want to know that was true if it was: I just wanted to sip the pain once in a while. Kind of like the difference between a full-out drunk and a functional alcoholic.

And so, I, Thomas Roberts, who knows a good thing when I have it, decided to keep my mouth shut and go along for the ride.

The ride didn't take us anywhere for a few weeks. Jonny texted April on a Friday, late at night, and she told me about it. Holding the phone loosely in her hand, she waved it around like it was a bag of candy she was considering buying at a convenience store.

Her casualness, and perhaps I would even go so far as to call it callousness, to what she held in her powers, disturbed me more than her final decision. She pursed her lips comically, looked at the ceiling, noting that she had planned to go on a really long run with her friend Jen the next morning, and she couldn't cancel. As she spoke, she waved the phone around, and smiled, and shrugged. She was indifferent, I guess, to the way that I was sitting there with a placid expression on my face, but inside, I was salivating like a starved dog.

"I better not," she said, dismissing the whole possibility within seconds on her phone and trouncing off contentedly to "take a bath."

I stewed for a while and got drunk that evening. What else could I do?

By morning, April was well-rested and left at 5:30 to go on her run, ponytail bouncing, mind clear and free, apparently, of the demons that tortured me.

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But not much later - though it seemed like ages for me - April confronted me as soon as I walked through the door. She had her phone in her hand, a message on the screen, and she was deliberating something.

"Lilith wants to go out tonight," April said. "Uh... I think she wants like, *just* me to go."

I raised an eyebrow.

April held the phone out, with two hands, and leaned on the counter, so I could see her texts. More than anything, she looked bewildered.

"Do you... uh... are you asking me if you should... go? Or not?" I asked. I was pretty sure that I was walking on ice here; I just had no idea

how thick it was.

"I don't... huh," April sighed. She looked up from her bizarre communion-handed pose with her phone, and met my eyes. She squinted, and did a strange thing with her mouth. "I don't really think that I *want* to go out with Lilith, like, by myself."

She laughed, so I laughed, and then there was an awkward silence.

"Uh... is that because of -"

"It's because of all of this," April said forcefully, standing up, her tone suddenly and unexpectedly forceful. She was talking like I had been arguing with her. She looked at me over the phone, which she was now holding as if she planned to rage-tweet something. "I always had a, like, weird relationship with Lilith, but there was a balance, you know? Like, she is who she is, and I am who I am, and now I feel like... like she's sort of out to get me to do... I don't know. Be like her. Or something."

Very thin ice, then.

It was cracking under my feet.

I waited. It was possible that April would start talking again and just talk herself out of this problem, because she did that every now and then.

But she didn't. She was looking at me, and she was looking for answers.

I took a beer out of the fridge to buy myself some time. I set it down too hard and it started overflowing, which is a quirk of physics I enjoy telling people about. Even I wasn't sure if I had done it on purpose. I dashed for a towel, and cleaned it up, hoping April would have found something to say by then, but she was still looking at me. Only now she had one hand on her hip and seemed impatient.

"Do you think that's what's happening?" I asked, hoping to sound like a therapist.

"I just *said* that's what I think."

"Um... okay. Does it bother you?"

April harrumphed.

"What does that mean?" I asked, still swiping our useless decorative dishcloth over the beer. The thing seemed to be made of Teflon. It absorbed nothing.

"I mean: of course it bothers me. Doesn't it bother you? I don't want to be... like Lilith."

I was standing on the thinnest ice now, like an idiot. And my feet were encased in cement boots. How deep was the lake? God only knew.

"Uh," I said, and coughed. "What, um, like, in what ways do you not want to be like Lilith?" I asked.

I hadn't given this question a lot of thought, but as soon as I heard it, I thought it was pretty good.

It stumped April for a moment.

"I mean, what are you saying?" April said.

"I'm just saying... okay, you don't want to be like Lilith. But what does that mean? You're friends with Lilith, you went to Mexico with her, you go to parties and you hang out together. So there's evidently something you *like* about Lilith. Right? So what about Lilith do you *not* like, what do you *not* want to get involved in, or whatever? That's what I'm asking."

April looked at me, her mouth open.

She was like that for a long time.

I was weighing my options. Because April being friends with Lilith was a very crucial component in me arriving, unexpectedly, at my fantasy. And I was mostly happy with my fantasy, even if it came with some serious angst. So there was a significant portion of me that did not want to fuck that up, but rather, to argue on behalf of Lilith remaining in April's good books.

But then... there *was* a danger to it, and a truth somewhere in this dilemma. I didn't really want April to become like Lilith, either, whatever that meant exactly. Like April, I couldn't really say: would I mind if April dressed more like Lilith? Would I mind if April slept with as many men as Lilith apparently did? Would I mind if April began running a nefarious business in some kind of sex-related something-or-other like Lilith evidently did?

This was the problem. I was sure that I would mind, and sure that I also wouldn't.

What I didn't want was for April to lose her hesitation, for April to become like Lilith in the sense that she would just jump on anything and anyone, and never blush for a moment.

Was that a fair thing to want? Probably not. But it was what I wanted.

While I was thinking away on this, April and I said nothing. She set the phone down and stared at it.

"Why don't you just say you're busy?" I suggested.

"Ugh, I've done that like ten times already," April said.

"It sounds like you want to keep Lilith as a friend," I said, treading lightly. "You just don't want to... you know, get as wild as she does. Is that it?"

April picked up the phone. "This is silly. I'm almost thirty years old. It's not like I can't..."

She let that trail off.

"It's not like you can't..?" I prompted.

"It's not like I can't make decisions for myself," she said. Her thumb hovered over her screen.

Her eyes went back to me. "Do *you* mind?" she asked. "If I go out with her?"

I wondered what April was asking me. Was she asking me if I trusted her to go out with Lilith by herself? Or if I was bothered by what she had done because of Lilith's involvement? Or what?

"April," I said. "I guess... like, of course, I have to say, it doesn't *bother* me if you go out with Lilith. What else can I say? But does it bother me, actually? I mean, yeah, kind of, because I don't really have any way of predicting what the hell Lilith will get up to, or convince you to do, and like... not every single thing would be okay with me."

We looked at each other. It was an explosive situation, potentially. I could almost smell the gunpowder.

"Lilith isn't exactly trustworthy," I pointed out. "Would you let her watch a puppy?"

April laughed. We had read about this thought experiment in a magazine somewhere and found it really was a good test of a person's trustworthiness.

"I wouldn't let her take a puppy *on a walk*," April said, agreeably. I think we both envisioned Lilith in a short pink dress, dropping the leash to plop on some man's lap while the dog fell into a manhole. We laughed at the same time.

"Okay. Well, there's your answer."

"So what do I say? Blow her off again?" April frowned.

I smiled. I was mostly joking, but only *mostly*, when I said, "Tell her you need a chaperone."

April found this extremely amusing. She grinned and began typing, turning her back to me, like she was flirting with a guy over text messages

and I was her dad or something. She cradled the phone sensually, secretively, and laughed lightly at whatever Lilith sent back.

Then she turned it off and walked over to the refrigerator.

I watched her pour herself a glass of water. I could tell that April sensed me watching her; more importantly, that she sensed the *way* I was watching her. Ravenously, desperate to know what she had discussed with Lilith, why she was smiling. The peculiar grin she had developed ran like a current beneath the shape of her lips, even while she kept her eyes steadfastly on her glass of water.

Finally, finally, *just* when my heart felt like an expanding balloon that had reached its limit, she lifted her eyes and met mine. "It's a date," she told me, in a sultry voice. "Lilith has something she wants to talk to *you* about, anyway."

I raised my eyebrows.

April shrugged back. "Don't ask me," she said. She sipped the water. "She says it's a secret." April pushed the water glass across the counter to me. "I'm going to take a nap," she said. "We're meeting her at ten."

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"So listen," Lilith said, flinging her hair over one shoulder and bringing her pink fingernails to her lips to tap them. Like everything that Lilith did, this was incredibly suggestive, made me think of some lewd sexual act, and yet was completely innocent in reality. "I'm sure by now you know what I do," she said, her breathy voice full of a contagious excitement. I had an epiphany that Lilith was like an endless scroll of porno thumbnails, each one more dirty than the next, her every gesture a promise of a window onto obscenity, and then she was on to the next one before you could take it all in.

I didn't know *exactly* what Lilith did, and it wasn't for lack of effort on my part. I had asked the question directly more than once, and she had just grinned and waved it away, or stirred her cocktail with a sexual laugh, or rolled her eyes.

"So one of my clients," Lilith continued, as if I had agreed enthusiastically, and knew *exactly* what she did, "has a, um, special request. Well, he's not so much *my* client as a reputable client of a... colleague."

I looked at her, dumbfounded. There were moments, since Lilith came into my life, that I actually couldn't believe the things that were taking place right in front of my eyes.

She had waited, a bit like a vulture, for April to go to the restroom, to turn to me with her vivid, hungry eyes, and set about tearing me apart with this speech.

A bad feeling was also building in my abdomen, a sense that things might go suddenly very very wrong. I shifted in my seat and hoped it didn't look uncomfortable. Because it seemed like with a girl like Lilith, the very last thing you wanted to let her know she was doing was making you uncomfortable.

"So this guy," Lilith continued, in her nasal, sultry, sexscapade voice, "is a special case. He's into *cuckolding*, kind of a very dark version of it, he has *a lot* of money, and he's looking to commission a *very* specific video."

The freeze that so often accompanied Lilith, or the word hotwife, was creeping through my chest.

"His wife?" she continued, "not into it. Not everyone is as lucky as you. But he thought if he could get a video made that was, you know..." Lilith waved carelessly at the air above her, "*like* his wife, then... I guess he can do a pretty good editing job or use his imagination. Whatever. Not my problem. But you know, you can't start from like, a big busty blond and get to a nice thin girl without a lot of... whatever it is." She moved her hands Reiki-style over her own body as she said "big, busty blond."

I stared at Lilith. I suppose I knew what was coming, even if I would have told you at that moment that I didn't have a fucking clue what she was talking about.

"April," Lilith continued, her breathless excitement carving out a slippery-wet, triple-X pronunciation of my wife's name, "is sort of, like... well, *exactly* what he's looking for. Tall, thin... she even looks like this chick." Lilith took out her phone and swept her fingers over it, then showed me a picture of a woman in her thirties with straight red hair who did look (albeit not a great deal in my opinion) like April.

I looked up from the photo. "All she needs," Lilith was saying, "is a good red wig. So, I was thinking... I mean, you're into anyway, you and April, and it's, like, a commission, right? *So...* it's good money, it won't be on the internet, and I thought, boom! Perfect."

She stabbed at the olive in her martini and fished it out. Biting into it in the most overtly sexual way a person could eat an olive, she smiled. "What do you say?" she asked, rolling the olive around like someone's balls in her mouth.

What did I *say*? *What did I say*?!

As if Lilith had heard my thoughts, she held up a hand to me, palm out, begging for calm. "He's even got, basically a script. I have it, I can send it to you. Before you say no, take a look at it, show it to April, whatever." She shrugged. Then she lifted her martini and sipped it. "It's not like there's much in it April and Jonny and... who's that hot black guy, his friend? - don't get up to." She set her glass down and grinned, then tapped it with a fingernail. "I mean... not *much more*."

"You want April to be in a porno?" I blurted.

Lilith put her thumb in her mouth and sucked something off of it. She shrugged. "Yeah," she said, as if I was the one saying something outrageous. Then she rolled her eyes. "Oh God, Thomas," she complained. "You're not going to keep up this act for the rest of our lives, are you?"

"What act?"

Lilith rolled her eyes again and pointed a beautifully-manicured finger at the table like a dagger. "The only one who needs any push here, Thomas, is April. I'll send you this..." she waved her hand dismissively at the air, having forgotten the word, as she swept her fingers over the screen of her phone again. "Script, I guess... you have a look. *You're* going to like it." She looked up at me then and smiled. Her voice dropped to a low vibration that seemed to be targeted right at my dick somehow. "You're going to get a big, fat, hard cock and not be able to stop thinking about it."

She let this sit with me for a beat, her crazy blue eyes smoldering above her overripe lips, crushed into a sultry, devious, ball-busting smile.

"But April might need some convincing," she quipped, her personality back in its regular gear.

"Lilith," I began, but I wasn't sure what I wanted to say. It was just a general complaint with her name on it.

"I sent it. Do what you want with it." She lifted her drink. "Just seems like a great opportunity."

I jerked my eyes above her head just then, because April was returning. Lilith lifted her glass to her lips and gave an exaggerated sip of her martini to let me know she got the message.

In my pocket, the two short bursts notifying me of a text or an email from Lilith burned. And for the next half hour, I was a man in a booth with two super-hot women, and I might as well have been in a closet somewhere.

At one moment, and maybe I dreamed this, April was laughing, talking to someone to her right, and Lilith looked right at me.

"You won't be able to get it out of your mind," she mouthed.

*

The "script" was not, as I had been weirdly expecting, an actual script, formatted as if for a professional movie or even a play. It was one long, rambling, text with no paragraphs, the words and sentences running together. I could picture the guy who had written it, hunched over his computer, typing his feverish fantasy, cock hard, chest heavy, his wife sleeping somewhere in his house. He was me, before I confessed my fantasies to April, before she'd accommodated them like a champion slut.

Now I was a different man, hunched over my own phone, my wife asleep in the next room. I was breathless: the script was a filthy, raunchy, gangbanging oeuvre that I could *imagine* April doing, sure - but a disturbing feeling filled me when I thought of the terrible fact that it was something not outside the realm of possibility that she might *actually* do for real.

It was a plot-heavy porno, based, evidently, on an erotic story from an author who had de-platformed one of her earlier works. The husband's wife is kidnapped, and the kidnappers send him a video-call ransom request, with his wife tied to a chair and two masked individuals standing near her with cocks ready to go, the threat being that they will start abusing his wife sexually if he doesn't pay up. But the guy has a fetish, and so he deliberates about it for too long, deciding in the end to pay the ransom and save his wife. He's too late, so the two guys stick their cocks in the wife's mouth, alternating fucking her face, until they come and make her swallow. He watches, obsessed, and thinks his wife is beginning to participate a little too much.

Then they cut the video feed - or so they think - after telling him to pay up or else there will be more, and he is left watching what they think he cannot see. (This part was all a little bit convoluted, but it's been my experience with porn, action movies, and most things that cater to the male mind, that nobody cares much if the dots all actually connect or not, so long

as the explosions are big enough). At any rate, they think he isn't watching anymore, and they take off the wife's blindfold and tell her she's done a good job, and it becomes clear through this video feed that she's in on this kidnapping with the abductors.

So the husband decides to "screw up" again, and they start doing all sorts of crazy things to her, some of them before they think the camera is rolling, and some of them after. They call in more guys, she gets fucked this way and that, and then when they're done, the feed is still on somehow and he sees that she asks them to keep going because she didn't get off while they were pretending to forcibly gang-bang her, and it just goes on and on in a spectacularly filthy sequence of face-fucking and throat-fucking and all kinds of really, really twisted stuff that I was sure *my* April would never agree to do - on camera.

Finally, he pays up and she comes home and makes him eat the loads of cum out of her ass for failing to rescue her in time, which was the final bit, and I sincerely hoped Lilith didn't think *I* was going to do that, because I was not.

And then she tells him she's going to keep seeing those guys and he tells her that's fine as long as he can watch again, which I guess was the burn for the wife at the end.

"Whoa," I said to myself in the dark of the office.

I was drinking, and so I held my glass up and talked to myself. "That is too much," I told myself. "Anyway, April would never do it."

I sat there convincing myself that this was exactly what I would say to Lilith, without even talking to April about this crazy plan.

But I got a little drunker than I meant to, and so I ended up sending Lilith the following text:

*It might help convince her if I could have a copy of that
book
know where I can get it?*

It was 3am. I stared at the screen on my phone, wondering what I had done. There was no way to get it back, no way to take back the message to Lilith that effectively said: *I'm a huge perverted fucker, and I'm into this so much I'm awake at 3am plotting ways to convince my wife to be gangbanged every which way in a commissioned porno.*

Unsurprisingly, I guess, Lilith did not write back immediately.

*

Or the next day, or even the next, and during that time I went in circles with my thoughts. April entered rooms I was in and talked to me, and left those rooms, but it was like I was watching a show, all the time my thoughts consumed and overflowing with the idea Lilith had planted.

I decided, on the second day, that it was all too insane, that I had gone a bridge too far, that it was good that Lilith had never gotten back to me - she had probably, I reasoned, already had her attention grabbed by someone or something else.

I abandoned the idea fully.

And then, at 10:15am at work the following day, I received a text from Lilith. It was a link to a file.

The book.

The book.

CHAPTER 5

After everything that had happened, I realize my next actions are a little strange. I'm not sure why I did things this way. Maybe for fun, maybe to avoid confrontation, maybe to step away from the role of influencer... I have no idea.

I read the book. It was filthy, rollicking good hot fun. It was a short novella, heavy on porny sex and visceral descriptions, light on plot. I put it on April's Kindle without telling her, or asking her, or saying anything. April reads often, but in short bursts and without any true seriousness, so it was a good bet she would see it within days. I had no idea how she would react, or if she would even read it. But, even after everything April and I had done together, I was still somehow reticent to just come out and propose to my wife: hey, want to be in a hardcore porno?

I put the story on her Kindle and decided that it was not my place to try and influence things one way or the other. If April wanted to do something like that, and if Lilith wanted her to do it so bad, then I was going to just sit back and let it all happen.

Lilith texted me the day after I put the book on her Kindle.

Well?

It's on her Kindle

Jesus. Have some patience

Sometimes, late at night, I like imagining Lilith's reaction to that text. I picture her rolling her eyes, setting herself to hatching some creative scheme to get April to do her bidding.

In all likelihood, Lilith probably read the message very briefly, and then was distracted by something more glittery and fun, or one of her many men, and pretty much forgot about it.

Whatever happened, April read the story, and Lilith got in touch with April, and all of it happened off-scene, so I will never know who broached the subject with whom, just that less than a week later, my wife came to talk to me about it all. She behaved so much like we had had a conversation about it already that I almost believed we had, and then I wondered if I had

dreamed it, or it had really happened. Perhaps Lilith had worked that same trick on April, and April believed we had already spoken about it.

I will never know.

All I know is that about a week later, April and I went to dinner, and something was obviously on her mind the whole time.

"What's up?" I asked, heart pounding. It could be anything, I thought: she liked someone at the bar and wanted to go home with him; Jonny had texted her; she had gone out with Jonny and not told me about it; she couldn't get Rog out of her mind; she had read this story and decided she only wanted to be with black men and not waste her time with me any more. Anything.

I was not expecting what she actually said.

Not at all.

"So, I, uh... well, I have something to tell you. Er... ask you about," April said.

Lately, I loved it when April talked to me about things, so I waited, smiling.

"It's about the, um... video."

I dabbed my mouth with a napkin, and tried to wrangle my face into an acceptable expression. I'm sure I failed. April was busy looking at her own hand as she moved her napkin around on the table.

"The video," I repeated.

April sighed, a tone of mild annoyance in it. "*Lilith's* video," she muttered, as if we had been talking about it all night.

"I... so I talked to Lilith, like I said I would... you know, just out of curiosity, more than anything. And, uh, I don't know. She made a sort of... compelling case, I guess."

April looked up quickly at me, and then back down at her hand. I was starting to see double, so who knows what I looked like.

"And, uh... I told her, you know, all the things I was worried about, like this ever getting out and stuff. And she said it's totally normal to put a nondisclosure agreement into the, you know, the contract, and like, a use-agreement or something like that."

She stopped and played with the stem of her wine glass.

"Okay," I prompted, when she didn't start speaking again for a long time.

"Well," she said, tipping her head to the side. "I don't know. It's... Lilith says this guy is true to his word, and stuff. But, I don't know. I don't know if it's worth the risk. You know?"

I nodded. It wasn't that I totally agreed with her, I was just racking my brains trying to remember any conversation that we'd already had about this.

I was about to ask when she had spoken to Lilith - my mouth was already forming a "w" - when April started up again.

"Still..." she said. "It's... like, a lot of money."

I raised an eyebrow. A spark of hope flickered inside of me. It was unusual for April to say something like that, about money.

"How much?" I asked, trying to sound casual, still mystified about this conversation with Lilith, still wondering if I had had a stroke and forgotten something.

She shook her head. "Well... he's willing to go to \$50K for the whole thing, so I'd get, like... \$10K or something." She looked at me, and then looked at her wine glass, that scary smile of hers creeping into her lips. If it had been in any other context, it might have seemed shy, but I was starting to recognize that April was not as shy as she acted. "Lilith says I could ask for more," she said, coyly. "She says she thinks if I like... I don't know, sort of auditioned, he wouldn't be able to resist me asking for more money. She says he's loaded and he's wanted this for a long time but just never found the right... actress, I guess."

I didn't say anything. What would I say? I knew that deep down inside, I wanted April to do this video: the money was just frosting on my cupcake. Now it was like someone had dumped all the candies at the store onto my cupcake as well.

I sat there grinning like an idiot.

"Is this really something you're, uh... okay with?" she asked me, after a long pause. "You've...uh, you know, read the script?"

"It's... look, it's fine by me, April," I said. My voice was shaking, and I wondered if she heard it. "All that matters is what you want to do."

All that mattered, really, was whether or not April actually wanted to be ass- and face-fucked, stuffed in every hole, and filled up with cum by a bunch of guys. Money or no money.

Who had this kind of money to spend on this stuff? I wondered.

"It does kind of... I don't know... it's kind of... I could get into it. Like, as a fantasy," she said, drawing a sharp line with her hand in the air. "Not, you know, actually getting kidnapped..."

Like that was something I would do?

"...and, honestly... if we could get \$50K for it..."

I tried hard to control my expression as I looked at April. Don't get me wrong, I wasn't *against* it, per se, it just shocked me that April was sitting there talking to me about what amounted to prostitution. Kind of.

But she was talking about it with this very no-nonsense tone to her voice. And for whatever reason, this no-nonsense tone frightened me a little. It had all been very fun, very erotic, very... cathartic, if that was the right word... when April had always needed a little push, from me, to being "okay" with all of this.

Now that it seemed that something so cold - money - had tipped the scales for her, made her less bashful, more willing, I felt a little out of control.

Not enough to *do* anything about it. Just enough to feel, yet again, like I had accidentally run off the edge of a cliff. Right now, I was Wile E. Coyote, looking down to see that the ground was far, far below me. Just about to fall.

I laughed a little. I know now that this was my way of trying to maintain control over the whole thing. "Seriously, April, if you could get \$50K for that, I say go for it."

April cocked her head. "What's that tone for?" she asked.

Like most married men I knew, this was a question that wives ask all the time. None of us know what the fuck they are talking about, although most of us know enough to do a good impression of knowing what they're talking about. I mean, Jesus. I only have one tone, as far as I know. April's the one with thirty, or ninety, or the hearing problem that makes her hear tones where there are none.

"What tone?" I said, against my better judgment.

April sighed, and rolled her eyes. "You sound like you don't think I could actually *get* \$50K for it. *That* tone."

Was this a serious discussion? Was my wife actually getting mad at me for being doubtful that she would get paid a certain amount for effectively prostituting herself, and not *the fact that she was thinking about prostituting herself*?

I didn't even know what planet I was on anymore.

"I don't even know what planet I'm on anymore," I told her judiciously. "This discussion is..." I held my hand to my head. "Look, I say, if you can make that much money doing something that you enjoy doing and I enjoy you doing, then all I'm saying is, that it sounds like you should go ahead and try - do it. That's all I meant to say."

April tips her chin up and looks at me through slatted lids whenever she thinks I'm bullshitting her, and that's what she did now. "Oh, okay." The sarcasm was pretty much in a firehose pointed at my face.

"I'm serious, April," I said, and, desperate to turn the tide of this conversation to something less hostile, I tried to be jokey and I took her hand. "I'm really sorry for my tone. You know my tone sometimes picks the lock and gets out of the closet and trashes the place."

April likes this running joke about my bad friend, My-Tone (pronounced like "Tyrone"). I had to wait a little while, stomach in knots, to see if it would save me this time.

She laughed.

"This is all just hypothetical anyway," she said. "Like, Lilith really has a tendency to exaggerate. Who has \$50K to pay for a porno? Right?"

I moved my head in a way that I could legitimately argue was either yes or no.

"Still," she said, picking up a dessert menu. "That's something we could really use. For a down payment on a house." She flipped a page.

We could really use it, considering that the median price of a cardboard box in this town had tipped the scales at \$650K. We were *renters*, and every time we scraped a pile of money together, the housing market shot through yet another ceiling. We had abandoned all hope of the bubble ever bursting. But \$50K would put us flush with -

What was I saying? No one has \$50K to spend on commissioned porn.

She read the dessert menu like she had never seen it before, and found it titillating. Then she set it back in its holder. "So. Is that a yes? Should I tell Lilith to get the ball rolling?"

"Uh... well, yeah."

"Like, it's not going to really happen," April said, looking through the menus in the box with both hands, like she was a librarian with an old-timey card file.

We were at our neighborhood, default restaurant; she had read them six trillion times.

"No, of course not," I said. "But it's fun to pretend."

April looked at me and gave me an absolutely searing grin. It seemed to have been lifted from Lilith's mischievous face, and it was disconcerting. And hot. And it disappeared quickly, so I was left wondering, as we left for home, whether I had actually seen it, and whether any of that conversation had happened at all.

*

Almost a week went by with no news on this front, except for me asking April if she "had, you know... talked to Lilith?" and April nodding, then shrugging.

But Lilith invited us to a party the following weekend.

She sent April a text asking if she wanted to come to "a party." No mention of anything else.

To me, Lilith wrote:

I'm having a business soirée Friday.

Mr. Smith will be there.

Perfect chance to dangle April in front of him.

So, I agreed to go to the party when April told me about it. "Who knows?" she said, with a smile. "Maybe Jonny or Rog will be there."

"Or both," I said, suggestively.

April smiled quietly, almost secretively, in response to this.

*

But from that moment forward, she put everything in motion to get us to that party. She bought herself a provocative new dress: black, strapless, form-fitting. I had never seen April in anything totally strapless in my life. She put a houndstooth jacket over it before we left, and wore her strappy, slutty black heels from the "date" with Jonny and Rog.

She walked ahead of me to the party, and I followed her, feeling like she was a different person. Maybe because of the heels. Maybe because of

the certainty with which she walked right toward Lilith's house. She knew she would see Jonny or Rog there, and if not, someone else: but she walked with her head high and her hair swinging.

I couldn't look at her feet in those shoes without my head filling with a collage of images from that night, so I tried to keep my eyes anywhere else. April's makeup was different, if only slightly. Some gradient of color or heavier application of something had nudged April from her usual appearance just ever-so-slightly in the direction of Lilith's loud, overt sexual advertising. I tried to figure out what it was, but failed: her lips were red, her eyelashes long and black, maybe a little of some sort of powder went somewhere it didn't usually go... I didn't know, I didn't understand women's makeup. (I thought "mascara" was what "foundation" actually is, until the third year of my marriage to April, just to give you an idea of what ballpark I'm in). Perhaps it was just a trick of my mind, an illusion of light and the dark thoughts that bubbled always in my subconscious. Maybe she looked different because she held her head differently, didn't hesitate as she walked to Lilith's party, seemed to be seeking something out as opposed to being led there reluctantly.

Or this could all be my mind playing tricks on me and me alone.

She lost the jacket about five minutes after we arrived, slinging it first over her arm and then dumping it who knows where, never to be seen again.

I went to the kitchen/bar area and installed myself with authority. I watched my wife, with her long limbs dangling from the dress that had been plucked from the narrow borderlands between classy and slutty, as she was absorbed seamlessly into the party. Among Lilith's hot guests - and now that I was zeroing in on what Lilith did for a living, I realized a lot of these women looked hot because they were somehow affiliated with something pornographic or mildly or completely illegal and sexual - April not only fit in, but sometimes dazzled. Like a gem hanging in the sunlight, she would sometimes blind me from across the room with her *hotness*.

It was unsettling. April is beautiful, and she always has appeared *beautiful* to me. But beautiful and hot are two different things, and in these flashes, April was *hot*. She was oozing sexual allure, where she had always glided, ephemerally, as an austere beauty.

I made quite a few drinks for myself, and other people. I watched men's eyes as they shifted constantly to April's direction. I watched them

approach her, make her smile and laugh, illicit a flirtatious grin from her.

This party had a decidedly different feel than Lilith's "housewarming party." The men were largely older. The women were universally gorgeous. A few stud-like guys, with cock-sure grins and taut muscles, wandered around, being unusually obsequious. Something in the air was slightly nefarious, while at the same time it had the stale, fake-smiliness of a standard corporate holiday party.

My cock was rock-hard. I hadn't seen Jonny or Rog, but I was getting quite a show without them. I wondered if any of these guys were "Mr. Smith," the elusive, rich financier who was going to pay my wife a fortune to be a slut in a video.

"Well," April said, coming over to where I was mixing drinks for myself and whoever happened to mistake me for a caterer. "This is a weird party." She leaned in close to me. "I think this is like, something to do with Lilith's business."

"What *is* Lilith's business?" I asked.

April cast her eyes around the party. "She never really tells me..." she said mysteriously. "It's... internet... something." April looked back at me quickly, her face very serious. "Not porn. I don't think. Do you think?"

I could have said "no" with a fair amount of confidence, but then I might have been forced to explain to April that I had been digging around, privately, for some evidence of Lilith in the world of porn, and had come up with nothing. It was - it is - however, a big world.

So I shrugged, and mulled over what to say, while April sipped her drink and looked over the rim of her glass at the seedy, well-dressed underworld that Lilith "did business" with. I tried to imagine what she was thinking, what she was looking for, as she scanned the room. What had Lilith told her? I wondered. How did you keep a friend like April, so nonchalantly committed to looking the other way or not understanding things to be what they obviously were, when you were a woman like Lilith?

I was pondering this mystery when April turned around abruptly to face the wall of liquor and sip her drink. "He's here," she said, with a grin.

My heart came to a stop with a thud, full of blood and nearly bursting. I thought, however briefly, that April was talking about "him" - this rich, mysterious man who wanted to watch his wife fuck another man so badly he would pay my wife to pretend to be her.

But when I scanned the room, I saw Jonny making his way through the clusters of people. Almost everyone seemed to know him. He didn't even look in our direction.

Lilith materialized shortly thereafter. She was encased in an outfit that, at first glance, looked somewhat professional. That was, until you realized that the odd color of her blouse was actually the color of sheer black material over bare skin, and that the only thing making it even seem like an outfit was the long black jacket with a business cut that she had draped over this piece of dazzlingly obscene negligee.

"There's a guy I'm paying to do this somewhere," she told me. But she didn't seem to care about me at all, or why I was making drinks, or where the "guy" she was paying to do it had wandered off to. She linked her arm with April's and used her free arm to make herself a drink, turning her head occasionally toward the party. If she was trying to be sneaky, she was doing a terrible job, but as I watched Lilith bite into a cherry and grin at me, I realized Lilith was not exactly the subtle type. About anything.

She released April and wedged herself in between us, facing the large living room.

"So listen," she said, tossing her hair and lifting her drink to her lips. Her mouth had been moving from one salacious smile to another before, but it set into a serious, business-like expression now. Her eyes were on something else, as if she had too much invested in what other people were doing at her party to talk to us. "This guy, he's here."

She sipped her drink and looked over the edge of it at me, then at April.

We were both silent. I was in free-fall; it was hard to tell how April felt. I watched her face for some indication of surprise and found none. I wondered if Lilith had told April he was coming, and had only been teasing me in a (notably effective) loony way.

She set her drink down and scooped another cherry out of it with her pinkie finger. As she bit into it, she grinned at us. "I think it's the perfect opportunity. Put on a show for him. I can call Rog up, you can do something with Jonny and Rog. And then..." Lilith leaned in and cupped her hand to April's ear, and said something that made April look at me quickly, blush, and then cover her mouth.

Lilith leaned against the counter behind her, arms spread. "It's what he's into. I guarantee that would seal the deal. Then you say... yeah, I don't

think I'll make the video, it's too risky, blah blah. And he'll..."

Lilith turned around suddenly, as if she sensed "his" presence, and then whipped back to face the room. "He'll start offering you all kinds of money."

April crinkled her nose. "You sure about this?"

"What did she just tell you to do?" I asked simultaneously.

Lilith pointed a finger at both of us like she was holding us hostage with a knife. "Don't." Then she smiled at April. "He'll have a lot more fun if you don't tell him about it first."

April looked at me. It was only then that I realized that I was the "him" in that last sentence.

"I'm sure about it," Lilith continued, "because I've done it. He's got cash to spare. And I have a new sauna." She grinned. "Have you seen it? It's in the backyard by the pool. Very Zen."

I wasn't sure what to do, so I took a sip of my drink. I was about to say that I'd need to confer privately with April, when Lilith looked behind her again. "Oh," she said quickly. "There he is. Look, I'm going to go talk to him, I need an answer, or he'll probably leave. And..." she shrugged. "He isn't big into meeting *you*, like... talking. You know? It's all about the illusion." She wiggled her fingers in the air and then whipped around, pushing her way toward the mystery millionaire who wanted to watch my wife fuck other men.

April moved to Lilith's side of the kitchen and leaned on the counter. She clutched her drink to her chest with one hand. "What should I do?"

"What did she whisper in your ear?"

April shook her head quickly. "I actually can't..." she said.

She put a hand on my chest. "So he will... she said to, uh... that if I let him..."

She leaned close to me. "Are you sure you don't want to, uh, like Lilith said..."

"I want to know," I told her. My voice was serious and April's eyes fluttered with surprise. Maybe I hadn't been so forceful about what I wanted until that moment.

"Uh, okay," she said, leaning closer to me, looking down at the counter, playing with her drink. "She said, uh... if I let him...eat out my ass, afterward..." She cast a sideways glance without turning, maybe so she

could see who Lilith was talking to. "Then it'd be a sure thing," she finished in a whisper, covering her mouth on one side quite charmingly.

"That's..." I said. It was all I *could* say. My head was quickly filling with images, my dick filling with blood, and my balls were tight as drums with all the cum I wanted April to suck out of it while this mystery man ate Rog's load of splooge from her ass.

We stared at each other.

"It's fifty grand," April mouthed, holding her drink, again, on the side of her face, as if we had landed in a spy novel and were talking about a heist of some kind.

"That's a lot," I said.

"Seems like he can actually pay it," April said.

We looked at each other.

"Do I do it?" April asked.

Another long pause.

I think, in the end, I nodded. Lilith came breezing through either right at that moment, or shortly afterward, or maybe even a second before: it all happened like a dream. "You have to make yourself scarce," she whispered in my ear, pushing me in the direction of the front door. She had a phone in one hand and was texting. She took April by the arm with her other hand and swept her away, to the other side of the open-concept kitchen, spilling into the living room with all the floor-to-ceiling glass that looked out over Lilith's amazing, lush yard, and her new pool, and her new sauna, and all the wages of her porn empire.

I turned, and walked, dazed, to the front door.

And then, unceremoniously, walking funnily because of my aching erection, I left.

*

When I closed the door of my own home behind me, I was struck by the fact that I had no recollection, whatsoever, of how I had gotten there.

Apparently I had taken an Uber six blocks from Lilith's house, but I could not remember walking there, or ordering it, or riding in it, or leaving the massive tip I'd left.

I was numb until that moment, my mind flashing through imaginary pictures of April, for some reason flooded by a bright flash: April on her

hands and knees, male bodies all around her, hands pushing her hair from her face, and then dark, enormous cocks pointed at her mouth.

I never even got a look at this mystery man, the man who was going to slurp Rog's and Jonny's cum out of her ass. How would he do that, I wondered? On his hands and knees? April on a bed, her gaping asshole pointed at his face, cum welling up from the hot-pink center? Would April enjoy it? Or was she just doing it to make money... the money I couldn't save fast enough to buy her a house?

I sank into a chair and stared at the wall.

What was April doing right this moment? Did she look enough like this guy's wife that he would actually be able to lie to himself, suspend his disbelief, and think my wife was his wife? What would he want her to do, other than get fucked in the ass and then eaten out? Would she be quiet, or would he ask her to be loud? Did he want her to be a bimbo, or say dirty things, or just lay there and get pummeled?

He seemed like he was into a little humiliation, which wasn't my bag. I wondered if April would get into it, and then want that in the future, too?

I fumbled to get my phone out. I opened the file Lilith had sent me: the script, the basic idea of what this guy wanted.

How much of this filth would he want to see *tonight*? How far would April go?

I would never know, exactly. She would tell me, but she wasn't going to give me every detail. She couldn't possibly know which details I really wanted, anyway. Which spurting, oozing, filthy sounds I wanted to hear for myself, or taste, or smell. She couldn't possibly know that when she gasped, or mewled, because another dick was touching her where she had never been touched before, there was no way for her to *tell* me about that.

I sat there for a long time, my insides in turmoil, half-inclined to vomit, half-inclined to jerk off.

I got up and poured myself a whiskey, and then I sat some more, head spinning in aimless circles of thoughts.

I got drunk. The hours crept by.

Somewhere, at some point, Jonny texted me a .gif. It was a dark picture of April, poised on a bed in a white, flimsy dress that looked like almost everything Lilith wore. Her hair seemed lighter: I squinted and detected that she was wearing a wig. She was on her hands and knees, her back arched, her face looking at the camera. In the seconds of the .gif, she

moved forward, her eyes went down, and her mouth fell open. I could almost hear her moaning.

Only after watching it twice did I notice that, in the dark background where the light barely illuminated the shadows, there was a dark head of hair just below the crest of her bared ass.

I watched over and over again, until April no longer looked like my wife, and the pain had permeated everywhere, and was now making me numb.

Or maybe it was the booze.

She would be home any minute, I thought.

I weighed the pros and cons of texting Jonny, asking for more, and decided I didn't want to look desperate. I thought of writing to April, and didn't, for much the same reasons. Aside from the fact that she looked a little too distracted to answer her phone...

I was a man who had asked his wife to fuck other men, and now that's what she was doing, and *I was going to be fine with it*.

I was sitting on my chair alone in my living room with a really hard cock and looking at a pornographic .gif starring my wife and who-knows-who-else, all because of my own doing.

I was going to man up for it.

*

I fell asleep in the chair and had fitful, visceral dreams about April coming home. In one dream, she walked through the door and sat on my lap, waking me up by licking my earlobe. In another, I awoke to her sucking on my cock, and in another, she breezed through the house, ignoring me as I stalked behind her, asking her what had happened.

The dreams were so life-like - typical of when I slept poorly and then finally, in the wee hours of the morning, fell into a poor sleep - that when April actually did come through the door, I heard it, and tried to rouse myself but felt like I was being pulled under by a rip tide of sleep. I was convinced for several minutes that it was just another dream.

When I opened my eyes, she was setting things down on our small table, they clattered, and she clumsily tried to stop the contents of her purse from spilling out and falling to the floor.

"April," I said, in a whisper for no real reason.

She jumped, and turned toward me. "Oh!" she exclaimed. Then she laughed, nervously. "I didn't see you there."

I rubbed my eyes, appraising her appearance critically, my head still swimming in a dream-like fog, irritated for some reason that she "hadn't seen me there."

She was wearing the same dress she had worn to the party, and it seemed tidy, unmarred by any debauched activity. Her hair was pulled back in a ponytail, her face bare of the makeup she had put on last night, but also streakless, as if she had washed it. She looked strangely unlike herself, or perhaps better stated, as though two Aprils had been blended together: the April who dressed up and went to parties, and the version of April fresh from a shower.

"Did you take a shower?" I asked. It was the first question that occurred to me, and I regretted it as soon as I said it, because I knew, without really understanding why, that it was the wrong thing to say.

She put a hand on her hip. "Are you serious?" she asked.

I was smart enough to know this was a rhetorical question.

"That's what you have to ask me?"

I yawned and made a big deal of showing her how sleepy and confused I was. "Sorry, I'm... I'm half-asleep," I said. I started to stand up. "Of course I meant to ask you... you know..."

April pecked me on the cheek. "I'm so tired," she said. "I'm going to pass out if I stay up one more minute."

She started to walk toward the hallway to the bedroom. I clutched her hand, caressing her as I pulled her back toward me. "How did it go?" I murmured. My dreams had done me the favor of maintaining an erection that throbbed noticeably, and almost painfully, now.

She kissed me on the lips. She tasted like toothpaste and smelled of an expensive soap. I noticed that her hair was slightly damp; it caught on her shoulder and stuck there. "I think it went well," she said. "But there's no way of telling." This final sentence ended in a yawn. "I really am so tired, honey. Can I tell you about it after I sleep for a bit?"

This was not at all what I wanted, not at all, but of course I had to say yes. "Of course," I said, kissing her forehead. She turned, and I followed her. She peeled off her dress as she walked. Beneath it she was naked: where her underwear had gone was anyone's guess, and something I supposed I wasn't allowed to know until later. I thought I saw a red, patchy

mark on her bottom, and shadows that were thrown across her skin as she walked looked like phantom bruises or signs of rough handling, but disappeared, or morphed into some other mark before disappearing again.

She looked, frustratingly, all cleaned-up.

She threw back the covers and climbed under them. "Can you pull the shades closed?" she said, sleepily. "And... wake me up... if it's... I dunno... past twelve. I guess."

And then, before I could ask whether I was allowed to sleep there, too, or say yes, or even close the blinds, she was asleep.

CHAPTER 6

I went in to wake April up at one pm, because she had, after all, told me to. Also, I couldn't take it anymore. I hadn't wanted to jerk off, in case April woke up and complained that she couldn't sleep. So I had gone for a run, which hadn't helped anything. Then I jerked off in the shower, and then I paced for hours.

She was sleeping unusually for her, on her back, a hand thrown next to her head on the pillow. Her hair was spread out around her head; she had evidently taken out her ponytail as she slept. She looked completely peaceful, totally comfortable in her dream world after whatever she had done.

Nothing like me.

I stretched out on the bed after taking off everything but my boxers, and looked at her. A part of me was infuriated by her contented sleep, but I knew I didn't really have a right to feel like that.

I brushed her cheek and she moved a hand to swipe whatever touched her away. She sighed, and turned on her side, facing me.

I stroked her hair, and she stirred, waking up.

I kissed her forehead, and her eyes fluttered open. She stretched, and yawned, and behaved as if it was an ordinary Saturday morning, and she had just overslept.

Then her eyes went wide. "What time is it?" she asked, hurriedly.

"Like one," I said. "But it's Saturday. Remember?"

April's eyes closed, and she smiled in relief, bringing a hand to her cheek and dragging it along her face before stretching.

"I can't wait any longer," I told her, moving my hands down her body.

April's eyes flew open, and they met mine. "Oh my God," she whispered.

I moved my hand between her thighs, slipping my pointer finger into her slit. Her pussy was moist, but my fingers still caught on her flesh, slightly rubbery to the touch. I gently slid my finger into her pussy, looking at her face. "I want you to tell me everything," I said. I curled my fingers up, searching for her g-spot, pressing my thumb against her clit.

April's eyes closed slightly and she made a sound that was almost like a purr, then turned to a squeak.

My breath caught in my chest, and I felt the now-familiar clutch of a raw, cold, hyper-arousing jealousy, so fierce and poisonous that my breath shook as I whispered, hoarsely: "Are you sore?"

April mewled in response, and something overcame me: I pushed deep inside of her with my finger and rubbed the patch of her sensitive channel, my thumb pressing against her clit. I was rewarded for my efforts by a wellspring of hot liquid, her pussy turning to a juicy gash within seconds.

I pushed April's arms up above her head and stroked them as I moved my hands down her body, pushing her biceps firmly against the pillow on my way down, an indication that I wanted her to leave them there. She did. I dragged my lips over her breasts, noting that they were puffy, red - someone (or more than one someone?) had enjoyed them intensely, enough that they were still distended.

I moved down her body, aware that April was tilting her head to watch me, her arms still suspended next to her head. When I reached the mound of her pussy, I could smell her excitement, but I had a new idea. I rose up to my knees and pushed her legs open, to get a good look at her and see for myself what her adventures had left behind on her body.

It briefly flashed through my mind that I was losing it - my mind, that is: what sane man wants desperately to see his wife's plundered gash, the swollen evidence of others having enjoyed her like only I was supposed to? What sane man feels disappointed that she has taken a shower and washed away the most visceral evidence of being intimate with someone else?

I didn't want to see it: the redness of her pussy lips, the evidence of abrasive rubbing against her soft skin, stabbed me in the heart. And yet I *did* want to see it; I wanted to probe it, to feel it for myself.

I pushed her legs open. "Spread your legs for me," I said, hearing myself say it before the thought even surfaced in my consciousness. April obeyed, her eyes hungrily watching me.

The outer lips of her pussy were reddened; her juices seeped from the engorged petals, down to her ass, and I peered at her eyelet, wondering if she had taken it there. How many cocks had she sucked last night, how many loads of cum had been deposited in her pussy and her ass?

I had known for certain in our previous adventures because I had been there, watching it all. Perversely, it was thrilling to have nothing in my

memory but the flash-drenched picture of her, some man behind her, his deeds before, at, and after that moment, a vague unknown.

"What did you do last night?" I asked her, sliding a finger between her outer lip and her clit, circling around it, sliding down again, withholding the pleasure of my touch from her.

April seemed reluctant to begin the story, her eyes begged me for something. Maybe she just wanted me to make her come, maybe she wanted me to save her from telling the story. Maybe she had been so very, very filthy that she actually felt contrite.

"I don't... know... where to start," April breathed.

"Who did you fuck? Who was there?" I asked. My cock was pressing painfully against my boxers, so I squirmed out of them without getting off of my calves. I touched the tip of my cock, where a huge drop of precum had been squeezed from the crown, and leaned over her to put my finger on her lips.

"It was Rog," she said. "And Jonny. And then... the guy."

"The guy," I repeated.

"I don't know his name still... the guy who wants the video. It was kind of like an audition."

Another cool stab of insane jealousy. Even if I had told her to do it, even if it was what we had agreed on. It still burned.

"So... what did you do?"

April squirmed underneath me. She closed her lips around my finger, and began to move her right arm down. I pressed it to the pillow beside her head. Touching her mouth, I looked at her. "Did he want you to suck their cocks?"

April nodded.

"And did you?"

"I did it like in the story," April said, and my cock throbbed against her thigh as I pictured April, as I already had so many times, as the protagonist of the story, on her knees, eyes meeting her kidnappers', mouth open for first one cock, and then the next. I could picture it perfectly, because I had seen their cocks, even seen their cocks in her mouth before. But not like that, one after the other.

"Did they come in your mouth?"

April paused, just long enough to make my cock throb again painfully. "Jonny did."

"And you swallowed it?"

April nodded. I pushed myself back up and guided my cock to her slit. She was soaking now, ripe and ready for me, but I stroked her clit with the tip of my cock. "Do you like swallowing Jonny's cum?" I asked, staring at her swollen pussy.

April didn't answer so I looked back up at her. She had the smile I had begun to love and fear on her lips: barely visible, impossible to decipher. She didn't answer. Or that was her answer. My heart felt wrenched.

"Keep going," I said.

"I... so, we did the part where the wife, you know, sucks both the guys. Then... uh, I did them both, you know... kind of like that night at Jonny's apartment. And the guy just watched."

"He just watched," I repeated.

April nodded. "But then..."

I couldn't help groaning a little.

"Then he asked me - the guy - if I knew how to, um..."

"Just say it," I whispered, because my voice was hoarse. I was staring at her mouth, trying not to let her feel the desperation that was gripping me. April's inability to talk about the filthy things she had done was charming, but at that moment I had a jealousy and lust squeezing my chest and my balls into oblivion.

"He asked if I knew how to... uh, throatfuck. And I said I never did that before..." April's eyes closed and she arched her back as I entered her, unable to wait to feel myself inside of her. I could picture her saying "I never did that before," just like she had so many times before. But with April, it seemed to be an invitation: she had never done it before, but she was strangely, surprisingly, willing to try.

I felt her squirm in some discomfort as I eased my cock into her pussy. She was so sore that I could feel it in her reaction, spreading through her limbs. She mewled softly, but ground against me, wanting more.

"Keep your legs spread for me," I told her. "And tell me what you did."

April spread her legs wider, and I sank deeper inside of her. "I said...uhn...that I, that I hadn't done that and then... oh, go slow, I'm so sore..."

"Is your pussy sore because you let Rog fuck it all night?"

April squirmed. "Uh-huh," she breathed.

"And did you like that?"

April met my eyes. "I liked it," she whispered. Her eyes were wide, almost like this story - of all the things, the story - shocked her senseless.

"So did Rog fuck your throat? Like Jonny did?"

I was fucking her slowly, and April was mewling and squirming beneath me: I didn't know how long I would last if she kept that up. "I can't... it was different," she said. "I can't believe what I did."

"You're going to tell me, though, April. Just tell me what he did."

I fucked her slowly, and she moaned under me, but I could tell she was craving it, even though she was sore. Whatever happened with April last night, however reluctant she had originally been, April was completely turned on by the memory of it.

"I put... my head down, over the side of the bed... and then this guy, the guy who wants the video, he told me to look at him. I can't... even... explain it."

"Try," I said, more harshly than I meant to.

"And then Rog said, open up... and just let me fuck you. That's what he did."

"And you did that," I groaned. My cock pulsed inside of her and I started to fuck her, feeling like I couldn't stop what was coming. April reached down, quicker than I could move to stop her, and wormed her hand between our bodies, clamping the base of my cock tightly.

My eyes went wide: the urge to come was not changed, but I could feel that my ability to do so was somehow blocked. Behind her hand, the pressure began to build... a flicker of fear traveled through my mind: would I ever be released from this torture? Would I have a heart attack first?

"Rog taught me that," April said, unprompted, grinning devilishly. "He does it so he can fuck me longer."

"Jesus," I groaned, as a wave of painful heat slammed into me. I looked between our bodies, pushing up so I could get a view of her hand clamped around my dick, her legs spread wide on either side of me.

April put her mouth close to my ear, so that her lips carved the consonants of the words she said next over the skin of my lobe, her breath traveling over my neck in slippery caresses.

"Rog fucked me while that guy looked at me, and Jonny kept saying, look right at him, so I did. And then he started fucking me so hard I couldn't breathe. Jonny told him to stop, just before he came."

I groaned. I was sweating like a pig at this point, and a drop of my sweat fell onto April's lips.

"Where did he come?" I managed to ask.

April ran her tongue over her upper lip. "April," I groaned, just as she began to tell me:

"On my face. In my hair."

She released the base of my cock and drew her fingers up to her throat. "Here."

"God, April," I groaned.

She moved her hand back down to grip me. "Then Jonny told me to stay like that, and the guy asked Jonny to say something. And Jonny started fucking me in my pussy, and told me to rub all the cum on my tits into my skin."

"And you did?" My stomach was ice-cold, and my cock was near bursting against April's grip. She squeezed tighter, and the pain went through my whole body, even to the back of my eyes. "I rubbed it all in, and this guy just watched, while Jonny fucked me until he came."

"God, April," I groaned, pushing her hand away. "Fuck, that's so hot, that's so dirty..."

April mewled again.

"Are you sore?" I asked her. "Just from that?"

She shook her head. "It went on all night... a long time. This guy wanted Jonny to say all this stuff, ask him if he still loved me even though I was a dirty slut. Jonny fucked me and Rog fucked me, then this guy, he uh..."

"God, April," I said, "I'm going to come..."

"I might have done something bad," she said, as if she really did believe it. "But I figured... it was for the audition... I didn't know how to say no..."

"April..."

"The guy... he wanted to eat me out after... you know... after they fucked me."

I wanted to say something, anything - ask her another question, keep her talking, but it was too late. I yelled and gripped her head as I fucked her hard, coming harder than I had ever come in my life, the image of "this guy" eating out her sodden, cream-filled cunt while Jonny and Rog looked on.

It was too late when I remembered that she was so sore, I slowed my assault on her, but I felt her pussy quivering, her body warming up for an orgasm.

So even though my cock felt raw, and every thrust seared me intensely with too much pleasure, so much that it hurt, I fucked her slowly while I extracted the rest of the story from her.

"The guy" ate her out, and made her come. And then they fucked her again: both at the same time, like they had on our "date" with Jonny. And then Rog took her ass, with her on her hands and knees licking Jonny's dirty cock.

And after all that, this guy wanted to eat her ass, and suck all the cum from it.

April closed her eyes to tell me this last part, and her body shook around me as she ground her pelvis against mine, muscles rigid as an orgasm gripped her. I could not be sure which part of her memories, or what we were doing here, had sent her over the edge.

I collapsed next to her, and looked over at her for a long time. Her eyes stayed closed, the smile on her lips remained uninterpretable, and I realized I, too, was tired after that long night. At some point I closed my eyes, and then I fell asleep.

When I woke up it was nearly six pm., and April was taking a shower.

*

There were a lot of things I wanted to talk to April about. I assumed she had gotten the job, that her audition had been successful. It excited me: there was no filthier, more exciting fantasy I could cook up from my own imagination than April making a video about having to gangbang her way to freedom, specifically for a man who wanted to imagine his own wife doing the same. The fact that she was getting paid, even, was a turn-on. It was layers and layers of fantasy material, and it was really happening... I should have been thrilled.

But instead, I felt utterly disoriented. I both did and didn't want April to actually do any of these things. I wanted her to have never done them, I felt guilty for pushing her to them, I felt a little betrayed that she actually had. And the hot, filthy wetness of her pussy whenever she fucked other

men, and the hungry look in her eyes - and that smile, the one I wasn't sure of - made me think that maybe April was slipping out of my control.

If she had *ever* even been under my control.

I knew I could tell April not to do it. But telling myself that felt a little bit like an alcoholic telling himself he knew he could just tell himself not to have another drink. Sure, he *could*. Technically.

But I knew I wouldn't ask April not to go through with it.

Did I want her to back out herself?

Maybe.

Did I want her to go through with it?

Definitely.

I knew that there was something else that I wanted, something that I couldn't ever have: some kind of full, complete, total confirmation of how April actually felt about all of this, some seal that guaranteed her loyalty to me, that promised that all of this was just fantasy and fun, and that she would not be consumed by it and leave me.

Also, I wanted to make it clear to April that there were still lines she couldn't cross. What they were, I had no idea. But I was not the kind of guy who wanted these uber alpha men to fuck my wife and then make *me* eat their cum out of her ass.

Which left me with the final, most disturbing question: was that what April wanted? If it was, would I do it? Was this all about me or was it about April, too? Was it fair to deny her something she really wanted, if she had crossed this line for me?

The problem, of course, was finding the right time and place to bring it all up.

Of all the people in the world, I did not expect Lilith to be the one who would facilitate such a discussion, and "business-minded" was not the first word that came to my mind when I thought of Lilith.

So that's why, when Lilith asked us to meet her out for "business cocktails" at the extremely absurd - for Lilith - hour of 6pm a week after April's "audition," I was unconvinced she would even show, and less convinced than that if she did, the "business" end of things was going to be attended to in any real way.

I found myself staring, forgetting to blink until my eyes were raw, at Lilith, over the candles at an upscale, cool, but very boring and definitively un-trendy bar in a part of town frequented by lawyers and people who worked in the financial district. The candles were shabby-chic from two decades ago, the kind of thing you don't find anywhere anymore, orange and red glass goblets with cheap white wax poured into the bottom, ubiquitous at dives and Mexican restaurants up until twenty years ago. The candles gave the whole scene that much more of an air of surrealism as Lilith, in an actual suit, with her hair twisted up into an actually professional-looking bun, read from a contract her lawyer had evidently drafted and which, according to Lilith, we were free to have looked-over by our own attorney.

She didn't even look like a stripper dressed as a businesswoman, which is what I would have pictured if someone had told me Lilith would meet me at a bar dressed as a businesswoman. The suit was expensive, well-made, of a totally respectable length, and was not going to rip off her body.

"So... that's about it, you can have a look over all this stuff, and then get it signed, if you need a notary, I have a stamp -"

"You're a notary?" I said, bewildered.

She looked up at me. "It's handy."

She folded the papers into a nice leather file case and slid them across the table to us. "So there you are. I figure if you can get it signed by Monday, we can get going and start filming next week. We can, uh... work around your schedule, April. I have this stuff pretty figured out, I figure we can do it maybe five long takes. It's really about the guys, and Rog and Jonny are pros."

I opened my mouth, intending to say okay, but instead made a choking sound. Rog and Jonny being "pros" had so many connotations that I couldn't begin to make sense of, right then, given what I'd let them do with my wife.

April opened the file, looking at the papers with interest. Then she looked at me.

Lilith watched us both with interest.

Then she sighed and rolled her eyes at the ceiling. "You guys talked about all this right? Laid down some rules? You have your own contract, right?"

We looked at her.

"Jesus," Lilith muttered, and rummaged in her purse. I was expecting whatever she pulled out to be related to us, but instead it was her phone, which she checked, and then dropped back into her purse. "You guys have to have an agreement," she said, in the tone of a real estate agent explaining we needed to have a mortgage secured, or some kind of fixed ceiling as we looked for a house. She shook her head. "What have you been doing so far? Just winging it?"

She tapped the folder when we didn't answer. "Look. Guys. This kind of money doesn't come around every day in this business. And definitely not for something that you don't have to put on the fucking internet. So get your shit together."

I had no idea what to say. I was still getting my head around the fact that Lilith was dressed in normal clothing. And that the state evidently felt Lilith was responsible enough to be a notary.

Her eyes met mine. It was hard not to look away. "You go on hotwife forums and all that," she said accusatorily. "What's the number one thing guys say there?"

April looked over at me, and I held up a hand, as if doing so would maybe erase what Lilith had just said. I didn't really want April knowing the depths of my fantasy, and how much time I had dedicated to it before any of this had actually happened.

"They say, have an agreement," Lilith said, like she was teaching second grade. "You guys are such noobs. The one thing I've learned about *any* of this stuff, is you gotta have a really clear contract. Everybody is fine if they know exactly what they can and can't do. But if you don't say that at the beginning, then you get problems."

April looked a little red and covered her mouth with the palm of her hand twisted backward, so she could lean on her elbow. "I mean... it just kind of happened."

Lilith looked amused, and her devious sexuality glinted beneath that professional exterior for a moment. Her eyes went back and forth from one of us to the other, and my chest felt tight: she was going to spill everything, and spoil everything, and make April cry.

Instead, she said plainly. "Well. Now you're going into something where you know exactly what's going to happen. So if I were you, I'd have a real talk about it."

"Like...?" I said.

"Like, Thomas... can April do anything and everything, if it evolves that way? Or do you draw the line somewhere?"

"Uh..." I said.

Lilith grinned. "Can someone take a shit in April's mouth?"

April made a face and said, "Jesus, Lilith!"

"Lilith," I said exasperated.

"That's just to make the point: there are lines you don't want her to cross. So say what they are, and then we'll all know, and nothing will get out of hand. But if you don't mind me saying, you guys are playing a dangerous game just winging it." She looked at April. "I'm surprised," she said, "and... it's none of my business the rest of the time," she pointed down at the contract, "but this? This is business. So now it *is* my business. I say, get yourselves straightened out."

Lilith's phone was ringing again, and she removed it from her purse. This time, she answered it, holding up a finger to tell us to be quiet.

"Baby," she said breathily, "I'm just out shopping. You want to call me back in an hour?"

Lilith laughed, like a bimbo, and then said, "You know I can't do that in a *grocery* store. Okay... okay... can't wait."

She dropped the phone in her purse after sweeping her fingers over the screen rapidly. "Forgot to log out," she explained, explaining nothing.

When she looked back up at us, she was back in her deadly professional mode. "Okay. So I'm leaving that here. I'll send you a list of things to talk about if you can't think of it yourselves. But get it sorted out. I recommend putting things in writing. I gotta run. Call me if you need anything."

*

"Wow," I said, after a long silence that followed Lilith's departure.

April inhaled slowly. She looked at me. "I don't know..." she said, in her "troubled" voice. It sounds nothing like Marge Simpson's voice, and yet when she uses it, I commit it to my memory as that voice. "Maybe we shouldn't be doing this. Now that it's all here in..." she flipped the folder open, "you know, black and white... I'm not really sure this is the best idea."

I put my hand on hers. I was thinking that she was starting to doubt her desire to do something that radical, or repeat those filthy acts with Rog and the "real pro" Jonny. Maybe she just didn't want to commit to being filmed. And the truth was, as much as this excited me, as sweet as the pain was, as enjoyable as it seemed to be living out my fantasy, if she wanted to back down, I sort of wanted a way out for us.

Part of me did, anyway.

"Honey, look. If you feel like anything about this is too much... just, we don't have to do it. You can say 'no way' to anything here. That's what Lilith said, wasn't it? Anything you want taken out of the script... it sounds like... you just tell her and they negotiate it."

April was still looking upset.

"Or you don't have to do it at all," I continued.

April put her hands to her forehead. "It's just so much... money," she said, at last. "But it's..." her voice trailed off. Then she looked at me earnestly. "I mean, technically, this makes me a prostitute, right?"

I sighed. The word prostitute was zigging and zagging through my body, pinging my cock, and it was hard not to shudder with pleasure and shock at the same time. "I think it... technically, I think it makes you a... well, an actress."

April gave this some thought. Laughed, timidly. Put her hands to her temples again. Chewed her lip. "A *porn* actress," she said softly.

She stared at the contract.

Then she looked at me. "What should I do?"

What was I supposed to say? I didn't know. I didn't want her doing anything she wasn't comfortable with, but then, this whole thing had really been about getting April to do something she wasn't "comfortable with" to begin with. I couldn't read her: was she really, really not okay with it? Or was she just *hesitant*?

I knew what *I* wanted, if April's feelings were taken out of the equation. But they couldn't be, and it seemed like they couldn't be known for certain.

"What are you thinking?" April whispered loudly, her hands still propping up her head at the temples.

"I think... if you don't have a problem playing again with Rog and Jonny, and you make sure you have it all set up to only do what you're comfortable doing... then, why not? Why not get paid for it?"

April's eyes went wide. "I know," she admitted. "It's just... it seems so..." she flipped the pages of the contract with one hand, looking at them like they were the devil. "What if it ever, I don't know, got out?"

"I think the contract is pretty airtight," I said, having skimmed it and not *really* knowing what I was talking about. "He has to pay you if the video isn't kept private." April still looked troubled. "Lilith says she does this a lot, and she's never had a problem with it."

April frowned at me.

"This is a guy who has fifty grand to spend on this kind of thing," I said. "Just to make a video to amuse himself. I don't really see him wanting to sell it or put it on the internet or anything... why would he? You're not famous, there isn't any money in it. And you can sue him... the contract says right there he has to pay you damages."

April looked up at the ceiling. I leaned back and took a sip of my drink. I was talking some good game, and I was pretty impressed with myself.

If it had been anything else, if I hadn't been so obsessed with this myself, I would have of course advised her, "better safe than sorry." There were all kinds of things that could go wrong, and I knew that; it was my profession to think about the way things could go wrong. But the part of my mind that was talking to April now was not professional, was not intellectual, was not risk-averse. The part of me speaking to April at that moment was single-minded, and dark, and the one thing that part of me wanted more than anything was for this to all take place.

Not because I was particularly comfortable with it, not because it was *my* fantasy: my perverted mind had never come up with anything remotely like this.

But now that the possibility existed that my wife, April, would star in a commissioned porno, participate in really filthy acts, and get paid for it, there was nothing else that I wanted to happen more.

April's chest moved up and down rapidly.

I slid the file toward myself. "Tell you what," I said. "Put it out of your mind. Sleep on it."

April looked at the file, and then smiled. "Yeah," she said. "Like that's going to happen."

We stayed and had a few too many drinks, and I pulled out all the stops telling stories, making jokes, and "taking April's mind off it." We ended up having a really nice evening out. We edged our chairs closer together and talked trash about all the lawyers and their suits and how stuffy they all seemed.

I vowed to April to just let her think about what she wanted: no pressure from me, whatsoever. She had my support, whatever she wanted to do.

So we had to take a cab home, again, which was a pain in my ass the next morning, because I had to cab it back to the bar, get my car, and then drag myself to work. April called in to her job at the bank, where she worked part-time while getting in her clinical hours for her physical therapy certification.

And I kept my vow; I didn't bring it up. I was going to let April make this decision, and support her 100% no matter what she decided. Because I was 100% behind her doing it, and 100% against it.

That, my friends, is the true definition of ambivalence.

*

I don't know, and I suppose I never will, what went on in April's mind for the next few days. I know that she talked to Lilith. She was on the phone with her one night when I came home, and said, in a low voice I take it I wasn't meant to hear: "He's home, I have to go."

She smiled when I walked into the kitchen and asked who she was talking to. She shrugged. "Just Lilith," she said.

I could have asked for more information. "And...?" I could have said. But I didn't. There was something of a method to this particular madness I was exhibiting. In a way, I wanted April to take control of his whole situation, so that I could tell myself I was not responsible for it, if I got the outcome I both feared and desired.

I could have sent a message to Lilith, and I have no doubt she would have told me anything I wanted to know, if it helped her cause, which now seemed to be largely business-oriented. Lilith was neither sinister nor the opposite: she was maddeningly, sexily neutral, concerned only with her own mercenary desires.

It suddenly made sense that she could buy a house in that neighborhood.

But several days later, April brought the contract to me, signed, and notarized by the multi-talented Lilith. I was sitting in bed with a laptop on my lap, and she tossed it recklessly onto the chair. "I'm going to do it," she said, standing over me, looking like a stranger. "He's upped his price by 10K. Lilith says it's absurd money. It makes sense. We're doing this kind of thing anyway, right? So why not?"

I stared at the papers, the words taking on the shape of a foreign alphabet.

April climbed onto the bed with me and maneuvered herself onto my lap. "If you don't want me to, then I won't," she said, her hand slipping between our legs and brushing over my cock, which could not lie. I had sat up, my hands on her back, working their way beneath her silky nightshirt, and my eyes probably looked vacant to match my half-open mouth.

"But if you wanted me to sleep with Jonny again anyway," she whispered next to my ear, "we might as well make money doing it."

April, who rarely takes the lead, pushed me onto my back and freed my cock from my boxers. She played with the slickness of the precum that oozed from my crown for a moment, grinning, while her free hand did something with her pajama bottoms - a pair of silky shorts - that I didn't see because I was staring at her face, wondering who she was, unable to think about anything else except the burn of her gaze, the pad of her thumb rubbing my swollen dick and threatening to make me come with that motion alone.

Her thighs squeezed me, their muscles glorious and taut, and then she was sliding onto my cock. The silky seam of her pajamas rubbed against my dick, and I knew it was slightly painful, but I felt that from a long way away. Her pussy engulfed my dick, and her mouth opened as she sank her weight onto me.

When I was as deep inside her as I could go, she closed her eyes and ground against me. I finally managed to move my limbs and gripped her arms, which pressed me into the bed. Her pussy was soaked, and as she rode me, it gripped me tightly, hotly.

I stared at April, wondering what she was thinking. My boxers and her pajamas were caught between us, grating against my cock, soaking up

her juices. But she seemed to not notice, and only made herself heavier and wetter, rubbing her body against mine, mind somewhere else entirely.

I stared down at the tangled fabric, glimpses of juicy flesh appearing in the folds, and then disappearing, then back at April's face. It was upturned, caught in a moment of rapture, perhaps moments from her orgasm. She was thinking of something else, though, and the moment I saw that clearly, cum was spurting into her pussy and stars began to invade my eyesight from both sides.

My wife - this was a thought that went on endlessly and yet only for a few moments - is going to be in a porno, getting fucked every way I can imagine.

My wife.

April Snow.

Below this cycle of thoughts was a sound, that only later would I recognize as a wild, feline mewl, leaving April's mouth as she came - a sound she had never made, not once, in the history of our married life.

CHAPTER 7

The filming began about a week later. Apparently, the suite of rooms in Lilith's immense basement were "set up" for this kind of thing. I suppose I concluded, at that point, that Lilith was a pornographer, and while part of me wanted all the details of her financial life, another part of me knew she would never share them. Lilith, when asked any sort of direct question, possessed a unique talent for blowing you off in such a way that you forgot you'd even asked a question.

"Are you nervous?" I asked April, lying in bed the night before. We weren't having sex, because Jonny had told her to keep herself "untouched" for a few days, so that the first scenes would look more realistic.

I had a sense that Jonny was just being an asshole, directly to me, but I was trying not to let myself get carried away with paranoia, which was becoming a problem for me.

April squirmed a little, and I'm sure she didn't mean for it to be as seductive as it was. "Of course," she said. "I mean... Jo- those guys are being really, uh, professional about it, but it's, you know..."

I wondered if April thought I hadn't heard her start that comment with the first syllable of Jonny's name. *I'm sure Jonny is being real professional*, I thought.

I didn't want to say stuff like that, because I very much wanted April to go film a porno the next day, and there was even a part of me that wanted Jonny to be "real professional" about it, and maybe a little unprofessional. There was a part of me that wanted to sit around all day in my office, thinking about how Jonny was greasing my wife up, fucking her, telling her she was doing a good job, sweet-talking her into doing something she wanted to axe from the script.

"Listen," I told April. "Remember that you don't have to do anything you don't want to, okay?"

"I know," April said. "It's just... I don't know what it will be like. So... I just don't know, you know, what will happen. If it will all be... like, you're *sure* you're okay with whatever?"

"I told you I am," I said, trying not to sound slightly annoyed. I kissed her forehead. "You just have to tell me about it. And you have to be okay with it. That's all. I promise."

My cock was rock-hard. I moved my fingers under April's silky camisole. "Are you *sure* he said you can't, you know... loosen up a little? Practice?"

April giggled and pushed my hand away. "I'm sure," she said. Then she looked me in the eye. I couldn't tell how devious she was being, or if she knew what it did to me inside when she said:

"He told me, *he'd know*."

I tried again to put my hand under her shirt, and April resisted, but with less force. "Oh yeah. And then what?"

April shook her head. I found her breast and rubbed her nipple to erection, then started to squeeze lightly.

"*Stop*," April complained. "I'm supposed to look like I haven't had sex for weeks. It's in the script."

Jesus.

I moved my hand down to her silky shorts. Her face was flushed, her body responding to my touch. "No sex," I said. "Does it count... if someone just maybe..." I ducked under the covers and pulled her shorts with me as I positioned my head between her legs.

"Thomas..." April whispered, putting her hands on my head.

I didn't bother finishing my sentence. I worked my tongue between her pussy lips. She had gone for a wax yesterday, and every last trace of her hair was gone. Only glassy-smooth contours of her soft flesh, with her gash between them, remained. I slipped my tongue between her lips and through the rubbery outside, until I tasted her leaking tangy juices.

Her legs were close together, and I admired the novelty of this new tack... almost like prying open a woman for the first time. I drove my tongue into her folds until I found her pulsing clit, then worked on it until the muscles of her thighs went limp and she spread open for me. Her fingers dug into my hair, and her body went rigid as I rhythmically sucked and teased her bud.

I lifted my head just before she began to tip over the edge, and she howled, looking down at me, pushing the covers away frantically. "Are you sure...?" I asked.

"Please, Thomas," she panted. "Don't be a dick."

April had never said anything like that to me before. She fell back and closed her eyes, pushing my head toward her pussy. When my lips closed

around her clit she pressed me hard into her pussy, rubbing my face all over her, bucking against me, making herself come.

All the while, I let my twisted fantasies run wild: Jonny wasn't even making this porno, there would be no money, he was just leading my wife on, telling her to deny me the pleasure of her body so that he could use her in every conceivable way the next day and know that I had been denied.

It was pretty screwed up, but April came wildly and dug her nails into my shoulders, and when I rose to my knees, I had only to stroke my cock twice to explode all over her bare, pristine pussy, that we were leaving untouched for the director of her porno.

It was disturbing. And hot as fuck.

*

I don't know what I envisioned those days of making that film were going to be like, but I certainly did not envision the torture that they actually became.

I had to work. It was Monday, and I had a real job. The morning was much like any other morning: incredibly mundane. The banality of it clashed with the excitement of what April was about to do, and I left the house feeling sick to my stomach, but smiling anyway. April made me coffee, and we looked at each other strangely over the counter and our phones, both of us lost in our thoughts. April didn't change out of her nightshirt - she'd put on a different shirt after our adventure the night before. She was going back to bed because she didn't have to be "there" until eleven.

"Okay," I said, or I remember saying, as if it happened in a dream. I kissed April on the cheek, and then thought better of it and kissed her on the lips. She seemed distracted. Her mouth moved beneath my lips but in a way that felt perfunctory. I told myself not to be crazy, and I repeated this thought to myself when I looked into her eyes and judged them to be distant. "What time will you be home?" I asked.

April looked surprised by the question. She was thinking about something else, not listening to me. "What time...?" she repeated. That was my trick: repeating something so it seemed like I was paying attention.

I wanted to shake her. I was angry, nervous, feeling lost already. It wasn't fair, she would naturally be a little preoccupied with her thoughts the

first day on the set of a porno. I knew all that, but I couldn't help the feeling from eating away at me.

"What time will you be home, do you think?" I repeated.

"Oh... yeah. I actually have no idea... I assume you can't go, like... all day with this. That's what Jonny - I mean, that's just common sense, right?"

Why did she keep saying Jonny's name, and then trying to cover it up? It irked me. Did she think that I didn't hear it? Did she think her bashful cover-ups didn't make everything "Jonny" seem worse than it probably was?

"Okay, well... text me when you know more," I said. "And, um... good luck." I kissed her again, and savored the distant removal of her return kiss. "Don't forget to tell me everything about it," I reminded her.

April smiled and shook her head. "Of course."

I dwelled on that for a long time, all the way to work. In fact, I missed my exit because I was spaced out, absorbed in my mind by the way April had kissed me, picking it apart, trying to find a way that it was a sign that she was under Jonny's spell somehow, and also trying to find a way that it was not like that at all.

I missed a left turn after that, and got lost in a sea of warehouses not two blocks from where I work, but which I had never even once thought of driving around to see. I ended up being fifteen minutes late into the office.

Not that it mattered. I suppose I did something work-related. I spoke to people on the phone and untangled a big shipping disaster, but I did these things in the far outer reaches of my consciousness. Inside, at my core, I was replaying April's distant kiss, April telling me she couldn't have sex, April stopping herself from saying Jonny's full name, April on her hands and knees, gagging on Rog's cock, Jonny holding his shaft in his hand and inspecting her pussy before mashing it to a pulp with his fat gnarly dick.

I checked my phone constantly, but no message arrived from April.

And while I didn't want to be a psycho, I couldn't help but imagine the worst: April fucking and fucking and fucking all day long, doing scenes over and over again, coming so hard she passed out, her body limp on a mattress, her breasts rolling up and down as Rog and Jonny took turns fucking her full of even more cum.

Be home in about an hour.

That was all I received from April, around six pm.

At seven I began to get agitated. Minutes ticked by, the phone didn't ring or buzz, no messages came in, and April did not come home. Another half hour dragged by, and I sent her a message.

You get held up?

It was kind of supposed to be a joke. Edgy, ha-ha, funny. But inside I was blowing a fuse. I knew I had no right to, I knew April would be home any minute, I knew I had agreed to all of this and she wasn't doing anything we hadn't agreed upon.

But I was losing my shit when, at 6:53, a shiny black car, make and model unknown, rolled to stop in front of our house and the passenger door opened.

I recognized April's arm, her thigh - she was the passenger in the car. She had her hand on the doorhandle, but she was talking in an animated way. She laughed: I could see the bottom of her face, her wide-open mouth. She leaned toward the driver's side of the car. I couldn't see what she was doing. It didn't last long, whatever it was, and deep down inside I knew it was just a peck on the cheek. Jonny's hand slid over her elbow.

My temples pulsed with my elevated blood pressure and I literally started seeing red. One part of my brain was communicating with my animal-brain.

Thomas, it was saying, you have literally watched this guy fuck your wife in the ass. You can't lose your shit because he cradled her elbow and gave her a quick peck goodnight after fucking her in a porno all day. That's insane.

It was insane. I was stomping toward the door, unable to account for my feelings, ready to throw it wide open and charge down the steps to...

What?

Pull my wife inside the house like a crazed maniac because the guy she was fucking - because I had given her permission to fuck him - had the audacity to keep her out late and kiss her on the cheek?

That wasn't it.

It was April smiling. Laughing. Having a great time in the car with Jonny after a long hard day of filming a porno. *That* was what got me.

It was absurd. I stared at the door, kicked it, and then stomped back into the kitchen to make myself a drink and start pretending that I was just relaxing with a whiskey while I waited for April, instead of acting like a middle-school boy on a hormone rampage.

I sat down, took out my phone, and opened up the front page of a newspaper I didn't have a subscription to, after cracking open a beer and chugging it.

April was through the door moments later.

I stared at the phone as she walked into the kitchen from the foyer.

"Oh, hey," she said, her voice surprised.

"Oh, hey," I said. "You're home."

I looked at April. She had taken a shower; her hair was damp. I knew I had asked her not to do that, I knew I had confessed to her why I didn't want her to. And yet she had. I felt rage blinding me again.

"I'm sorry I'm late... and, uh..." she looked down at herself, as if noticing for the first time that she had showered. "I just *had* to take a shower. We had some, uh, food after afterward and it would have been crazy sitting there... you know."

And then she yawned, holding her hand up to her mouth.

The room sort of spun around me for a few moments. I had twenty or so things I wanted to say, but couldn't figure out where to start with any of them. I felt like I was looking at my life from some distant point outside of it, and everything was a copy of itself, with something slightly off about it.

Especially April.

"So you... already ate dinner?" I asked her. It felt like the world's stupidest question once it came out of my mouth, and I wanted to take it back. I didn't know what you say to your wife when she comes home from her first day shooting an exclusive porno, but I knew it wasn't the question I had just asked.

April nodded, stifling another yawn, nothing about her expression betraying that she thought the question was out of the ordinary. "Listen," she said, "I had no idea this was going to be so tiring -"

"Yeah, God, I'm sorry," I started babbling. "That's not what I meant to, I meant to ask you, how did everything... go?"

April rubbed her left eye. "It's... not what I expected."

I was crossing the room now, not sure whether April wanted me to be concerned, or what she meant by that. I pulled her close to me and kissed

her forehead. "What do you mean?"

April shook her head and smiled. Her eyes really did seem drowsy, her lids fluttering in slow, bedroommy blinks. "No, not anything bad, just... it's different. It's a lot more work, I guess." She leaned against me. "Than I thought," she added. "I think I just need to go to bed. Is that okay?"

The taut string of sharp, burning wire that was my jealousy vibrated throughout me, slicing and cauterizing, a pain throughout my torso that made me feel like I was going to disintegrate.

No, it wasn't okay if she went to bed. That wasn't what I had envisioned at all. I wanted details, I wanted to know what she had been doing, who she ate dinner with, what they talked about, what scenes she had done, how many men she had pleased today. I wanted to know why Jonny was driving her around, what he said to her in the car, if something more than just this professional relationship was beginning to simmer between them.

But I also didn't want to be a dick. Of course it was fine if she went to bed: she was only involved in this because of me, and my fantasies, and because she wanted to buy a house and an opportunity had knocked where I had failed.

"Of course," I said. "You want me to run you a bath or something?"

I was only asking this because I hoped to repeat what had happened after her "audition." It was a selfish question more than a selfless one, and deep down inside I knew that when I asked it.

But that didn't stop me from flying into an inner rage, and despair, when she said, "Oh, man, I really just need to hit the hay. I think it's a good bet that the whole week will be like this." She smiled at me, turning her face up to look at me. "But then..." She smiled again, and kissed me with a dry, quick, perfunctory kiss on the lips.

"Yeah, sure, okay," I said, and maybe I threw in some other affirmations for good measure. I was cool-cool-cool with it. Whatever.

"Just... uh, do you need anything?"

"No," she said, smartly.

"You okay with everything?" I asked.

"I'm just tired," she said, a little snip in her voice. "I promise. Really. I just want to go to bed."

Alone, she seemed to say without saying.

"Yeah. No, of course. Okay. I will... I'm going to, uh, eat dinner..."

"Okay," she said, and turned toward the hallway.

I watched her go, thinking that our conversation seemed horrible and stale, that I wanted something *else* but I didn't know what it was, or if April could give it to me.

I didn't eat, just had a few beers and sat in the dark kitchen staring out the window, aroused and jealous and confused and disappointed, angry at myself for being angry at April for not being more... something... when she got home. I knew I was being ridiculous.

I pointed at my reflection in the sliding glass door, a grayish blob, backlit by the LED stove light and warped by a smudge that had no explanation for being there. "You, sir," I told my reflection, "are ridiculous."

When I went to the bedroom, April was asleep on her stomach, like she had come home from a party and managed only to get her jeans off before passing out, limbs akimbo, face-down on the bed.

I crawled in next to her, leaned over and smelled her. She smelled like soap and not much else. Her underwear was crimson, cotton, and hiked up a little over her left buttcheek. She had a white t-shirt on and seemed to have removed her bra without taking off the shirt. She looked like a nice, suburban professional wife, pretty, fresh from the shower, tired after too much yoga or a pink wine party with some girlfriends that got out of hand. Her parted lips formed a perfect "oh," like the mouth on a doll, and beneath her freshly scrubbed eyelids her cornflower eyes moved as she dreamed.

Sound asleep, conscience evidently no barrier to dreaming peacefully. She looked like April Snow, my wife.

But now, as I thought of her name and the fresh spring day it conjured, the syllables took on a sinister tone and sounded more like a porn star's name, as if they had always been that.

I turned out the light without doing any of the things I so desperately wanted to: slide my fingers beneath her red panties and feel the shape of her body, find where it had changed, touch some evidence of her wild day. Lying there beneath the cotton sheets and in the soapy scent of her body, I could swing from one end of my fantasy to the other - on one end, this was all a dream; on the other, my wife slept peacefully because she was, deep down inside, the sinister, slutty embodiment of her name, and she always had been.

The ceiling turned gray, an air compressor came on, it faded to black, and I fell asleep, still swinging from one extreme to the other.

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The second day of filming went much like the first. I woke up early, went to the shower after deliberating whether or not to try and get April to wake up and do something, anything, with me... something like the night before her first day of filming. I decided against it.

When I got out of the shower, sour bed was empty. I found her in the kitchen, wearing a robe, rubbing her eyes, yawning, and pouring me a cup of coffee.

She yawned loudly as she handed it to me. "I think I'm going to go back to bed," she said. Her eyes were watering. She walked around the counter and kissed me on the cheek. "Don't kiss me, I haven't brushed my teeth," she said. She dropped her hand to my leg as she turned around. "I should be home around the same time," she said.

"You want dinner?" I asked her retreating form.

She spun around, hands in the pockets of her robe. "Can you text me?" she asked. "I think Lilith gets us take-out, it's kind of a thing since we don't... you know, eat all day really."

"Okay," I said, hoping I didn't sound too on-edge.

By the end of the second day, I wanted to pull the plug on the whole thing. I wouldn't, I knew: it would make the first few days of filming, and whatever filthy things April had done, unknowable to me, for one thing, and also totally pointless financially. But hardly a minute went by that I didn't have a terrible sinking feeling in my chest and wish that I could go back in time and undo everything. Have April all to myself again.

I *had* a good thing, and I had fucked it up.

The days went by, blending into each other. Alone at night, because April went to bed very early and almost immediately fell asleep, I re-read the script and the book several times. It did nothing to ease my paranoia; it only inflamed it. April was slipping away from me, turning into a porn star, falling for Jonny's charms, enjoying herself so much that she would want to leave me and make more money with Lilith. She would discover that she had wanted to be a raging slut all her life, but tire of her husband and having to account for what she was doing, asking for permission, getting approval. She was going to leave me and hook up with Jonny, who would be her sleazy pimp-daddy, taking her to "auditions" and pushing her to

perform more and more obscene sex acts, which she would discover she loved.

The rational man inside of me tried to reason with my paranoia, but that rational person decayed quickly, until I could no longer even hear his voice.

The following week became a series of nightmare days. I tried to work, but found myself getting behind on everything imaginable. I wasn't listening to clients or my boss, I found myself having done tasks poorly and not remembering having done them at all.

And April, with each passing day, seemed to slip further and further through my fingers. She was always tired, never into talking about what was happening "on set." I was left to imagine it, to feed on the promise that when everything was done, she would tell me about it.

It became a soup of arousal and resentment.

I remember snippets of arguments, April yawning and seemingly disinterested.

"The deal was, you would tell me everything..."

"I don't see why you need me to tell you everything, if you're just going to watch the video once it's made..."

"It's just... it's not even that hot, between scenes, while we get set up. Half the time we aren't even filming, they're just moving stuff around and getting ready..."

"So, maybe I want to hear about that..."

"You don't. It's really just... not... all that exciting...it's a lot of waiting."

"It must be exciting, if you're tired at the end of the night..."

I didn't believe her.

It's not that I didn't want to. It's not even that I thought she was lying. It just was actually impossible for me to believe that "sitting around, waiting..." to be fucked in the ass by Jonny could possibly be "not that exciting."

It was exciting as hell to me.

The weeks dragged on, a fog of all the feelings I just described.

And then April was home one evening when I arrived.

CHAPTER 8

"Hey," I said, genuinely surprised. I had been coming home later than usual, stopping to eat somewhere by myself, at the bar, a man in a suit with no wife or girlfriend, not even drinking that much. I read pity in the faces of people who surrounded me, but I suspect I was just imagining things. Even with these deviations from my schedule, April was rarely home before me, or even near the same time. It seemed she got home later and later every day.

April was clad in a new sweatsuit. I mention that it was new because it was *sexy*, a sexy crimson pair of sweatpants that hugged her figure and a sweatshirt with a wide neck that revealed most of her shoulders and, if she leaned over, would fall open and show me everything.

She was standing behind the counter with her hands folded on the surface, hair damp and combed, lips enticingly red, and face freshly-scrubbed. Her expression was one of doubt and uncertainty, and my heart fell through my feet when I saw it.

It was happening: she was going to tell me that what I had been suspecting was, in fact, true: she loved being a porn star, she loved Jonny's cock and Lilith's seedy world, she wanted to leave me for a better lover, for the money, for the excitement.

'Are you done filming?' I asked, my voice shaky and low. Any question to deflect, to draw out the time so that April wouldn't be able to tell me whatever she had to tell me. Any way to keep the inevitable from actually happening.

"Yeah," April said, distracted. Her eyes were focused on something behind me, maybe the wall. She was thinking: I had seen this face before, any time she had something to tell me that she believed I would receive as bad news. But always before it had been something escapable... an unpaid parking ticket that had devolved into a bench warrant, a fender-bender, her forgetting to mail something important.

What lingered in her thoughts now could be anything from a terrifying range of possibilities.

She touched her lip, picking absent-mindedly at a tiny piece of dry skin.

I was falling... falling... inside my mind I reached for any coherent thought, anything to say, any question to ask to delay whatever April needed to say to me. Maybe if I could just keep talking, she would forget it.

"You want dinner tonight? I can go back out and grab something -"

"I have a... we have, a, um, not a problem really so much as... a change of plans."

I was standing there with my laptop bag in one hand. My fingers loosened and it fell with a thud, a good impression of my heart.

April met my eyes. "It's my fault," she began.

Time stopped for me. I suppose April began speaking no longer than a full second after she said this, but for me, the time between "It's my fault," and what she said next seemed like an eternity. An eternity of cascading, falling, agonizing...

"You know how I thought - we thought - that we'd be getting a... well, you really wanted it so I was pretty sure I asked for it... copy of the whole, like the unedited film? Or, you know, whatever it's called, before they edit it?"

I didn't understand what this meant. I was still waiting for the hammer to drop on my head, and this was all just garbage preceding it, delaying it, dragging out my torture before my death. "Yeah," I said, not really meaning anything by that. There was no way but forward.

April scrunched up her shoulders and made her "I'm sorry" face. "I guess it turns out that... like, I don't know exactly what the deal is, but Jonny and maybe Regg -"

"Reg?" I said. Not in a demanding way, just in a sleepwalking voice, a voice of incoherence.

"He - yeah, he's one of the, you know, guys. Anyway, I don't know who it is, it's just that *they* said that they don't want the um... raw footage, that's it, right? to be distributed. I guess. They said that. To Lilith."

These final sentences came out like random bursts of artillery fire, like April herself believed she was done talking and then couldn't help but add a final thought in.

"That's it?" I said, after a long silence.

April looked confused. Then relieved. She had the sleeves of her sweatshirt bunched up adorably in each hand, and she stretched them out now, stretching the sweater, blinking. "You aren't mad? I thought you'd be... you know. Mad."

I slowly blinked. I was relieved, and still gun-shy, but April's words were slowly coursing through my thoughts, revealing their content and their meaning... beyond that she was not leaving me, or filming for two more years, or any of the nightmares I had imagined.

"I thought you had an agreement with Lilith," I said. And I had: back before I had lost my mind and sunk into a perverted and feverish depression, I had been looking forward to receiving the raw footage, because I didn't just want to see my wife in a porno, I wanted to see her making it, talking to Jonny between scenes, maybe doing something that didn't make the final cut. I had wanted to watch it all and savor it and pick it apart for some errant glance or indication that April was taking her role more seriously than just "a role," or that she had fallen for one of her co-stars.

April shrugged again, her arms outstretched in an adolescent-looking way, like she was a teenager trying to answer the question "if your friends jumped off a cliff, would you, too?" as honestly as possible. She shook her head in disbelief. "She told me there's nothing she can do about it." April looked down at the counter. "I must have misunderstood."

"We have a contract," I began.

"There's nothing about this in there, I looked," April said. "I just didn't think about it, honestly. But because there's a hefty thing in there about this guy posting or re-selling the video, that clause kind of... I don't know, precludes I guess? Us having a copy of the raw footage."

"I don't understand," I said simply.

April brought her thumbnail to her teeth and grimaced. In a whisper, she added, "I'm not even sure - Lilith's not even sure - we can have the *actual* video. That's because -"

"What?!"

" - because of the same thing, like... it says something about him having the sole copy, which constrains the copying and distribution for everyone, even us... or, you know. Whatever lawyer jabbity-jabber..." April seemed like she was going to say something more, but then she fell silent.

The room was beginning to contort, its dimensions warping and coming toward me, a high-pitched buzz began singing in my right ear. "What?" I repeated.

"I know," April said solemnly. She was looking at her hands, moving one over the other and then switching them, piling them over and over.

"So we don't get... anything?" I repeated, exasperated.

April shrugged. "Except the money. I mean, that's good, right?"

Green and pink stars, the kind that preceded unconsciousness, began to swim in the corners of my eyes. Was I going to stroke out? I felt like I might.

"But that's!" I huffed, pointlessly.

It was the only thing I wanted. It was the only thing I had truly wanted out of any of this, the only reason I had put everything on the line, the only reason I had let my wife prostitute herself. It's why I had suffered for weeks. The money was great, but at that moment it seemed as irrelevant as the dust on the mantle: I had survived because of my belief that I would have that video, and watch it with the added benefit of knowing that *my wife* was willing to fulfill my fantasy, and some other man's.

Also, I had to see it. I had to *know* what April had been up to.

"I have to see that video, April," I said. My voice was acidic.

April looked stunned. I suspected it was the tone of my voice, but I didn't care. I couldn't change it, I couldn't think straight, I couldn't spare her feelings at a moment like that one. I knew I sounded like an addict, I knew I was behaving insanely.

She didn't answer; she just kept looking at me like that.

"I have to have that video," I repeated.

"What do you want me to do?" April said, a helpless tone in her voice. She lifted her hands, palms-up, and shook her head. It was done, she was saying. What could she do about it?

"Why do you need it so bad?" she asked, when I stood there, seething inwardly, and said nothing.

My eyes snapped to meet hers, and I could feel the senseless, raging-testosterone-meanness in them, the tunnel-vision of my thoughts that April would no doubt register in my eyes. "I *want* it," I said icily. "I only agreed to any of this because *she said we could have it*."

April looked astonished, and then an expression I wouldn't understand until later flew across her face.

But there was no reaching me. Thomas Roberts had checked out.

It had been a long time since I'd felt anything like that. The flip of a switch, the conversion of myself from a fairly rational person to a bit of a psycho. In my twenties, when I was drinking, it had happened, like I'm guessing it had to any guy. Some mixture of booze and testosterone works

its way into the wrong sector of your brain and you act like a fucking dick, picking at some fragment of something a pretty girl said and having rage travel up and down your spine, punching a hole in the wall because it's that hot under your collar.

But it had been years.

So I don't know exactly what I said to April, or what I looked like, or even how I ended up screeching to a halt, one tire over the hard curb, in front of Lilith's house. Why I didn't call, like any normal person would do.

But once I was there, there was no way to turn back. Not after parking like that.

So then I was banging on the door. Then I was storming across the emerald-green lawn, the grass damp from sprinklers in the middle of the fucking afternoon, which annoyed me even further. The gate to Lilith's yard had been unlocked, it creaked closed, its un-oiled hinges surprisingly out of sync with the rest of her immaculate, expensive, well-oiled life.

I didn't really expect her to be in the sauna. And you'd think a girl like Lilith would lock her gate and her sauna door. But she didn't.

"I need to talk to you," I said, loudly, after throwing open the door, finding her there, and then realizing what I was doing and wishing I could take it all back.

Lilith was stretched out naked on the top shelf of her sauna, skin glistening with sweat, a floral and tangy scent that was wildly sexual permeating the air. She kicked her feet slowly above her thighs before opening her eyes.

"You're letting all the cold air in," she said lazily.

I reached for the door, fumbling behind my own back, staring at Lilith and for some reason - not her hotness, but something linked to fear - not wanting to take my eyes off her. When I caught it, I slammed it shut, and the room became dim and instantly insanely hot.

It was a large sauna, expensive-looking, clearly made by a carpenter of fine skills. The cedar walls were made of planks cut like mosaic pieces and formed into a pattern. The workmanship alone probably exceeded the cost of my house. My head felt like it was going to explode.

"April just told me you're not giving her the video," I said.

Lilith flipped onto her back, her big, supple breasts swaying slightly, rivulets of water coursing enticingly down her thighs before she stretched

them out. She smiled, as if she was privy to some funny secret, and paused a long time before she spoke.

"Why on earth would you think I'd be able to do that, Thomas?" Lilith said, her voice bored and unconcerned. "It's a commissioned film."

She said this with disdain, as if everyone on earth knew that it being "a commissioned film" excluded it from being shared this way.

"Anyway," Lilith said, when I just stood there, fuming helplessly. "Who cares? April made a *ton* of money. You know, she could really make a career out of this."

Lilith had a smile on her lips, and she pushed her hair from her face with two hands. Then she opened an eye and looked at me. "Not everyone can."

And closed her eyes again.

"Lilith," I seethed. "This was the agreement we had. I am sure of it."

"Are you," she said, bored-sounding. But the amused smile was still on her lips.

"It wasn't," she added, without opening her eyes, after I didn't say anything. I was busy suppressing the urge to throw one of her heated rocks at her head.

But my silence must have alarmed her, because when I still didn't say anything, she turned her head and looked at me, and then sat up, for the first time since I had known her, a slight flicker of worry in her eyes. "It's in the contract," she told me, pulling a towel up to her chest.

So I guess I must have looked pretty psychotic. Part of that was real: it was a thousand degrees in there and I had sweat through my suit, all layers of it. My face was probably beet red before I got there, so I'm sure it was a terrifying color by then.

Also, I was, in fact, a little bit unhinged.

Well.

There was nowhere to go from there. Somewhere in the back of my mind, I knew that what Lilith was saying only made sense. There wasn't really any way to have a contract of this type and then give copies of the film to more than one person. I was overreacting, and I felt like an idiot.

But there was nowhere to go but bigger.

So that's what I did.

"I want to read that contract," I said.

"Heh," Lilith said, smiling. "Your wife has a copy."

"I want the -"

"No way," Lilith said, shrugging. "Look, Thomas, it's done. Just enjoy the money."

"Give. Me. The. Film," I said, icily. "I'll cover your expenses. Tell him it fell apart with the actress."

Lilith stared at me, and then laughed derisively. "Right," she said. But uncertainty had crept into Lilith's voice for the first time in my presence.

Something, something in Lilith's world was making her uncertain. I didn't know what it was - I had been operating under the nonsensical assumption that Lilith ran a business of porn or something like it, and she was so casual and carefree about it, and lived in a house that required legally accounted for money to purchase, that she must have all her legal and financial ducks completely in a row.

But this was a state with some odd laws. And so, without really having a complete narrative in my mind, or the details, or really any certainty, I combined all the things I knew about porn, the law, Lilith's behavior, human nature, and poker, and concluded that Lilith *must* have something to hide.

"Lilith," I said, and I heard my Thomas-Roberts-the-smart-guy-voice, the voice of Thomas-Who-Plays-Chess and talks himself out of every pickle. I had never been in an actual fight, and that wasn't for lack of doing anything stupid in my neighborhood or for lack of trying: it was because I knew how to gab. There was one of me in every greasy-blue collar neighborhood: the guy who always kept his nose clean because he knew how to talk himself out of anything.

Or into it.

Either way.

The words leave my mouth when I do this, almost ahead of my thoughts. I don't even know what I'm saying until I say it. Where am I going? It's all going to be revealed at the end. Whatever it is, when you talk yourself out of something, you have to talk fast, sneer, and say it with confidence. It's a performance.

And in this case, all I had to go by was that tiny flicker of doubt in Lilith's face. At the corner of her mouth, where it still twitched.

"I want that video, Lilith. And you are going to give it to me. Because if you don't, some little bird is going to drop a trail of breadcrumbs that leads... straight... here." I waved my finger around in a circle. It could have

meant the sauna, or her house, or this moment, or Lilith herself. It didn't matter that I had no idea what I was talking about: if Lilith was hiding anything, then she would fill the blanks in for herself. All I had to do was sell the menace.

Lilith's mouth was open. She laughed, and in her laugh she revealed all her cards: there *was* something wrong, something she was hiding, and she *was* worried I might actually reveal it. To whom? I had no idea. The authorities, I guess.

But Lilith, whose face had been formed in the mold of nonchalance, was simmering with some kind of worry, and her facade was cracking in hairline fractures.

"Are you sure this is what you want?"

I rolled my eyes.

"You sure this is what *everyone* wants?"

"Just give it to me."

Lilith's disbelieving face did some calculating and frowned. "I'm out 20K on this, not including April," she spat.

It was a challenge. I knew her game. I wondered if Lilith had grown up in a similar neighborhood as me.

If I acted like I cared about her money problems, it would signal that I was holding less of a hand than I wanted her to believe.

I shrugged. "Not my circus," I told her. "Not my monkeys."

Lilith sighed. She tapped her fingers on the wood.

Then she smiled, and let the towel drop, her beautiful body shining even in the dim light. "We could maybe -"

"I want. The video. Lilith. The raw footage. Like we agreed. That's what I want. You figure out the details."

Lilith had a half-smile on her lips, and it fluttered. In her eyes, I saw her impression of me change, and she wrapped the towel around herself before rolling her eyes. "It's not in the contract, Thomas," she repeated.

"It was a verbal contract, Lilith. But I'm happy to have it reviewed in court."

Lilith did a good job of hiding her reaction, but I saw it, deep beneath her skin. A flinch.

"Are you good with a copy?" she groaned. "And you have to keep your mouth shut that you have it."

I mimed zipping my lips. "That's all I wanted," I told her.

Lilith rolled her eyes again. But then she looked me up and down, which I have to admit was pretty flattering, because Lilith had always treated me like an umbrella stand - no feelings one way or the other. "All you had to do was ask," she said sweetly, closing her eyes.

"When will you -"

"Oh, I'll do it from here in my sauna, Thomas, I have the raw footage right up my ass."

I couldn't help but smile; for one thing, it was funny, and for another, the unflappable Lilith had finally gotten frazzled. I have no idea why, but I, like most men I know, take a particular pleasure in making women lose their cool. The cooler the customer, the more satisfying the victory.

"I'll get it to you," she sniped, when I snorted a laugh.

"See you around," I told her.

She lifted a hand and waved me away.

I felt like a pretty baller, big-dick as I strolled out of her sauna. I even had the class to shut the door, because people as cool as guys like me don't do things like leave the sauna door open after having a showdown with a woman like Lilith.

I still didn't know what I was holding over Lilith's head - it could be anything - but I had played one hell of a bluff.

And *that*, ladies and gentlemen, is how you do it.

*

April had sent me a slew of messages during this time, and when I pulled up in front of the house she came out of the door and running down the stairs, her face angry, concerned, and relieved all at once. "What the hell, Thomas?" she said. "Where did you go? What - you can't just do that, take off like that!"

I was smiling, and this confused her, so she folded her arms over her chest and pouted.

"It's all taken care of," I said, supremely impressed with myself, still, even after the drive home.

"What is? What do you mean by 'taken care of?'"

Because I was on a high after swinging my dick around a little, and tricking the manipulative Lilith, I made a joke by drawing my finger across

my throat.

April screeched, and immediately realized I was joking, then punched my arm, then seemed to think maybe I wasn't joking after all. "You're not serious," she said, tentatively.

"I just had a talk with Lilith. It's fine, she's going to give us a copy. We just have to keep quiet about it."

April's eyes widened. "She told me... that it wasn't possible," she said, uncertainly.

I didn't hear it in her voice at that moment, but there was a bemused disappointment in her voice. I was too high on myself, on the idea of getting the raw footage, on having "bested" the evil Lilith at something.

I reached for her hand and pulled her to me. "Nothing's impossible for Thomas Roberts," I said cheesily. And then I picked her up in a fireman carry and took her to the bedroom, which made her laugh and then engage in raw, frenzied sex.

I had a sore back muscle the next few days, so there may actually be *some* limits on what Thomas Roberts can do, but I bluffed my way through that one as well.

CHAPTER 9

Lilith delivered the copy of the raw footage to us the next day, inviting us to meet at a trendy club early in the evening for some kind of bizarre hipster happy hour involving overpriced tiny drinks that tasted like mulch.

She was wearing a baby-blue dress that no words in any language can describe: a complex pattern of interlocking Bohemian designs was woven into it with variations of the transparency of the fabric, from "totally" to "mostly" transparent. She was not wearing underwear. The dress hypnotized anyone who saw it: the pattern emerged in much the way those pictures you have to stare at and un-focus your eyes to see work, and also glimpses of her bare body surfaced and then disappeared as she moved.

She had erected her composure anew, and seemed disinterested in the USB key she slid across the table. "There you go," she said simply.

She was looking at April, who was looking at the USB key, her fingers playing with each other nervously.

"I can show this to no more than ten people, right?" I joked. I don't know why. Because it's fun? Because I was full of myself?

Lilith's eyes turned violently icy when she met mine, and that was all she had to say about that. It was a brief, threatening, arousing, feral gaze, and then it was gone, her message delivered.

April watched me put the USB key in my pocket and then glanced at Lilith, who grinned at her.

"Did you guys order the special?" Lilith asked. "They taste like dirt, but they're supposed to be an aphrodisiac."

I patted the USB key in my pocket. "I'll get by on whiskey," I said.

"They do taste like dirt," April mused sticking her finger into the drink and bringing it to her lips.

I marveled at her. She was doing this absent-mindedly, with no intention of looking as sexy as she did. No, really: she was fully capable of starring in a porno, having her husband wrest the footage from her semi-gangsta madame Lilith, and not be aware that sucking a drink from her fingertips like that was going to make anyone think unholy thoughts.

She just really thought it was curious that it tasted like dirt. She then sniffed it, as if to emphasize her innocence.

Even Lilith was amazed. She looked at April, and then at me, and exchanged something that almost qualified as a smile.

The USB key was burning a hole in my pocket. I leaned over to April, and nuzzled her neck, whispering to her: "Let's go home."

Lilith was already looking into the depths of the bar, seeking out her next prey. She lifted her hand and rolled her fingers closed in a dismissive wave. She had known we would leave, she was saying. She was moving on.

"Do we need to get the -" April began.

"It's on Lilith," I told her.

I wondered where Lilith kept her money, or if she literally just went out without any at all. She didn't seem to hear us, or if she did, she didn't care.

Her latest victim was approaching, and Lilith was shifting in her seat, smiling.

So we left.

*

April was quiet on the way home, looking out the window in that way she had when something was on her mind.

"What's up?" I asked, finally, when we stepped into the house, April still silent and perturbed. Some combination of images and echoes of things April or Lilith had said recently was making itself into a brew in my brain: I didn't know what it meant, but I had an idea that it was going to be unsettling, or disappointing.

April glanced up at me, and then looked away. "Huh? Nothing. No... I just..."

Her eyes dropped to the pocket where I had stuffed the USB key.

Slowly, slowly, the tendrils of synapses in my mind began to reach out, trying to make contact, neurons finally firing up.

"Wait a minute," I said. "You don't want me to have this, do you?"

April sighed, and shook her head.

"I asked Lilith to just... say you couldn't have it," she admitted, at last. "I thought, um... I think maybe it's a little too much. And then she just... *caved*. And gave it to you."

I was confused. I did my best to make the features of my face reveal this confusion. "I thought our agreement was that... you would tell me

everything. That was the whole reason..." My voice dribbled away.

"I know. I know. I know that, and I guess I'm okay with that - it's just, I really don't know what it's going to... I don't know. It's pretty... crazy stuff."

I took the USB key out of my pocket. "Did something happen...?"

April shook her head. "Everything was really... professional. And everything. And it was, like, not... I don't know, I wasn't uncomfortable or anything. Doing it. I just worry that you're going to... I don't know. Think differently about... me. Or something. I don't know." Her eyes got darker, bigger, shifted somehow. They looked damp. "I don't know if I want you to see it."

I pulled April close to me. "Honey," I said. "How many times do I have to tell you, there's nothing you can do that will make me feel any differently about you about, or... you know what I mean. It's all something we're in together. Just as long as... you know, there aren't any secrets." My chest went cold for a moment. "There aren't any secrets, or anything? Are there?"

"I mean... not really," April said. "It's just, uh... pretty... graphic, I guess. I guess, I agreed to show it to you when... before... I actually did it. I guess I just never imagined myself being a, um, porn actress. And now that you have it, I'm nervous, I guess. Like, watching it will make that really real: I'm a woman who did a porn video."

"April," I said, shaking my head. "I told you, that is like, the hottest thing you could have done. It's seriously my fantasy, even more than... more than I ever fantasized about."

April scrunched up her nose and rubbed her forehead. "What if it's too much?"

She was really worried about it.

"I promise, April, it can't be too much."

April looked at me seriously, her eyes searching mine. "But what if it *is*?"

I didn't know what to say to that. There seemed to be no way to convince my wife that whatever she had done could not be too much, not in the sense that she was thinking it could be.

"I love you, April. And you love me. Right?"

This was my standard line when words fail me. I say it a lot.

"Right," April said. "Okay."

"This thing is really burning a hole in my pocket," I told her, suggestively gesturing at the bedroom. "But I can wait. If you want to."

I set the USB key on the table. My fingers almost failed to un-clutch it. "You decide," I told her. "I'll be... in the bedroom. Taking a cold shower."

April looked at me strangely, and it was hard to do, but I walked to the bedroom, leaving the USB key on the table, hoping that April would not do something crazy, like run a magnet over it.

When I got out of the shower, April was on the bed, setting up the laptop, the USB key inserted.

She looked up at me. "I guess... you'll have to see it eventually," she said.

I moved toward the bed. I had my boxers on already. April was in a silky pair of pajama shorts, looking fresh and pretty, covered in smooth silk, her hair glossy, her lips bright pink like the blush on her face. She looked like the kind of girl who you would never be good enough for, the sort of prudish girl you couldn't even imagine having sex with, because you figured she probably didn't. In that moment, despite our years of marriage and many adventures, I had a real sense of vertigo: *this* woman had a porno, that she was the star of, sitting on her lap.

I decided to keep my mouth shut. So far, that was working out well for me. I stretched out next to her on the bed. "You ready?" I asked.

"I'm nervous," April said, covering her eyes.

I pressed play.

The following is my best recollection of the experience of watching this video with April. Even now, it seems like something that happened to another man, in another, parallel universe, where Thomas Roberts' hot wife April is an inventive porn star.

I did my best, but... it was all a little bit of a blur.

CHAPTER 10

It took a moment for me to realize that Lilith had not given me the "raw footage," and I was burned by it. Maybe it was her concession to April, her way of smoothing over the fact that she had to give in to my demands over April's insistence that she not give me the file. Maybe it was just negligence - a definite possibility with Lilith.

Either way, I realized I would never get that footage, because I wasn't going to stir up any more shit. I would have to make do with whatever I had, and in some ways that was almost more tantalizing than having the raw footage: the voids, the unknowns, between the scenes, would keep my mind occupied for a long time.

Also, I had been foolishly envisioning a scenario where the "raw footage" was going to capture every moment between April and co-stars, like a spy camera embedded in the wall. I was secretly hoping that some painful-to-watch interaction might take place, that I might catch my wife looking longingly at Jonny, or fucking him even when it wasn't required by the scene. Or that April would reveal some true feeling that was more than just the pure physical attraction between her and Jonny, or Rog.

All of that, I realized in short order, was to be left in my imagination. And it was almost more savory that way.

The first scene began with April on a chair at the center of the screen. She wore a sexy white dress, and I recognized it immediately as something from Lilith's wardrobe. The dress was loose on April in places, like it had been torn, and I realized right away that was the desired effect: in the book, "the wife" was kidnapped.

She was wearing a red wig, and her makeup made her look decidedly unlike herself. It was heavy, applied sloppily, and gave her an appealing trashy veneer. The effect was titillating: the woman on screen was both my wife, and not my wife.

Her acting was really very good: I was taken, for a moment, by the scared look in her eyes, as if she really was in danger.

"Your hubby told us he can't get us all the money until next week," a baritone voice said from behind the camera. "But that's too bad. Because I told him, we're gonna have to charge him some interest in that case."

April's eyes welled up with tears, something I found disturbing, because they looked so genuine. In fact, watching April act - even though it was a known acting job - stirred that same awful brew inside of me. If she could act this well her first time on camera... did that mean April acted more than I believed? Were her tears, or her moods, ever really real? Or had she been acting all along in our marriage?

But I didn't have time to dwell on these thoughts, because the film was moving at porno-plot-speed.

"He doesn't have this much money," April said, doing a more-than-decent impression of begging.

Next to me on the bed, watching, April covered her eyes and shook her head.

"What?" I asked.

"It's so... cheesy," she said, looking at the screen through her fingers.

The film continued, unabated, with me watching mesmerized. "Well that's gonna be a real problem, then, honey. Because he owes that much money, and we're gonna have to get paid somehow."

April faked a sob. "He'll never be able to pay," she said. "You're taking everything we've got!" Then she looked up. Her lips trembled.

It was really a great acting job. "Wait," she said. "What if...?"

"Go on," the voice, which I recognized as Rog's, said.

April looked down at her lap. "Is there anything you'll take, you know... as payment? Other than cash?"

A snicker. "What you got in mind?"

April looked up. "I could... you know... work it off."

She squirmed in the chair.

"What's the juice on that, man?" Rog's voice said. "Over the weekend?"

"Bout ten K," another voice said. I recognized it as Jonny's voice.

Rog's muscled body came into the scene. He approached April, who was still tied to the chair. He lifted her chin to look at him. "Bout ten K," he repeated. He swept a finger over her lower lip. "Now, what you gonna do for me that's worth \$10K? Hmm?"

April swallowed. She shook her head.

In real life I looked over at her. She grinned sheepishly. "I know, it's... bad," she said.

"Actually," I told her, "you're a pretty good actress."

"Man, I'll take some of that high-end pussy," the off-camera voice said. "I'll pay real good for that."

Rog laughed. "Man, that's real high-end."

"Well, now, not 10K for just one fuck. I'm sayin,' maybe whatever we pay them high-end hookers. \$2K?"

"Hmmm," Rog said. "This ain't no hooker, though. Are you? You probably don't know what you're doing." He tsked.

"Please," April pleaded, on camera. "I could... I could try. I could learn."

They both laughed. "What you willin' to do, sweet thing? You gonna let me fuck your ass? You gonna suck on two cocks at the same time?"

April's character looked shocked. "I don't..."

The other man was on screen now. "Yeah, man, just cool it, I don't mind giving a little instruction. I'd like to have a piece of this fine bitch."

"She tied up," Rog said, and I had to smile at his sudden turn to black vernacular. "Just take it."

Another man, who was an even larger black man than Rog, stepped close to April and took her chin in his hand. His hand was an enormous, thick, meaty thing, almost the size of April's whole head. "Nah," he said. "I like it when they doin' it for money, gotta do what I say. I'd like to see what this little honey will do. You need \$10K baby? Tell you what. I'll give you five-hundred dollars, every load of my cum you swallow."

I wanted to reach out and stop the video, to confirm with April what I didn't need any confirmation of, because I could see it with my own eyes. It had been in the script, but now that it was unfolding right in front of me, it was jarring. There were three kidnappers in this story, and a gang-bang at the end. I had known this all along, of course, but I had somehow been telling myself that it didn't really end up happening that way.

Now that it was in front of me, I was paralyzed, so the movie rolled on.

"Shiiiiit," Rog's character snorted. "You couldn't get your dick hard twenty times, man. She need ten K."

April's eyes were wet and scared.

"I could, I could do it," she said, desperation that sounded pretty genuine in her voice. "I could do... other things, other things if they pay... more."

"She ain't gonna do it," Rog said, waving a hand in the air.

"Huh. Why don't we see? You serious, little girl? You gonna suck some big black cock to save your hubby? Show me you serious."

He unzipped his jeans and stepped out of them. He looked over at Rog. "Let's see if she got the goods." To April: "You suck on these two cocks and swallow everything we put in that pretty little mouth of yours, and I'll take 2K off the juice -"

"Damn, that's an expensive fucking blowjob, brother -"

"Hey, just seein' if she got what it takes. It's called incentivizing. Once she done it, she ain't gonna be all hung up on it. Then we go back to a more... suitable price list."

He looked down at April, cock in hand. "Whatya say, princess? You want to work off some of that juice?"

April looked up at him as he took her chin and rotated her head toward him. His enormous cock was in his other hand, just inches from her lips. She looked down at it, and then up at him.

"I bet your hubby would forgive you, baby. After all, if he didn't have a problem, you wouldn't be in this mess, would you? So go ahead and suck on some big black cock, you only doin' it for him, honey."

April still looked uncertain. She was acting, I knew, but it was unsettling to see her acting, deliberately, because it approximated the same uncertainty she had shown her first time with Jonny. Inside my chest, it felt like a million worms had been released, each one of them squirming away with some terrible possibility: my wife had acted throughout our entire marriage, I had been set up, she had wanted to fuck guys like Jonny and Rog all along.

I blinked slowly, and April squeezed my hand. She was watching the screen, riveted. She seemed to have lost her shyness about the acting and the "cheesy" script, and now seemed fascinated by herself. When I opened my eyes from this slow blink, the big black cock was filling April's mouth, and onscreen she was making a gagging noise. The video then sucked me in, as it had April, and I watched, my disbelief fully suspended.

"I can't hear you, baby doll. Your mouth is all full of cock," the voice said. April pleaded with him with her eyes, which were watering convincingly.

The cock slipped from her mouth and the man held her chin. "Too much for you?"

"I can... I can't," April's character said, helplessly. "It's too big!"

"Yeah, it's big, but you need to swallow it all if you want to get paid. So open up, baby."

In his cock went, and his big hand pushed April's head forward. She made noises until his cock was too far back in her throat, and then I heard a gag, and her face was mashed into his pelvis.

"Okay, then, man, you gotta get off that, my turn."

The first man pulled April off his dick and grabbed her hair, pulling on it to make her face him, gasping. Spit flowed from her mouth, down her chin, and her mascara was starting to streak. She gasped for breath.

But the next cock was nearing her lips, and the first man pushed her toward it. She opened, struggled, and made a noise again the same way, as they shoved their cocks into her throat until she couldn't make a sound.

"What's the matter, baby, hubby's cock too little? Or maybe you never suck it for him."

"Oh, she's liking it," the other one said.

The first man pulled her hair and turned her head, shoving his cock back into her throat. He did this, trading from his cock to the other man's, several times. April gasped for breath at first, and then, after a few iterations, began to turn her head and perform the act herself, and he let go of her head.

"There you go, see?" the first man laughed. "She got the hang of it. She real good at it. Yeah, baby, all the way down. Suck it nice like that. Keep that mouth open for Reggie here. Yeah."

I stared, unable to believe the picture before me on the screen. April, head bobbing, working hard, sucking hard on first one fat black cock and then the other. Between cocks, as she turned from one to the other, she looked into the camera.

Right at her benefactor. Right at me. Right at whoever was pretending she was his wife.

My cock was painfully swollen long before the first man grasped her head and held onto it. "Oh baby, yeah, I'm about to blow, you gonna suck it right up and swallow it, aren't you?" He began to fuck her face, holding her head in place as he thrust against her with sticky slaps. When he came he groaned, and April looked up at him as his cum filled her throat.

He pulled his cock from her, saying "good girl," but his friend Reggie could hardly wait, and he grabbed her head and pushed his cock back into her mouth, fucking her in the face until he, too, came.

I had to remind myself that it was a fictional story when he let go of her head, and she gasped for air, her lips wet and overflowing with the cum she hadn't swallowed - which wasn't much.

The discomfort that I had been feeling for a while now stirred inside of me again: how *was* April such a natural at this? Or was she?

I looked over at her, and she glanced at me and paused the video. She put a hand to her face. "It's pretty extreme," she said, almost uncertainly. "But... it's what he wanted."

"No," I said quickly. "No, it's... it's hot, I just didn't, uh, realize you were such a good actress."

April slapped me playfully. "Shut up," she said. "Do you want to keep watching?"

She dropped her eyes to my cock, which was pushing the loose material of my shorts into a sturdy tent. "Maybe you want to... you know... relieve a little pressure?"

She dropped her hand to my cock, and dragged her nails over the material, sending a shudder through me as her fingers lightly tickled my shaft.

What did I want? I wanted to know if April was as turned on by watching this as I was. I wanted to know how wet her pussy was now, and how wet it had gotten when she had sucked on two cocks and swallowed the cum.

I looked at the screen. April was sitting on the chair, hands behind the back, legs together. Would the villains of the video answer this question for me?

I reached for the space bar and continued the video. "Maybe just a little bit more," I said. Then I asked, "Does this make you hot?"

April was staring at the screen. She didn't answer me.

The guy played by Rog was touching her lips on the video now. "Huh," he said. "That's pretty good, baby. I think you might have even liked it. Is that true?"

He reached down to part her legs. April was not wearing any panties, and I caught a flash of her bare slit before the space filled with Rog's hand and he began to feel around her pussy, sticky wetness cackling on the audio.

He lifted his hand and held it to the other man, who sniffed and laughed. "That's some sweet pussy. Maybe you want to give me some of that, hmm? You still got like \$8K to work off, baby."

April's character breathed rapidly, looking wonderfully scared and sexy.

"I'll do... whatever," April said. "Tell me what you want."

"Thing is, I feel like you kinda gettin' the good end of the deal, here. Seems like you like it a whole lot. I think maybe I don't have to pay quite so much, since you like the black cock so much."

"Please," April begged him. "I have to... there's no way he can pay if I don't. Tell me what I can do. I'll do it."

Rog laughed. "Mmmmkay. Tell you what. You climb on my cock and ride it."

He untied her from the chair, but left her hands tied behind her back, and pulled her up to standing. He took her place on the chair. The other man, "Reggie," ripped the loose dress from her, and let it fall to the floor in shreds. "Ain't gonna need this much," he said.

April's hands were still tied behind her. Rog pulled her toward him, his huge black hand covering the entire small of her back, her thin wrists wrapped up in thick, rough rope, hanging over his huge forearm.

He guided her roughly over him, so she had to straddle the chair to keep her balance. Rog held his dick in his hand, and stroked it back to life pretty quickly, the crown sliding between the wet folds of April's pussy as he did.

"There we go," Rog said, pressing on her back and pushing her down on the crown of his dick. "Just sit right on that, sit right down, get comfortable."

"Oh!" April said, as the meaty shaft disappeared between her legs and her thighs lowered, her ass falling to Rog's thick thighs. "Oh! It's so big! Oh! I can't!"

Rog pushed her down by the shoulder, and April gasped, her legs lifting from the floor and her feet kicking slightly. "Oh my!" she said. "Oh! It's so big!"

"It's tight in there, baby. You gonna loosen up. Now you want to make some money? I want you to bounce on my cock, baby. You do all the work and make yourself come. And no faking it, little girl. You work real hard, and do a good job, and then Reggie here will get his dick nice and wet before he fucks your little ass. But you gotta work for it, baby. Show me how much you love your hubby, honey. Fuck that cock good."

The other man crossed in front of the camera and posed on the right side, where Rog had been, holding April's hair in his fist. He gently pulled her upward, and April rose with him, as several inches of Rog's cock slithered out from inside of her. Then she lowered her body.

"That's it."

She started to bounce on Rog, her mewling turning to grunting, a sheen of sweat developing on her skin. "That's just how you do it, little girl. Yeah, keep going, I can feel you want to come all over my cock, that's it. That's good. You're working real hard, keep fucking that cock, baby. Oh, yeah."

I stared at the screen, immersed again as if this was a real situation, and the April I was watching was *my* wife taken hostage, and now bouncing heartily on Rog's lap, working hard to earn some cash.

I felt a cold punch in the gut as I realized that this was, pretty much, the actual reality I was in. Sure, I had given her permission to do it, but she was doing it for the money, and... probably because she liked Rog's, and Jonny's, and now Reg's cock. Jesus.

"Oh my!" April said. I was enjoying the prudish dirty talk that April's character was engaging in, and wondered if someone had told her to talk like that, or if it was her own invention, or, more appealingly - if it was her true self. "Oh my goodness!" she cried out.

April's pale, lithe frame was bouncing hard now, Rog's cock cackling and spurting as she rammed her pussy onto his lap and his dick disappeared between her legs. He moved his hand to her bottom, and slipped two fingers into the crack of her ass, where he held them still, so they rubbed against her sweaty skin as she bounced and worked hard.

"Oh! Oh!" April screamed. Her hands were still tied behind her back so this was a thigh-only work out. She was panting, working hard, screaming... and then she threw her head back and gave out a wail. "Oh my, oh my goodness..."

Rog caught her with his hand, keeping her from falling backward. "Oh fuck, that's it, she came all over my dick," he growled. "Yeah," he said, guiding April's loose head back to his face, licking her from breast bone to chin. "You like it, don't you honey? You gonna come back and keep doin' it for free, aren't you doll?"

April seemed listless and spent in the video, and I couldn't tell if she was acting. I glanced over at real April, and she looked back at me. "I'm

fine," she said.

"Did you really come that hard?" I dared to ask.

April bit her lower lip and looked down at the keyboard. "I mean, *a little bit* of it is acting," she said.

"Fuck," I breathed.

April shot me a look.

"Just like, fuck, that's hot," I clarified. That *was* what I meant. I thought.

But I sort of trailed off, because now the other guy - Reggie, I guess - was pulling April by the hair from Rog's lap, and pushing her onto a bed behind the chair, which I hadn't noticed until that moment. The camera moved forward and up unsteadily: someone was holding it now and moving it closer.

"Get your ass in the air, baby. Reggie likes ass."

April crawled forward on her knees and displayed her ass for them, her hands still tied behind her, slumped near the middle of her back, elbows bent on either side of her ribcage. The perfect roundness of her ass spread open, her engorged pussy splayed wide, cum oozing from its center with each quiver, still ongoing from her orgasm. The valley between her rounded asscheeks was glistening with cum, and her tiny pink eyelet was shiny and slick.

She turned her head to the left, and I could just see her eyes, trained on the camera lens, looking up at Reggie, who was approaching her, dick in hand. The camera focused on her asshole as Reggie's meaty hand palmed her right buttcheek, and he plunged his thumb into the gushing flesh of her pussy, then drew it up to her eyelet. He played with her hole for a moment, making circles, grunting, saying "oh yeah." The entire screen was filled by April's ass at this point, and in the center, her eyelet, puckered and wet, with Reggie's thumb massaging it.

April squirmed, and mewled.

"You like that, honey? Reggie can give you more than just a taste."

"Not my ass," April breathed, her voice the perfect imitation of any porn protagonist's "hesitant" voice.

"Not your ass, huh? What's the matter? You never had a dick in your ass before?"

April mewled again as Reggie pushed his thumb into her hole. April shifted her butt to the left and he pulled her back to the center with his

thumb hooked inside of her. "Keep that ass right where it was, honey. There we go. See, she's gettin' used to it now. Aren't you?" Reggie began to slowly fuck April's ass with his thumb, pushing in deeper each time. Finally, his entire thumb was inside of her, and he squeezed his hand around her asscheek.

"You tellin' me you never done this before? You like it, don't you, baby? Mm-hmmm."

"Oh!" April mewled. Reggie finger-fucked her some more. "You wanna take it in the ass, baby? I can take a lot off your bill if you let me fill your ass up with dick."

April howled.

"Hmm? What'ya say?" Reggie continued.

"I can't... I can't..." April mewled.

"Hmm," Reggie growled. "Okay then, little thing. You gonna let me fuck that pussy, though?"

April made a noise.

"You wanna get paid, you're gonna have to ask me nicely. Say, 'please fuck my tight little pussy, Mr. Reggie.'"

April demurred, and Reggie squeezed her asscheek until she panted, "Please fuck my pussy, Mr. Reggie."

"Please fuck my tight little pussy, Mr. Reggie," he corrected.

"Please fuck.. my... oh, my... my tight little pussy... oh, oh..." April trailed off, as Reggie started to finger-fuck her ass again.

"Mr. Reggie," Reggie prompted.

"Mr... Reggie..." April said breathlessly.

Reggie pulled his thumb from April's ass and gave the camera a moment to capture her pulsing eyelet, before the camera switched hands and the images swam over the screen. When it stopped, it appeared to be held by Reggie, filming from above as he guided his cock to April's pussy with his free hand.

"Push those knees up, baby, get that ass up higher, I want to see what I'm doin' here."

April obeyed, and I was treated to a view I had not been privy to so far: another man's fat, gnarly cock at the entrance of her pussy, her lips enclosed around the head of it like a kiss.

Against her pussy, Reggie's dick looked too large to fit. It covered from view everything but her outer lips. A cold thrill ran down my spine,

and my balls felt like they were being squeezed. "Honey," I said aloud, realized instantly it was silly: April had already been there and done this, so nothing I said now would stop what was going to happen on the screen from happening.

"It's too big," April mewled on screen. "Oh! Oh my!"

April wriggled, and thrashed a little on the bed, but there was no stopping Reggie's cock as it pressed ahead. Her pussy crackled, like a juicy watermelon breaking apart along a scored line, and the inches slowly disappeared inside of her, as her voice trailed off to a feral pant.

Reggie then began to pummel my wife, keeping the camera trained on his shaft, sawing in and out of her. The firm flesh of her buttocks rolled away from the impact of each thrust, and her moaning was pushed from her lungs almost like hiccups, squeezed out by each ramming of Reggie's dick deep into her pussy. Wet slapping cut through her slow and steady moaning.

"Oh fuck, that's nice," Reggie said. "That's good, she's taking it real good. You gonna come, you little slut? She likes it, I can feel her pussy getting tighter. That's it, baby girl, if you want to come on Reggie's cock you better do it soon, I'm gonna fill you up with a nice big load of cum."

Reggie began to pound her harder, grunting, the muscles of his thick abdomen flexing. April began to grind backwards against him, trying to make herself come, and the camera moved to capture her face: hair damp with sweat, eyes rigid in concentration, mouth open, her voice squeaking out of it.

Just as Reggie grunted deeply and rammed inside of her, dropping a hand to her back to steady himself while he dumped his cum inside of her, April mewled and squinted her eyes. Reggie gripped her lower back as she squirmed and bucked against him. "I'm... coming...I'm coming..." April wailed.

Reggie's deep laugh could be heard, while the camera focused on April's bucking body, fighting against Reggie's strong grip, to make herself come on his cock.

At last she wailed loudly and went stiff, then limp.

"Yeah, she comin,'" Reggie commented. Then he slapped her ass two times quickly. "She likes it. I bet she gonna be askin' to pay that whole thing off. That's okay, baby. But you gonna have to ride a lot of cock if you don't let me fuck that little ass of yours."

"Maybe she don't mind," Rog's voice said, with a laugh.

The camera moved away, panning to capture Reggie's semi-hard cock flopping out of April's pussy, then moving away, a long, slow retreat from her still-folded body, ass in the air, swollen pussy pulsing out globs of creamy cum.

"That's your wife's pussy full of two loads of cum, buddy."

I reached out and stopped the video, exhaling sharply. I wasn't sure which way was up or down anymore: I needed a minute to take myself out of the (admittedly corny) storyline of owing money to some nefarious gangsters, because the woman in this b-grade plot was, in fact, my wife. And her very real pussy was full of two loads of cum, and was quivering with a real orgasm brought on by an enormous black cock.

I felt anxious, like I was actually the intended recipient of this threatening video, which was thrilling, and only made my cock harder. But an unease about April - her acting skills, how much acting she was actually doing, her seeming ease with being in this video - was eating at me as well. I was *thrilled* she had done this, and yet I couldn't shake a kind of nausea that was building up inside of me.

April had a strange, feverish glow about her, a light behind her eyes. She tore them away from the screen and looked at me.

Her features softened to a look of concern, maybe they even flirted with a look of contrition and prudish embarrassment. But *in* her eyes, I could see something different. Something more like the look I expected burned behind my own eyes: an all-consuming lust, barely under control.

I shook myself and blinked. Was that right?

Or was I just projecting?

"Why'd you stop?" April purred, turning toward me and putting her hand between my thighs. With ease, she found the rigid contours of my cock and caressed me, her touch light and infuriatingly feathery. I bounced against her hand and she grinned. "Did you like it?"

I moved my head up and down in a gesture of "yes," but a sound like "Huh!" left my lips and I could feel my face, the uncertain worry on it.

"The next part is better," April said. She was holding her hand flat, horizontal to my lap, grazing my cock with the lightest touch of her palm. It was something she had never done before, and it was unsettling, like so much else I now seemed to be seeing from her, for the first time.

On the screen, I stared at her pussy. Even though the frame was frozen, it seemed to pulse, and cum seemed to stream endlessly from it.

"I had to... had to stop," I said, and I sounded a little crazy to myself. I exhaled again. My gut felt like I had swallowed a gallon of menthol, and the chill radiated to my limbs. But I could barely feel any of that, I could only feel my cock, throbbing.

"Tell you what," April said. "Why don't you watch the rest, and I'll just... sit right here..." she slid down my body and put the laptop in my hands. As she moved, she pulled my shorts with her, and I rocked from side to side so they could be tugged off enough for my cock to be freed. April grinned up at me and squeezed my cock at the base.

She squeezed harder, and leaned toward me, smiling. Her tongue left her mouth and flicked at the raw, strained skin of my crown. "Oh, God, April," I said. The laptop almost fell from my hand, tipping slowly to the side, forgotten momentarily.

"This is a trick I learned from Rog," she said, and gripped my cock uncomfortably tight. "That way you ..." she turned slightly, and reached for the space bar to un-freeze the scene, "can watch the next scene, and I..." she lowered her mouth to my cock, "can suck on your dick... but you won't come right away."

I stared at her, not at the screen, even as the characters in the porno starring my wife began to talk, and mewl, and moan. I couldn't rip my eyes from the back of April's head as she sucked my dick into her mouth.

I shuddered. It was too intense, almost, to take, and I closed my eyes for a moment. I dropped the laptop to the side and put my hands on her head and gripped her hair fiercely, but April was right: with the hard squeeze she was applying to the base of my cock, I wasn't able to come, no matter how much I needed or wanted to.

My eyes were watering a little as I remembered the video, and looked to the screen. April's tongue, in real life, was sweeping in circles around my shaft, inside her mouth, and I couldn't understand how she was doing it. It was a new trick, one she must have learned from the man who was on the computer screen now, or perhaps one of the other men who'd fucked her countless times this past week.

The scene had changed somewhat: April the character was handcuffed to the bed by only one arm, and Rog was standing next to her on the left side of the bed. He had his hand in her hair and was playing with it almost tenderly.

"You want a little bit more of this, baby? Want to pay off some more of your sugar daddy's debt? Hmm?"

"I want to," April's character was saying breathlessly. This was the point in the story when she began to convert, and become seemingly obsessed with her kidnappers.

"Yeah? What you want to do, baby? You wanna suck some cock? Or you want to have some of this dick in your pussy? Hmmm? You got a free hand... you go ahead and show me what you want... that's it..."

April was slowly unzipping his jeans, and the monstrous cock sprang loose. Rog helped out, pushing his jeans away.

April reached up and wrapped her hand around his shaft, looking up at him with a pleading expression in her eyes.

"That's good, baby. You ain't gonna try to bite me, are you? Nah. You like it, don't you? Go ahead and open for me, honey. Suck on it all you want. You do a good job and I'll fuck you till you come, baby. That's what you really want, isn't it?"

April nodded, opening her mouth. She fed Rog's cock to herself, and he put a hand behind her head to push her all the way down. Then he dropped his hand. "Do it yourself, baby, I want to hear you slurp it and suck it, show me how much you want that cock in your pussy."

April sucked, slurping loudly, moaning in that very porny way that all porn stars and no real women (at least, none that I've ever known) do when they suck cock. When she paused to breathe, she licked at his crown, scooping up the oozing precum, smiling, telling him she wanted it.

It was all in the script, but I was seized by it as if it were real.

In real life, April released my cock and took me inside of her, precisely when Rog's character on screen thrust his dick so far down her throat that the heavy lump could be seen moving beneath the tender white curve of her exposed neck.

I cast the laptop to the side and tried to hold April's head: she was still swirling her tongue around my cock, sucking the cum from inside of me, and the final spurts were almost painful in their intensity. But she didn't stop, she kept going, until I had to fall back and groan, my hands uselessly entrenched in her hair.

When she finally released me, she picked up the laptop and brought it to her own lap. "There's still more," she told me, grinning.

I was panting, and I could feel the grimace on my face. April's words chilled me a little: this was the first time I think she had ever exercised her power over me so explicitly. She should have always known she had it, and I believed that she did know that - but April had never *behaved* like she could do whatever she wanted to me, like she had me wrapped around her finger as tightly as she did.

My eyes went to the screen anyway, my cock in real life pulsing and flopping, incredibly, attempting to come back to life.

The scene changed abruptly, the way porn often does. April, naked, was sitting on the bed, knees to her chin, ankles crossed, slit peeking through the dark shadows between her legs.

"He wasn't able to pay up, honey," Rog was telling her from off-camera. "So we gotta teach him a lesson."

April turned her legs to the side and struck a feline pose. "What kind of lesson?" she asked, her voice a disturbingly perfect cross between slutty and innocently naive. God, she was good - almost *too* good.

But there was no time to dwell on my personal pain, because the porno carried on. "You gonna have to get fucked in the face, baby. But you been real good, so I'm gonna make it nice and easy for you."

April - the character - pouted. Then she shook her head. "I don't... I don't think I can do that," she said.

"Yeah, you can. You're gonna do it, because you want your hubby to be able to come with all that cash, don't you? It's either you or him, baby."

"Oh... okay, okay," April pleaded.

Another terrible, abrupt cut - not that anyone would care - and April was stretched out on the bed, her head hanging over the edge, her arms to the side.

I looked over at my real-life wife. "April," I said.

I don't know what I meant by that. April shot me a glance, and brought her thumb to her lips. "He has a real fantasy about this, I guess," she said, as if musing to herself. "I told you about it..."

Her voice trailed off, and I barely noticed, because the dark skin of one of her kidnappers blocked the view of her face temporarily. "Now open up, baby, that's all you gotta do, and keep those pretty blue eyes open, look right at that camera."

A voice from behind the camera began to speak to the "husband" as the scene unfolded. "This is what you get, man, for missing your deadline:

your wife is gonna have a belly full of cum."

A bit of jittery camera work screwed up the view for a moment, but when it stabilized, the screen was almost entirely taken up by April's eyes, staring at the camera, creamy-tinted spit rolling into them and making her blink it away, beneath a dark, unfocused mass - Rog's ass and cock - sawing in and out of her mouth. On the out stroke, his gnarly purple cock glistened and spewed from her lips, on the in-stroke, his hairy balls rested on her nostrils, her eyes widening when he rammed himself deep inside of her and she could not breathe.

"Honey," I said, in a hoarse whisper.

April was watching herself, transfixed, but not disturbed.

The scene went on for a while, April's eyes blinking beneath the slapping hairy balls and sticky cock that sawed in and out of her mouth. Rog pulled out and spilled his seed into her open mouth and all over her face, as April held her mouth open to catch as much of it as she could.

"Lick it off," Rog told her, and she did, her tongue reaching for the pools of cum in the corners of her mouth, slipping slowly toward her nose.

It was the filthiest thing I had ever seen.

But the camera panned out, so that April's full body on the bed was visible again, and the man who called himself Reggie was climbing onto the bed, working himself between April's spread legs.

He spoke to the camera, and April remained with her head hanging over the edge of the bed, her eyes looking into the lens of the camera, right into the darkest corners of my mind. She lifted her fingers to her face and touched the sticky cum that had dribbled on her skin, her expression vacantly pleased.

It might have been acting, and April was just a very good actress. Or it may have been that April was just as turned on by taking Rog's cock like that as Reggie was about to say she was. There would never be any way of knowing, and as I sat there, looking at April's eyes blinking away spilled cum while Reggie got between her legs, I realized: no matter what I did, no matter how many questions I asked, no matter how many times I made April answer me: I would never, ever know what she was really thinking.

And that was the other side of the double-edged sword that stabbed me through my heart.

Reggie had his meaty hands around April's loose, spread thighs. Her legs flopped in his hands, as devoid of agency as her expression, as the

wandering fingers that touched her cum-streaked face.

Looking directly at the camera - at me - Reggie smiled and moved a hand between April's legs. "Your wife is all hot for some of this cock," he said, grinning. He put his fingers into April's pussy, and the sticky crackle permeated the audio, almost deafening.

"And I'm gonna give it to her. I'm gonna fill her right up."

He fucked April at a slow, leisurely pace, his hands holding her thighs like they were sticks, his eyes on the camera, his mouth a twisted, cruel grin. April's tits rocked, her nipples visibly hard. Her fingers went to her mouth, and she clamped down on them to the first knuckle, and mewled.

"Yeah, there she goes, now she's gettin ready to come, aren't you, little girl? Yeah, she wants it." He grinned again. "Come on honey, show me you want it, make that little pussy pop, squeeze it tight and then you'll get another nice big load of cum."

He looked down at her, and she closed her eyes and squealed, her toes curling, her hand stuffed in her mouth. Her eyes flew open as her legs tensed and squeezed against Reggie's torso.

Reggie looked at me, right at me, and grinned. "She's beggin' me for it. So I'm gonna give it to her. Ain't that right, baby?" He looked down at April, and swept his hands over her torso, playing with her tits, while April lifted her head to look up at him, dropping her fingers from her mouth, clawing with one hand at the cheap bedsheet.

"Oh, oh, oh!" April moaned.

Reggie gave the camera a final grin, and then rammed himself deep into my wife's pussy. His thighs slapped loudly against her skin, each contact a wet splat because April's skin was completely covered by a sheen of sweat. He gave her five or six final thrusts, grinning the whole time, as he dumped his seed into April's cunt.

Her head fell back, over the edge of the bed, her eyes listless, as he pulled out and dropped her legs to one side, giving her a smack on her ass as he left the bed. "Coming back for your ass later, if he don't pay up."

I stole a glance at the real April, who was totally absorbed by the scene, almost to the point that I wondered if she remembered where she was. Again, a pang of desire to know what she was thinking - both her in the moment, and also while making the video - crawled up inside of me and gripped my heart, making it hard to breathe.

But these were things I could never know. I could never *really* know.

When I looked back at the screen, April was sitting on the bed, Reggie on one side, and Rog on the other. Reggie already had his cock out, and was stroking it, while April looked from each man to the other.

"Please," she said, her voice quivering. "I don't think I can do it, please, I'll do anything else." She got onto her knees and crawled to Reggie, reaching for his cock. She hungrily took him into her mouth, working on him with her hand at the base of his shaft. Her eyes sought his, her body contorted to a position of maximum submission. "Please," she begged, slurping and mumbling with her mouth full of spit and cock. "Please, I'll suck on your cock all you want," she panted. "I like it."

Reggie watched her, grinning. "That's nice. That's good baby. Oh yeah, keep going."

April sucked Reggie off again, and he pulled her head back to fire his cum all over her face, with April's tongue reaching out desperately to catch it. He used his finger to sweep it into her mouth, and she greedily sucked on his fingers.

"That was nice, baby," he said. "But you still gotta pay up, honey." He touched her face tenderly. "I'll go nice and easy breaking you in, because you've been a real sweet girl. You got a real nice mouth, done everything I asked you to."

"I can't do it," April complained. "It's too... it's too big."

"You gonna do it," Rog said. "You gonna do it and you gonna like it. Now get over here and suck my cock, baby, you do a nice job and you'll get some lube. You be nice to me, I'll be nice to you."

April crawled to Rog, who had pulled a tube of lube from thin air and was holding it over April's head, playing with it in his fingers. "Show me how much you want this, huh? Be a real good girl, suck on me real nice. That's it."

A hollow pain carved itself out in the pit of my stomach as my wife on the screen began sucking Rog's cock, her head tilted to look up at him, as he held his bottle of lube over her face, taunting her with his perverse form of payment for her good services.

"That's good, I'm going to come, suck it right out, swallow it nice, and then you can have some of this when I put it in your ass."

"Gonna take a long time to come the second time," Reggie pointed out.

"Maybe," Rog said, pushing a strand of April's wig from her face. "Maybe that ass is so tight it won't be nothin at... all..." he groaned, and squinted, tipping his head back. "Oh yeah, take it all, swallow that up, baby."

I stared at April, on her knees, sucking cum loudly, with smacking lips, from Rog's cock.

"Oh God," I said, in real life. My cock was painfully hard, my eyes almost watering. I was bent over slightly, trying to manage the wrenching pain in my abdomen, part physical, part the twisted emotional pain that racked me.

April - real April, looked at me quickly, alarmed. "Too much?" she asked, worry in her voice.

I shook my head. "It's hot... it's just... wow," I said.

April looked at me a moment longer. Then her eyes drifted back to the screen. "If you want to stop," she murmured, but her voice trailed off as she spoke, her attention garnered by her own image on the screen.

The next part was a succulent piece of twisted genius, and I wondered who had edited it: if it was Lilith... if in the end, Lilith's actual job was that of director and editor, not star of her pornography. Whoever had done it had made a magnificent piece of work that I knew would be burned into my memory for all of time, never leaving me, not even for a moment. It would be one of those images that always smoldered somewhere in the back of my mind, even while grocery shopping, speaking at a meeting about the price of transnational shipping of light bulbs: a split screen, one half of it April's face, pressed to the bed. The other half April's ass, up in the air, the handheld camera wobbling slightly as Rog - by now, I recognized his cock - placed himself behind her.

The entire final scene was filmed this way: split, so that April's face was always visible, as was everything that happened to her tiny asshole.

Rog squirted a pile of clear lube onto her ass and rubbed it gently around, while April's mouth opened and she made a slutty-sounding expression of shock. "Oh!" she said, her voice becoming almost bimboesque. "It's so cold," she whined.

"Gonna warm it right up," Rog said, slipping a finger into her eyelet.

April's face froze, mouth open in shock. She brought a hand next to her chest and clawed at the sheet on the mattress, framed perfectly in the shot.

"That's right, there you go," Rog instructed her. "I'm gonna go nice and slow, yeah, she's opening up just like a tight little clamshell. Mmm."

On the right side of the screen, Rog added a second finger to April's ass, tucking the lube inside, curving his fingers, twisting his hand around to stretch and plunder all the inner contours of her ass. April, on the left, looked into the camera, her face contorted into an expression of surprise. "Oh!" she moaned, over and over, as Rog worked around inside of her, fucking her with his two fingers.

"That's good, yeah, you got it, just relax, baby. She likes it, she's gonna be able to take it. There we go, honey, get all loose, push out, that's it. That's good. Now get those hands up here, honey." He reached down and pulled her left hand up to her asscheek, splaying her fingers over the round of her bottom. "Now the other one," he commanded.

April brought her right hand up to her ass and held herself for him while he continued to fuck her with two fingers, spreading his digits apart to stretch her ass open. The lube crackled stickily as he kneaded her from the inside-out.

"Now just hold on like that, baby. I'm gonna slide it right in."

"Oh! Oh my goodness!" April said, as he pulled his fingers out. A small gape quivered where her once-tight eyelet had been. Rog lined up the fat crown of his dick so that her orifice closed around the very tip like a tiny, shrinking mouth. Lube oozed from the seam between his flesh and hers.

"It's so big," April panted, squeezing her eyes closed.

"None of that," Reggie's voice said, from off-camera. "Look right here, honey, so he knows what your face looks like when you get a big cock in there for the first time."

"Oh," April moaned, her voice almost childlike. "It's too big, I can't do it!"

"Open your eyes, honey, or you just gonna have to do it again."

"Maybe that's what she wants," Rog joked.

April opened her eyes and looked at the camera. "Oh," she mewled.

Rog pushed himself forward, and the bulbous head of his cock sank into April's asshole. Her eyes went wide and she inhaled sharply, then stared, without making a sound. Her left hand slipped from her ass and fell, like a doll's arm, to her side.

Rog pushed forward, placing his palm on her right hand to secure it in place.

"Oh!" April moaned. "Oh, my, oh my goodness... it's so... it's in," she was whispering now. "It's in my ass."

On the right side of the screen, Rog's cock sank into April's ass, while she mewled and stared at the camera on the left side of the screen.

He fucked her slowly at first, and then ordered her to put her left hand back up. She did, and Rog began to saw inside of her, the view from his hand-held camera perfectly trained on the full length of his fat cock as it plunged in and out of April's ass.

The scene was long, and I was spellbound. I almost forgot April was really there, watching beside me. I forgot that she had already taken it in the ass from Rog, and from Jonny, so convincing was her vacant, surprised expression, her glassy eyes, her occasional, bimbo-voiced exclamations of "Oh my!"

"Oh, yeah, oh fuck that's hot," Rog said, starting to fuck her harder. "Oh, yeah, baby, I'm gonna come, oh yeah."

But he didn't, not for at least a few minutes. When he finally groaned and thrust hard into April, her hand slipped and she had to push back against him slapping hard into her ass. "Ohhhhhh!" April yelled, her voice wobbling with the vibrations of Rog's big body slapping into her butt.

He yelled as he came, and pulled out just as he did, holding the left side of April's ass so that there was a perfect view of her gaping hole as he jizzed into it, almost all of it landing in the yawning chasm of her stretched hole.

"That's one load," Rog said. And the camera jiggled, and so did the bed, as the men traded places. The man called Reggie dropped his huge slab of meat into the small valley between her buttocks. It splatted heavily on her sweat and the stray ropes of cum that had fallen there. He dragged his crown down to her quivering ass.

"You ready to take another load, baby?" Reggie asked her. He lined his cock up with her distended hole, cum oozing from it in pulses. "I'm just gonna feed it to you, it's gonna slide right in. Yeah, there you go."

"Oh, my, oh... oh, it's so... big... it's so big..." April murmured.

Reggie sank in fast, all the way to the hilt. He thrust his hips upward once he was deep inside of her. April opened her mouth wide and mewled.

"Oh, she likes that," Reggie said. "She's likin' it, aren't you baby? See, that's not so bad?" He started to fuck her, nice and slow as he had promised. "Let me hear you say how much you like it. Say it, look right at that camera and tell your hubby how much you like that big black cock, yeah, that's all you're gonna want from now on, huh, baby?"

April stared at the screen.

"Say it, baby, let's hear it."

Reggie reached over April's huddled form and worked his fingers under her wig. He pulled her up to her hands and knees, his hand secured around her neck from the back, fingers nearly touching at the front of her throat. "Go on, I can feel you working it, that's it baby, yeah, she's buckin me now, that's it."

"Oh!" April cried. "Oh, it's so... it's so big."

"It's good, you like it. Tell him you like it. Turn that face over there... that's it. Now tell him."

April turned to look at the camera. She was starting to back up against Reggie's dick, thrusting her ass to fuck his cock. "I love it," she whispered, in her bimbo-voice. "Oh, it's so good, I want it."

"You want another load of cum?" Reggie growled.

"I want it," April repeated.

"Go on then, baby, you work on it."

April started to fuck herself against Reggie's pelvis, turning her head to face forward, working hard. For the next few minutes, there was nothing but Reggie's occasional growl of pleasure, his derisive, low-rumbling laughs, and April panting, all layered over the sticky slaps of her ass against his thighs.

"Yeah, there we go, oh, baby, yeah, milk that cum right out of Reggie's cock."

Reggie groaned and gripped April's hips, lifting her up with a thrust and a tilt of his pelvis, impaling her completely on his cock and lifting her knees briefly from the bed. "Oh, yeah!" he yelled. "Fuck that cock, you little slut. You want it?"

"I want it," April panted.

"Look over here," this was Rog's voice. "Give your hubby a big smile, that's it. Keep smiling,"

April smiled, vacuously, as Reggie slammed into her and fucked his cum deep into her ass. He pushed her to the bed again, and she stared, a

strange half-smile on her mouth, as Reggie's cock slithered out of her, still spurting cum. On the right side of the screen, her gaping asshole overflowed, the white cream of Reggie's second load gushing out in waves as April, evidently, came for him.

"That's two loads," Reggie told the camera, as he backed up, giving a nice view of April sprawled, ass in the air, on the bed, her asshole gushing their mingled splooge.

April, in real life, looked over at me, and reached for the laptop. I stopped her hand mid-air.

"That's probably it," she said.

I was staring at the screen. The camera panned away, was set back in a tripod, while April lay there, ass up, staring at the camera focused on her face. The split screen disappeared in a ragged change of scene, and her abused ass, thrust up, gushing cum, was the only thing left on the screen.

"Better come up with some money fast, Joe," Reggie's voice said. "Or your wife ain't even gonna wanna go back to you. That right, little thing?" He moved closer to April, pushing her onto her side. She rolled over, the red hair splaying over her throat, her arms flopping uselessly to the side. She touched her lips, her eyes vacant.

Reggie reached down to her, and touched her lip, pulling her mouth open. April sucked on his fingers, looking at the camera. "You liked that, didn't you, doll? Maybe you want to work a little more off. Hmm?"

April held his fingers, sucking on each of them in turn, her expression heated and yet vacant.

"Oh, she likes it now," Rog said.

"Yeah," Reggie agreed. He plunged his fingers into April's mouth and played with her lips possessively, messily. She grasped his thick arm, her eyes pleading for more. Her look was hungry, slightly crazed.

I had lost all sight of the fact that it was an acting job. I was consumed by the irrational fear of being unable to pay for my wife to stop fucking these guys, consumed by the pain that she had become obsessed with this other, darker, stronger man and his fat cock.

"You ain't never gonna go back, are you baby?" Reggie laughed. He slapped her playfully on the cheek. "Go get yourself cleaned up. I ain't done with you yet, don't worry."

April - the actress, I reminded myself - looked worried.

"Please," she said. "I need some more."

That was the end of the video: Rog laughing, April sucking at Reggie's fingers, pleading for more. "Keep me here with you," she moaned, in a sultry voice.

The screen went black.

April looked over at me, an almost bashful expression on her face. "That was all... you know, acting," she said.

"Fuck," I breathed.

We looked at each other for a moment. My cock was, by then, so engorged that a concern flickered in the back of my mind that it would split right up the middle, like an overcooked sausage. The pain radiated to my balls, and from there into deeper places in my torso.

I touched April's lips, much like Rog had done, pulling her mouth open, rubbing her full lips against her teeth. In the video, she had taken on the look of a slut when Rog did this to her, but here in the bedroom, the effect was not the same: this was *my* April, and she was in *my* bed, and the April in that porno had only been acting.

I pulled her to me, and kissed her with an aggression that I rarely brought to life in our bed. With my eyes closed, the images from the screen could layer over each other, one after the other, all playing out at the same time: April's face, vacant-eyed, rubbing against the mattress while Reggie kneaded the inside of her ass, April turning her head and her open mouth from dick to dick, April's cornflower blue eyes, smeared mascara rimming them, pleading with Rog to keep her there with him.

I don't remember pulling away her clothes, or how I got inside of her. Her pussy was soaked, and her legs spread wide for me. I would come within moments, so hard it would almost blind me.

I don't know if I imagined it, or I dreamed it later that night, or if it really happened, but at some point in one of these planes of existence, April met my eyes.

"It was all just acting," she whispered. "I love *you*."

EPILOGUE

The \$50K was added to our nest egg after I subtracted taxes. This allowed us to get approved for an enormous mortgage, which is what it takes to buy a tiny house in this town. We had a housewarming party for our "regular" friends. I considered inviting Lilith, but when I suggested it, it was April who blanched and lost her cool.

"I don't... know about that," she said. "She might..."

What might Lilith do? It was anybody's guess. She might tell everyone at the party how April made her money to buy the house, she might recruit people to her business, she might act like a totally normal person. She might invite Jonny and have an orgy in our bedroom without us. You just never knew.

And life went on fairly normally for a while. Jonny contacted us every now and then, and April had a few more sessions with Jonny and Rog. Every now and then Lilith would have a party, or want us to go out, but it wasn't like she took over our lives.

My fears were just beginning to fade, and I was just beginning to think that in the end, Thomas Roberts had managed the whole enchilada. His wife was perfect, she had made a porno and they bought a house and now they had a casual hotwife lifestyle and zero problems because of it.

I was That Guy on the Reddit forum, the one nobody believes...

And then one day, we are at fucking *Old Chicago*, of all the places. Lilith is there because she has some "boyfriend" who is really into sports, or so she says. He's a bit of a ganja-scented dud, like Mike, and I can't get any read on him except that he is really deep into what's on TV. They just came from the racetrack, and he has the edgy, jittery vibe of a chronic gambler.

April goes to the restroom. This guy - Chet, or something like that - is glued to the TV. Other than Lilith being Lilith, a sex goddess in a white tube top and short-shorts, one of her most conservative outfits - everything has a wholesome Sunday feel to it. I mean, it's Old Chicago. A chain restaurant that serves pizza.

Lilith watches April go, flips her hair as she turns to me, and twists a straw between her fingers. Her ripe lips glisten with lipgloss and the insanely complicated drink she ordered from the poor bartender, who was

all too happy to flex his skills for her. She has that breathless, excited look on her face, the one that presages the breathless, excited voice that she uses to tell me things like this:

"You know that guy? Hotwife guy?"

She leans close to me, smiling. It occurs to me for the very first time that Lilith acts like she and I are in cahoots, and it gives me a little thrill.

Am I in cahoots with Lilith, I wonder, ever-so-briefly. It's a thought I've never really had before. Lilith, after all, is sort of the villain in this *erotica noir*.

"He *cannot* get enough of April. He texts me like, *all the time*."

Lilith has said this with such breathless excitement that I am leaning toward her, my heart fibrillating away years of my life, hanging on her every word. It takes me a good long time to realize that was all she was going to say.

I start to sit back.

"You know what I thought of?" she says, and I almost jump because it surprises me so much that she's talking again. People in the bar start yelling and cheering. Chet is unmoved, eyes fixed on something he needs to read off a screen.

I just sit there. Don't-Say-Anything-Thomas.

"He would probably pay her a shit ton of money to wear that wig..." Lilith says, and another loud cheer eats her words, so she pauses, as if she herself chose to interrupt what she was saying for the dramatic effect, and not because of the plebes at Old Chicago.

"... and then just go to his house and fuck like, Rog or something. You know? 'Get caught' by him?"

Lilith twists her straw in her hand. I realize, with a sudden, freefalling sense of wonder, that April twists her straw the same way. Lilith's eyes twinkle.

April is coming back, I can feel her, I can sense the ripple she is sending through the bar as she breezes by. Lilith tips her glass to her mouth to get the last of her drink, grinning devilishly.

It is human nature to see a pattern where there is none, and agency where there is only coincidence. ... I have to remind myself of this adage as I lay awake at night replaying each of the nights that April returned from

the bathroom, her face unblemished by any sort of clue about the sorts of things Lilith talked to me about when April went.

I search through the microscopic changes on their faces, as if I really can remember them.

Lilith is grinning, almost winking at me, and April is... well, April.

Does a sliver of a smile flicker at the corner of her mouth?

Or does April really not know what Lilith talks to me about when she disappears?

Perhaps April is clueless, and Lilith and I are the devious ones. Perhaps it is some other way around.

It's hard to know.

April is, after all, so very good at acting.

END

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